



arnica butler

introducing
april

a hotwife beginning

INTRODUCING APRIL A HOTWIFE BEGINNING

By Arnica Butler

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CHAPTER 1

You might say it all began in Mexico.

Not *all* of it, of course.

The fantasies always seemed to be there. They were still pure fantasy at that time, something I tucked away in my mind, buried on my Kindle, slinked around on the internet for - always, always, in a private browser.

I suppose I never even thought of broaching the subject with my wife for a few reasons.

The first was the most obvious. There was always a question within myself: how much did I really *want* this to come true?

It was one thing to imagine this sort of thing in the shower, jerking off, or to let it flit through my mind as we were having sex. It was one thing to read about a fantasy in erotica stories, superimposing my wife or myself over the written characters. To occasionally browse through the vast pages of the gray backwaters of the internet, lurk about in forums, read the conversations and stories of men who claimed to have done it.

But I'm a guy who thinks ahead. It's a thing I pride myself on. Thinking of consequences, planning ahead for any eventuality. I'm a logistics guy, for fuck's sake. I think about *logistics*. It's a matter of course that I'm *supposed* to think of everything that could go wrong.

But the internet was always there, a sea of shiny lures, drawing a guy like me into the promises of happily fulfilled sexual fantasy. There were long threads from men who needed to be coached into finally telling their wives or girlfriends, but then - lo and behold! - the ladies had been receptive to it. Not just receptive, of course - enthusiastic. Men who claimed to have had countless pleasurable nights watching their wives have sex with other men, with guys they'd plucked, together, from the virtual orchard of dating sites and forums on the internet, the way the rest of us common folk select a movie to watch on Netflix.

I didn't really believe those guys.

Okay, maybe I believed *some* of them, the way men believe in pillow fights at women's slumber parties and other such mythology. Every *sensible* fiber of your being tells you it *doesn't* happen, and every woman you know will confirm that.

But if reality and the laws of physics alone guided the male mind, action movies would be boring and we would probably still be living in

caves.

So imagination, I suppose I have, but there was another major obstacle to me becoming a guy like one of *those* guys - an obstacle that had nothing to do with me, per se, or whether or not *I* would roll the dice on the dangers of opening up my marriage to a guy specifically chosen for his physical and sexual superiority.

That obstacle was my wife.

The nature and character of my wife.

I'll start where I always do: my wife's real-life true name is April Snow.

April.

Snow.

She is exactly what you expect from a girl named April Snow. She is *like* the April snow, and I shall burden you for a moment with an analogy you might find a little overwrought: April is clean and white, both physically and in personality. Her skin is a sort of insanely flawless, unfathomably soft, magical material, almost the color of snow. Just enough pink to keep her from looking vampiric, which was a fortunate calibration of her genes, because she is also raven-haired. Her eyes are a hue of purpled blue that, if you know her name, you cannot help but compare to periwinkles. To drag this anecdote out to a ridiculous level, her eyes and her natural cherry-colored lips remind even the least poetic person of spring flowers poking out from the snow white of her skin.

It's a cliché. I know. But more than one person has said this sort of thing, and that group includes a guy named Dan, a barely-literate truck driver who opens beer bottles with his teeth. I'm just saying: if a guy like Dan starts waxing poetic about something... it's, well... probably closer to *literally* true than not.

April Snow is like April snow in other ways, too: there is a freshness to her, and a cleanliness. She is chilly and sunny at the same time. Her unexpected coolness is dotted through with bright spots of quirkiness.

You guessed it. Like the flowers.

Anyway, the point is... you don't go telling a girl like April Snow that you have visceral fantasies about her sucking two dicks at the same time, or taking it in the ass from some guy with a huge cock while you watch.

It was just... sort of unimaginable. The look on her face, the way her thick, naturally black eyelashes that required no mascara would drop over her purple eyes, and then, most likely, she would start crying.

No way I was going to cause that sort of scene.

Because I am not an idiot.

I'm a guy named Thomas Roberts, and everybody calls me *Thomas*. Not Tom. Not Tommy. Not "'Mas" like this Chicano kid I knew in high school.

There's a certain kind of person you have to be if your name is Thomas and no one calls you Tom, or Tommy. It's a much-too-serious guy, a guy with a blue-collar friends who make fun of him for actually being smart enough to play, and weird enough to like, chess. And that's it, that's the whole shtick with his buddies: *Thomas. Chess guy. Played-any-chess-lately-Thomas? Thomas.*

A guy with sandy brown hair, a decent physique, a guy who is slightly short at 5'8." You know, not enough to actually call him short - no one ever calls Thomas Roberts "that short guy," but all Thomas Roger's girlfriends have to be tiny or not wear heels, and that's a thing that's generally known.

Thomas is a guy who is probably "okay" in bed, "not bad" to look at. Personality-wise, he's not easily tossed into the "friend zone" by legions of girls who walk all over him, like his friend Tubs, but he's also not a guy like his buddy Sebo, who has tattoos and plays the guitar and has about thirty grown women claiming to have a crush on him.

So when a guy like this, a guy like me, gets a girl like April Snow to tip her head to the side and form a slight smile on her ruby-red lips, and then say, "Yeah, sure, you know, why not?" and then gets her to go not only on *that* date, but many more after, and then gets her to agree to marry him... well, let's just say that the Thomas Roberts of the worlds are also the kind of guys who know this:

If a girl like April Snow lets him *touch her*, he should not do *anything* to fuck up *anything* about *any* of that.

So that's what I was doing, this Thomas Roberts. Squirreling around on the internet when April wasn't home, letting dirty thoughts wander through, boil up some cum, and spurt it out, and planning to never, ever, ever, say anything to April about any of it.

I'm a lot of things.

But "fucking idiot" is not one of them.

CHAPTER 2

So we were in Mexico, at a resort, the name of which isn't particularly important.

With Lilith.

If April Snow is, and I believe she might be, the most *appropriately*-named woman on Earth, then Lilith Stephanapolous is the hands-down champion of *least-appropriately*-named woman on Earth.

Of course the two of them became friends.

Did they look over at each other, as their names were called out in succession twenty years ago in second grade, and appraise the ridiculousness of the situation, nod, and decide to be friends forever after?

I can't help but think that they did. And they've been friends ever since.

What do you imagine if you imagine a girl named Lilith Stephanapolous? A tight, pencil-thin mouth, always fashioned into a frown, mustache forever darkening the scraggle of her upper lip? Olive skin that is somehow always pale, perhaps a Gumbi-like physique? An overflowing, dark black bush sprouting from oversized underwear of some long-abandoned style, that could not be called, by even the wildest imagination, "panties?" A humorless, dour woman who calculates your share of the restaurant bill to the exact cent and does not tip?

Certainly you would not be imagining Lilith Stephanapolous as she is in real life, because a name like that simply does not conjure this girl at all.

First of all, whatever the twists and turns of the family history that landed "Stephanapolous" on the "surname" line of her birth certificate, they are convoluted and, I suspect, involve an extramarital affair. I'm no anthropologist, but I have eyes, and Lilith has not inherited one gene indigenous to the peninsula of Greece, or anywhere within hundreds of miles of it.

And *Lilith*. It's evidently some name passed down from a relative, but she doesn't dwell on explaining that, because she doesn't really have to. Lilith is not the sort of person who has to rely on the reception of her name to get her anywhere in life.

A side note: it's a true story (I guess) that on her twenty-first birthday, she used her actual ID to enter a bar. Incidentally, she had long been using a fake one left to her by a Swedish exchange student with total success. Using her real ID, the bouncer called the cops on her.

The misnomer is that drastic.
So Lilith.

Rather than looking like an extra for a documentary about the Armenian genocide, as you might envision, Lilith looks instead like she should be on a Nordic ski team, waving and smiling at the opening ceremony of the Olympics. Her mouth is not a pencil-drawn affair, but a big, plump, juicy, pink flower of a mouth, which is almost always open suggestively and quick to form smiles that, if you know Lilith and her personality, make one's blood quicken from arousal, or fear, or perhaps both at the same time. Her hair is platinum blond, and it is natural, and the carpet does match the drapes, which is something you will find out without much effort, because Lilith likes to take off her clothes. She seems, in fact, to not be aware whether she has them on or off, or that normal people tend to put them on when they answer the door. Anyway, she leaves a little of her almost-white hair trimmed in a downy-soft landing strip, I guess as proof of her inherent blondness.

Her skin is tanned year-round, without tan lines, a tan without orange tint, without being dried out in any way. How she accomplishes this feat living in Chicago and having naturally blond hair is anyone's guess. She does not seem afraid to sunbathe naked in January, but you can't get tanned from the low winter sun no matter your level of derring-do. Maybe her skin is just magically a shade of suntan.

Lilith has the kind of figure that most women claim does not exist without surgery. The sort of unicorn that gives men like me a reason to hang on to our fantasies, in spite of all evidence to the contrary. Her thighs are sculpted, round, and lead to what almost anyone would agree is the most perfectly-shaped ass in the world. Her waist is narrow, her breasts are full and perky, and, in the same way that *April* is *beautiful*, Lilith is very, very, very *hot*. Her face is not *beautiful*: it's too tidy, too perfect, it's missing something, and honestly, if you get to looking at it too long, her eyes are a little wide-set. But I wager that only a small percentage of men spend much time looking at her face, anyway.

So there's the set-up: Lilith and April and me and Lilith's weird boyfriend at the time, in Mexico, on some trip Lilith had finangled at half-price for reasons she never disclosed. April was invited along because April is her oldest friend, and I was April's plus-one.

I remember the night this took place very clearly, because Lilith had answered the door completely naked, and it took me a while to recover from the shock, which had the somewhat pleasant effect of sobering me right up. Boom. A whole day of poolside bar drinking knocked away by the silvery white feathers above a smooth, tan slit, enormous breasts hovering over it.

There was nowhere to look, nothing to do, except stand there and gape.

"Oh," Lilith said, as if she were standing there in jeans and a t-shirt. "Is it time to go already?"

April pushed me out of the way and reached for the doorknob, closing the door slowly, almost like you would on a baby taking a nap. "Clothes," was all she said to Lilith.

Then she turned to me. "Sorry," she said, and I think she probably really meant it. "I should have warned you. She does that kind of thing."

This is probably the perfect time to introduce you to the fact that I am pretty sure that sweet April is fully cognizant of the fact that she has me completely and totally wrapped around her little finger. Sure, she may never really *do* anything with that information - she's kind, and sweet, and as far as I can tell, never a manipulative bitch, but she could be if she wanted to. On some level, I assume that April knows this, and it's because of moments like that one.

I mean - Lilith is fucking *hot*. She is a Swedish-X-rated-massage-level hot. But there was April, apologizing to me for her friend's exhibitionism, and not in the least bit concerned that I would be anything but disturbed by it.

The door opened within moments, and Lilith was loosely clad in a gossamer white dress. I say "loosely" because it was only clothing in the strictest of senses: it was made of fabric, and it had holes for her arms and legs. It was not doing any of the other jobs that clothing normally does, like hiding the shape and color of her erect nipples (eraser-like, a ripe pink), or obscuring the fact that she did not wear underwear, or really doing much more than tantalizing men with glimpses of her body and then snatching them away, like a strobe light at a strip joint.

Mike, who I remember only peripherally and as a real weirdo, had a lollipop in his mouth and said "Cheers" as he walked out the door. A vague skunky scent followed them, and then the door closed.

"Well," Lilith said. "Want to go into town for dinner?"

I'm going to repeat a few things about Lilith's dress at this point, because I think they bear repeating: it was transparent, clingy, and the only thing she was wearing. It was not fit to leave a bedroom in, let alone a resort.

April's eyes brightened. This is something I am acutely aware of whenever it happens. I don't even have to be looking at her. But then she turned to me and chewed on her lower lip.

This is because she knows me, and knows that I was already sorting the logistical and financial nightmare that "leaving the resort" was going to be.

"We have, uh, reservations at the Italian place," I said, but by the time I finished my sentence I had already given up on it. I'd only known Lilith for one day, but that's all the time you needed to know what she would do next.

"Oh but that place is so booooring," she said dryly. "Come on, Thomas," she purred, one hand on my chest, but her eyes on April in a way that I thought, at the time, would give me masturbation material for at least a few weeks (I didn't know where the evening was headed). "You only live once."

I'm not entirely sure why, but I looked at Mike, who popped his lollipop out of his mouth and shrugged.

"Okay!" Lilith said, pleased with her powers of persuasion. She linked an arm with my wife, and the two of them walked ahead of us.

April was wearing a red dress that she thought was "cute." It was actually pretty scandalous for her, high on her thighs, a low dip between her breasts. Her straight black hair was sort of knotted up in this thing she does, like origami for hair, so that little tendrils floated down to her bare shoulders and her long neck was exposed. She looked like a porcelain figurine, a modern Snow White.

Lilith's ass moved under her slightly frosted saran-wrap getup, though, and it was pretty hard not to notice that.

"So you work in logistics or something?" Mike asked me.

I kid you not, that's what he said.

*

Leaving the resort in Mexico did not turn into the hassle I imagined it to be, I think because none of the men I expected to hoot and whistle at Lilith did so. I suspect they did not believe she was real. And no one hooted at April because they were probably still busy trying to make sense of

Lilith. At any rate, Lilith seemed to work like some kind of fairy-tale ice princess, freezing all men in place, mid-expression, as she passed by.

They might have been wondering what the two of us, me and Mike, had done to get such hotties. Alternatively, and because I asked, Mike offered up an explanation: "Dudes are looking at us, and then at them, and they think we're really baller because we have these two hot chicks with us but we're just all jeans and t-shirt and shit. Obvious. We could be cartel or something. Either way, they ain't gonna say anything to them, just in case."

I want to stress that this is simply an interesting alternative explanation from Mike, not necessarily the one I believe to be correct.

We ate at a bar geared obviously toward American tourists, complete with a mariachi band and sombreros, and some kind of shot you slammed on the table like a frat boy and had to drink before it fizzed up, seemingly obligatory. The waiter appeared to be gay, because his eyes never once fell upon the bounty of Lilith's heaving tits, which looked, in the light of the restaurant, like they were bare and merely smeared over with a white, glittery paste. He also didn't look at April's prettiness, or creamy mounds peeking from beneath her red dress.

We got pretty drunk there, and then Lilith dragged us down the beach from bar to bar, until it was very late at night and everyone was behaving very silly. Somehow - and this is a drunken haze to me - the guys ended up together, and the girls ended up huddled at their own table, leaning over it and talking to each other mysteriously.

By this time, everyone in town was good and drunk, most of the people in the bar were tourists, and guys, unchained from sensibility by the many, many tequila-based elixirs they had ingested, were now beginning to look at the girls. Hungrily, blatantly, outright. Cartel be damned.

Maybe Mike and I were talking, I really don't know. I was a bit bleary-eyed by then, beginning to get a little edgy, and Mike, like I said, was mostly a real weirdo. (At some point in the evening he talked about raccoons for what seemed like thirty minutes: what they eat, how many people they have to come into contact with to become unafraid, something about their toes. I feel like that gives you a pretty good picture of this dude.)

Anyway, the girls were over at their own tiny table, casting glances around the place and whispering, and looking like a pair of hot single ladies out for a good time.

Which got me hard, and sent me down one of those waking-fantasy-tunnels I get into, where I imagine my sweet wife, April, turning suddenly into a raving whore, making out with some dirty stranger from the bar right in front of me, and then going back to our hotel room to fuck...

But I'm a logistics guy, so there was also this part of me that did not think that fantasy was a very good idea. So, erection and all, I finally got around to standing up, nudging Mike, and heading over to the girls' table.

I set my drink down on their table and said some dumb thing, like, "What are a couple of hotties like you doing in a dump like this?"

I'm not sure what I had expected, but Lilith gave her hair a toss and lifted her right arm to drape it across the back of her stool. Her legs were crossed, her dress looked very white, and my mind treated me to a very compressed scene from *Basic Instinct*.

"Playing a game," Lilith purred, one finger running along the rim of her margarita, her mouth poised to suck the salt from her fingertips within seconds.

If Lilith had taken her fist, punched it through my lower abdomen, and then squeezed some of my guts into my dick like she was stuffing sausage, I'm pretty sure it would have felt similar, if not exactly the same.

April pushed a fallen lock of straight black hair from her forehead, and giggled. "We're not," she bubbled. "Not really."

Lilith's finger was between her lips now, and the plump, glossy pillows were closing around it, her eyes sparkling with mischief and right on mine. She sucked on it loudly enough for me to hear it over the dull roar of the bar and the music. "I am," she said.

Mike had already taken a seat at a table next to theirs. These were tiny cocktail tables, against a wall, so only two seats really worked, and they crammed the occupants' legs together. Beneath the tiny table, April's and Lilith's legs were mingled in a knot of twisted pale and suntanned fantasy.

"What's the game?" I said.

Because I was drunk.

"Lilith," April giggled, and her legs moved underneath the table to nudge Lilith's. My cock pulsed. "Honey," she said to me, and her head was shaking in this delightful way I will never forget: the no-yes shake. A quick movement from side to side, an emphatic "no," but with a smile and a sort of deflated property to it that screamed, "but why not?"

I was about to repeat my question, but Lilith was already leaning back onto the table to get her breasts and her lips closer to me. "It's a game," she said breathlessly, "we used to play in college."

Yes, Lilith attended a university, and to hear April tell it, she actually *attended* and earned her degree in Business, with a minor in French.

I raised my eyebrows, and April did more head shaking.

Lilith turned her attention to April at that point. "So you were... what was your name?"

"Elena," April answered, almost immediately. Her head had ceased shaking. She bit the straw in her drink and looked up at me with a grin. "I was Slovenian."

I blinked, slowly. My head had become a cool lava lamp, things moving through it slowly when they ever did at all, the supply of oxygen reduced to a bare minimum by the re-routing of all available blood to my dick.

"And Lilith was..." April continued, and then stopped to suck through the straw while she looked at the ceiling, probably unaware of the image she was invoking.

"Astrid," Lilith purred. *Ah-stred*.

"From Sweden," April explained to me. And then she giggled.

"Ah-ha," I said, without understanding a thing. "And then what?"

Lilith looked at me for one long moment, her expression searing me with its disdain, or allure, or both. "We picked up guys," she said, with the tone one reserves for a toddler who has asked you what a truck is like fifty times.

I looked quickly to April, who was looking at me, and then looked down at her drink. But her lips had the remnants of a smile, the kind of smile I'd never seen on April's mouth before.

When she looked back up, it was gone. She put a hand on mine, which had fallen to the table to support myself a little more, and stroked it. "It was a long time ago," she assured me. She gave Lilith a sharp look. "It was so silly."

Lilith leaned back again, and beneath the table her legs were moving. I didn't dare look down, because my mind was doing a fine job of replaying Sharon Stone's fine scene in *Basic Instinct* (truthfully, I haven't even seen the whole movie) without any visual assistance.

Also, if I looked down, I was afraid I'd call attention to my erection.

"It was fun," Lilith said, with a convincing Swedish accent.

Or... maybe unconvincingly. I don't know. Does a girl like Lilith have to *do* much of anything convincingly?

She looked at April, and April looked at me, and then at her drink.

"So... what? How?" I stammered. "And.... why?"

Lilith shrugged. "For fun."

April looked up at me and shrugged, in a much less menacing way than Lilith had. She held her straw between her fingers and rolled it, seemingly unaware of how sexual the movement was.

"Want to see?" Lilith asked.

Say someone ever decides to make a movie about my life for whatever dumb reason: *this* is the moment you do some kind of special effects, where everything around Lilith gets blurred, like we're falling through a wormhole or something. And somehow her lips just keep moving and asking this question over and over and over again. Her voice sounds like it's underwater.

want to see want to see want to see want to see

Thomas? Do you want to see us play a game where your wife pretends to be Slovenian and pick up guys?

I stared. I moved my head so that I could look at April, but my eyes didn't follow. I actually had to rip them from Lilith's lips, and by the time I got to April's face, she was looking stunned.

"I act - I would, uh, actually - not seriously, just - show me how the game works. Yeah, whatever."

That's my best reconstruction of whatever it was that I said.

My eyes were on April's face now. I was drunk as fuck, and saying something super-stupid, but that wasn't the first time that had happened in my life, just maybe the most potentially consequential. The quick-moving, reptilian part of my brain, mostly anesthetized by booze, perked up, and was thinking ahead: *you just did it, bud, you just literally crossed the Rubicon! Sort of! Way to go.*

And the husbandy part of my brain, also largely under general anesthesia, was looking at April's face for the tiniest change, the flicker of an eyelid, the swell of salt water that would precede tears, a tremble in her lip.

But absolutely... *nothing*.. happened on April's face. For several moments. She looked at me, with her mouth open, the lower half of her

face, I guess, expressing mild disdain and disbelief. But her eyes twinkled.

"Huh," said Lilith, and when I looked at her, she was looking right at me, amused, like a cat who had eaten a canary.

April was back to shaking her head. It now seemed to be a shake of disbelief, and I would have bet all the money in the world she was about to talk about how she was too drunk, and how we should all go home.

But Lilith started talking first. "Have a seat, cowboy," she said. "And stay out of our way."

"Lilith!" April exclaimed.

Lilith rolled her eyes. "Oh God, it's just a game," she said. "He *asked* to see it. You never went home with anyone, anyway... exc-"

Lilith cut herself off, smiling at me, and to my right, April fluttered, like a bird in a box. That's all I remember.

Next thing I knew, I was sitting next to Mike. April gave me one last look over her shoulder, and Lilith tossed her hair haughtily. The two girls put their heads together over the table.

"Getting a beer," Mike said. "Want one?"

I looked at him blankly. He cocked a thumb behind him without even glancing at his insane girlfriend in her slathering-of-soap dress. "They're gonna be a while, I take it?"

"I..." I said, idiotically.

Mike continued looking at me. It was like he worked at my office and was headed to the break room and wanted to know if I wanted more coffee.

"Negra Modelo?" I said. And I guess that's what he brought me, because there were four empty Negra Modelo bottles on the table about an hour later.

CHAPTER 3

But I am skipping ahead.

For a while, nothing happened, and I sat there with an uncomfortable, twisted feeling in my gut while April and Lilith put their heads together and sipped their drinks through straws. Every now and then a bubbly giggle would rise from their general direction, and Lilith's hair would be tossed, shimmering and blond, through the air. A ripple would travel through the bar when this happened: men would turn, say something to each other, grin, take the bait.

Mike was completely unbothered by this entire scene so much that he was actually chatting to me about a topic I have no memory of, without looking over his shoulder to see what his gorgeous girlfriend was doing.

I sat there, my erection driving a white hot pain into my abdomen, slightly nauseous, nodding at Mike's pauses, and trying to piece together exactly what had been said, and therefore what I had agreed to. Had she said she was going to pick up some guys? Actually? April was going to do that? Or no... no, I wouldn't have agreed to *that*.

But you would have, a devilish little character in the darker recesses of my mind whispered.

Lilith stood up at some point, and shimmied a little to get her wild dress down to where it covered her pert bottom. A soft giggle escaped her lips, and she leaned over to speak to my wife, treating the men who could see her from the proper angle to what I am sure was a very delightful sight: the shape of her ass when she bent over, barely covered by her semi-transparent dress, perhaps nothing at all stopping them from seeing just where her snatch began: a slim, dark line, surrounded by smooth skin.

I shuddered. Lilith rose to her full height and turned, then strutted to the bar.

I surveyed the guys in the room. There were all types: old men, college kids on vacation, a couple of dudes with angry wives simmering next to them. Everyone was looking as much as their circumstances allowed them to, eyes moving all over Lilith's stunning curves as she crossed one ankle over the other and leaned forward to order a drink from the bartender, who had actually stopped pouring someone else's drink, practically dropped the glass and bottle on the counter, and run over to speak to her with an eager smile and a look of disbelief on his face.

Just like that, a stud moved in. Young, dark-haired. I watched Lilith at work: she leaned on the bar and turned to him as he said something to the bartender. She showered him with a brilliant, juicy smile, and then moved her mouth.

The change this effected on the poor guy was visible even from where we were: a sort of tremor traveled through him, and for a moment I was sure he was going to fall over. He looked around him, almost as if for help, like he needed to confirm something with the people around him. He had a disbelieving grin on his face.

Lilith nodded, tucking a strand of hair behind her ear. The music died down a little in that moment, and her voice carried over the quiet to us: a really quite believable Nordic-sounding accent curled around her words, and at the same time something about her gestures seemed to "mesh" with the idea of her being Swedish. "Yeah," she said, with oddly rounded vowels, "yeah, I am. This is... nice, thank you, I am... not sure how to, um... what is the custom? Accept...?"

The music picked up again, and I couldn't hear what she was saying, but she lifted an arm to point at April.

I feel the need to interject here that this was playing out like a film script. I mean, Lilith was really convincing. I was drawn into the story like I was at home watching some b-rated movie. The plot was dumb, the acting was so-so, but the actress was really hot, so why not keep watching?

It was only when the guy grinned, moved around, and grabbed a buddy of his, that it began to slowly work its way through my mind: Lilith was pointing at *my wife*, and this young buck's friend, also young, decent-looking, was looking over at April, getting two drinks from the bartender.

Lilith waved April over.

I watched my wife stand up, and her hair fell down as she did, out of her bun, a little kinked in places from her hairdo - but April is blessed with straight, thick black hair that hardly musses, and it fell in a shiny curtain over her shoulders.

She took her drink with her, and barely looked in my direction except for a quick glance, and a smile.

It was that, more than anything that would happen next, that really stabbed me right in the chest. April stalked over to the bar, with a walk that really wasn't even *hers* - and I don't know exactly how to explain that,

except that April doesn't usually *stalk*. The last bits of unleashed hair slid into place and swung lightly over her shoulders as she neared the bar.

I watched them, doing all the things that pairs of women and pairs of men who do not know each other do when they first meet: smile awkwardly, introduce each other, steal glances at each other. Lilith's mouth was open and moist and smiling most of the time, and I heard a strange, glittery giggle that must have been April's erupt from that direction in steady spurts.

The guy who had originally approached Lilith, funnily enough, took to standing behind the barstool Lilith had decided to sit in. He was attentive to Lilith, but his eyes were constantly stealing glances at April.

At *my* wife.

Mike had stopped talking long ago, and was now settled comfortably on his bar stool, one leg folded over his knee, watching the whole thing like it was a movie.

I was trying to be a little more surreptitious, but I didn't know where to look. Luckily, the bar was getting rowdier by the minute, and people were milling about between us and the ladies, so there wasn't much chance of those guys noticing the two of us staring like Neanderthals. Which is a little what I felt like, because I could feel that the expression on my face was slack-jawed and stunned, and there was nothing I could do about it.

People crossed in front of us, blocking the view, and when it cleared, I could only see Lilith, who was looking right at me, a devious expression on her face.

I had little time to contemplate what it meant: Lilith turned her attention back in April's direction, and the guy standing behind Lilith dragged his fingers along her arm while he locked his eyes on my wife's... breasts? Torso? I couldn't see.

The people in front of me moved, at last, and I was able to follow the strange gaze of Lilith's suitor.

To April's torso.

Where *her* guy had slid his hand around April's waist.

A liquid seemed to pour over me: slow-moving, icy, making the hairs on my upper arms and the back of my neck rise. I stared at the arm around April's waist, almost unable to believe it was there. Casually there, fingers moving just above her hip-bone.

I had to rub my eyes and look at this again, but even through the bleary alcohol-haze, it was clear: this guy was *stroking* her.

The cold flowed over me, my heart seemingly stopped by its chill, and I stopped breathing.

My cock was the only part of my body that seemed to drink it in, pulsing wildly as it pressed against the seam of my shorts, painful now.

I stole a glance at Mike, almost as if I believed this weird guy was somehow, suddenly, my comrade-in-arms, but he was fixated on the whole scene, drink in hand, no signs in his physique of the distress I was feeling myself.

I shifted my gaze back to the ladies. Lilith stole another amused glance at me, bringing a straw to her lips with a smile that could best be described as sinister. Then she leaned back, resting her head against the chest of her guy, tipping her chin up and fluttering her eyes upward at him. He craned his neck, her mouth was moving.

Whatever Lilith said, it was repeated to the other couple - my wife and the guy with his hands on her - and it caused a flurry of activity. The bartender was called over, Lilith's suitor leaned over the bar to speak to him. April seemed to wake from a dream - either hers or mine - and stepped slightly to the side, causing the man's hand to fall away from her hip, slide over her rump, and finally to his own thigh. He leaned in over the bar to speak to his friend, and Lilith climbed, slowly enough that a quick glimpse of the interior of her thighs, and a shadowy glimpse of her slit, was revealed to anyone who was looking, from her stool. She shook her hair a little and used one hand to tug at the dress.

It was then that April looked over her shoulder, her eyes a little frantic, to find me. Her mouth was moving, and Lilith was starting to pout. Lilith's eyes rolled, and she leaned over the guy with her arms outstretched, like she was one of those hot girls showing off a muscle car in a calendar. She drew her hands lazily over the length of the guys torso and kept talking to April.

My heart was beating again, now exceedingly fast. My eyes didn't know where to look: to April, to Mike, who was watching with the most minimally interested expression on his face, to Lilith, who was saying something to April?

I didn't know.

April turned to the guy who had been stroking her hip, and he raised himself up from the bar with a smile, putting his hand right back on her

waist. I watched my wife as though she were another person entirely: she smiled, dropped her hand to his, shook her long mane of hair, and then stepped away. She walked in the direction of the bathroom.

Lilith treated me to an eyeroll, and then dropped a last, red glob of her daiquiri on to her tongue, before slinging her arm around April's guy, who was all too happy to get his hands on *her*.

I looked toward the bathroom hallway, but April was long gone. I thought about getting up, marching over to the doors, but my entire torso had become a block of ice, immobilized, like dead weight, while at the same time deep within me legions of worms of jealousy and nausea were squirming.

The trio headed toward the door, Lilith clinging to the neck of April's guy as she swung on him, tossing her hair, bringing her big, smiling mouth within inches of his. The guy who had originally hit on Lilith got close to her ear to ask her something.

"...meet us there," I heard her faux-Swedish voice say, in a lull in the loudness.

And then they headed toward the door, arms and hands and torsos writhing together.

"Well," Mike said, standing up. "I guess we're heading somewhere."

I looked up at him in disbelief. I wasn't sure what was happening.

April was in the hallway of the bathroom now. I saw her red dress. She looked at me and pointed a finger toward the wall to her left, in the direction of the bar. "They there?" her lips seemed to say.

I shook my head. I was standing up, then I was walking, and April was still standing in the hallway, looking a little lost.

The distance closed between us. I still don't know what I was thinking. I'm not sure what I planned to say to her.

"They're going to a club," she told me, looking almost stunned. "I'm so sorry. That got so out of hand, I didn't think Lilith would..." she jerked her hands around in a motion that meant "*do that*."

And what, dear readers, did your narrator do? Your narrator with the severe pain in his chest, the erratic heartbeat, the knives of searing jealousy and disbelief shooting through his groin, the impossible erection, the nausea, the fog of a dream thickening in his brain...what did he do?

"Which club?" I asked.

*

It's not the easiest task to describe what happened to April's face after I asked that question. A flurry of expressions moved over her features, from her mouth to her eyes and from her eyes to her mouth, moving in waves that crashed into each other, mixing together surprise, relief, shock, sadness, and anger, until the final ripples were a distorted, carnivalesque mélange of all these things and perhaps more.

It was fairly grotesque.

When the reflecting pool of emotions at last settled, her eyes were wild, her mouth opened slightly, and a flush of intense crimson was creeping over her cheekbones. Her lips came together to start several words and then parted, without emitting a sound, before they pinched together for a few moments so tightly that the edges turned a violent white.

"Did you... what? Did you... even see...? Are you crazy?!"

I've often wondered if I would make the same stupid gesture I was making at an erupting volcano, or some other force of nature: hands spread, palms facing the danger, moving up and down. *Let's everybody just calm down...*

But I guess if you do that to a volcano, it's dumb because it does nothing.

If you do that to a woman, it usually makes things worse.

"Don't...!" April seethed, waving her hands in imitation of me.

Then she went back to looking confused. And hurt.

She folded her arms over her chest.

I was really drunk, so it was taking me a little while to catch up. In fact, knowing myself, I'm pretty sure I couldn't remember exactly what I'd said to set this reaction off.

"I thought it was just... for fun," I said, lamely.

April stared at me.

"Look, we don't have to go," I added. Unconvincingly.

April started to shake her head, and then seemed to get suspicious, because her eyes narrowed. "What are you even *saying*?"

I shrugged. That's me, Thomas The Shrugged. I make my eyes big and look around, like I have no idea what's going on.

It's a move designed to buy time while I think.

"That guy had his hands all over me," April complained.

Before I confess to what I did next, I would just like to reiterate that I had been drinking all day.

"It was kind of... I don't know... hot," I ventured. I held up my hand, or rather, I watched my hand elevate to just before my eyes, my thumb and pointer finger close together but not touching.

Just a smidge, I was saying. I crinkled my eyes up to add some much-needed potential for comic relief.

"Hot."

A deadly silence followed.

"You think it's hot that a guy had his hands all over me."

Opportunity, as they say, knocks. For sure. What they leave out of this saying is that opportunity knocks when you have a small fire in your house and you're trying to douse it while calculating whether or not insurance will cover it if you let it burn, and also whether or not that will put you ahead in life, or out on the street.

I rubbed my forehead with the back of my hand, because I was sweating and the nausea had returned. My skin was cool and clammy against my temple. "All I'm saying is," I began, but didn't really have any way to finish the sentence at the forefront of my mind. There was a pause while I ran my hand over my face. "I don't know. We're drunk. It was just, you know, kind of... weirdly... fun, sort of interesting. Anyway, it's just a game, right?"

April glared at me. "You said, 'hot.'"

"Okay," I said, waving my hands out in a gesture of surrender. I was thirty that year, and I could still be gripped by a certain *bravura*, that thing that grips you when you're about fifteen and makes you get suddenly, forcefully worked up about stuff. "Hot, April. I said 'hot.' It was kind of hot. And," I held a finger up, because I was getting a full head of alcoholized steam going, "I remind you, that you were the one who wanted to play that game, to begin with. It was your idea."

"What about it was hot?" April said, in a yell-whisper. Someone edged past us in the hallway and we paused our "talk" until he disappeared into the men's room, a not-particularly good odor billowing back into the hall as the door swung shut.

"Can we maybe... take this to a different place?" I asked, scrunching up my nose.

April rolled her eyes and brushed past me, which I took to mean yes.

CHAPTER 4

"So what about some random guy hitting on your wife is 'hot?'" she demanded, without looking around, as soon as we stepped into the street. Then she spun and faced me.

"I have no idea," I lied. And then, to quickly bury that claim, I said, "Why did *you* let him do it?"

This question caught April completely off-guard. She actually swayed, like someone had swept a foot under her legs and she had to regain her balance. Her eyelids covered her eyes, slowly, and then rolled up again, also slowly. Her lips expelled a puff of air that began with a "phh."

She put her hand to her forehead. "Oh God," she complained. She smiled, which was encouraging. "Oh God, I am so *drunk*. I don't even know what's going on."

She looked at me, and I looked at her, and we both laughed.

April folded her arms and shivered, but I suspect it was fake because it was hot as hell, even though the sun had faded and a breeze was coming off the ocean.

"Let's just go..." we both said at the same time.

"...to the club," I finished.

"...home," April said, at the same time.

Her eyes widened. "What?"

I did my Thomas-Roberts-Shrug again. "Let's just go to the club." I held my hands out. "It's a nice night. We're really drunk, we're on vacation, it's Mexico... we're going to have a hangover anyway." I took her arm. "Come on, you came all this way to have fun with Lilith. Right?"

She stepped toward me, reluctantly at first, and then willingly falling into step with me. I didn't know where we were going, but I was taking us there, my arm now linked with hers. "Let's not let this turn into a stupid fight. It's... we're here, it's Mexico, we're drunk... let's just go have fun and not worry about it."

We walked for a little bit while April made a face and shook her head.

"But you seriously thought that was hot?" she asked, after a while.

I looked up at the sky and sighed. "I mean... yeah. I did. I don't know why. It was just kind of... like watching you like you were some other person, not my wife. Just kind of... I don't really know. Different. Fun."

"But 'hot?'" April said, stopping. Her face was very serious. "Is this your way of telling me you want to like, have an affair or something?"

This worked very slowly through my mind, while my gut bubbled like a science fair experiment. In my unrelenting, drunken optimism, I was sure I had heard, "...you want me to have an affair or something." But there was a snag in the lexicon, I just couldn't put my finger on what it was.

"W..." I said, and left the word unfinished. "Well... I mean, not like, an affair. Just a like, physical thing..."

I stopped talking because I could see, by the violent shade of purple in April's eyes, and the way her features were turning into a jagged sculpture of rage, that I was saying the wrong thing.

She hit me on the shoulder, *hard*.

"So you're saying you want to just hook up with -" She stopped. Her eyes got even more fiery. "Oh, I get it. With fucking Lilith. *That's* a new one." Infuriated, she looked one way, and then the other, but clearly had no idea which way would take her back to the hotel, or a taxi, or what to do.

"W..." I said again, holding up my hand. "Wait. No.. wait, April, no you have it all wrong. Not *Lilith*."

That was wrong, and I knew it, so I held up two hands toward the volcano, and shook my head, but April was already fuming.

"Not *Lilith*? Not *Lilith*? Oh gee, thanks a lot -"

I grabbed her hand. "April. No. Not - that's not what I meant. Not, not Lilith. Not *me*. Not... I don't want *me* to have an affair - I don't want anyone to have an affair, but I don't want it to be me. I meant *you*."

April stared at me.

"What the hell are you saying?" she shrieked.

I took her hand and put it between mine, holding it in front of my face. "I... am not... saying... anything," I said, closing my eyes. "I am drunk, and we should go -"

April snatched her hand from between mine.

This wasn't going well. I left my eyes closed. " - back to the hotel -"

"You *just said*, you want me to have an affair with Lilith."

I opened my eyes. "no," I said, shaking my head resolutely.

I wasn't sure what I had actually said, but I knew it wasn't *that*.

(It is fair to say that a voice, the Bad Voice, inside my head was saying something like: *Although...*)

Luckily, April started talking before I could say any of that out loud.

"I'm not a lesbian," she shot.

I held up a hand. "You have this all wrong."

She glared at me.

"I meant, and I just got... we're too drunk for this conversation..."

"Finish what you were saying." April snarled. "Anyway..." she prompted.

I rubbed my forehead again.

I'm a lot of things, and that night I was also drunk, but I do know when I've dug myself into a hole. I was starting to realize that tonight was not the night to try and confess my fantasy, and vaguely I was aware that I might have poisoned the well forever. "You know what, April, we're -"

"You want me to have a 'physical thing' with Lilith?" she said, and she started walking again, looking over her shoulder. "That's really fucking original."

"Not *Lilith*!" I said, exasperated. My exasperation at being misunderstood got the better of me. "I want you to have a physical thing with another *guy*!"

April stopped in her tracks. She turned around, arms folded over her waist. Her mouth was now caught somewhere between whatever she had been planning to say, and the strangest smile I had ever seen.

"Another guy..." she said, disbelief dripping from her voice.

"This is not the way I wanted to talk to you about this," I said, seriously. "So let's just forget it -"

She let out a sharp bark of a laugh. "Another *guy*."

"Like I said, April, we're drunk, this isn't a good time to -"

"You expect me to believe that."

She was shifting her jaw from side to side. It wasn't something I'd ever seen April do before and it was slightly terrifying.

"Believe that?" I said, because repeating the last words of somebody else's question is a trick I learned for meetings. Although I wasn't sure what it was supposed to accomplish in this context.

"You want *me* to hook up with another *guy*?"

I waved my hands around and made a bunch of weird expressions, most meant to give plausibility to the next idea I was going to introduce, which was that this was all a big joke. "I mean... not in like, any serious way... it just came up, because you were at the bar there with that guy..."

April still looked steamed.

"I'm not... you know, super-serious about it," I floundered.

I was, but this was derailing faster than I could handle in my current state.

April was shaking her head and squinting.

"Honey," I said. "We are... I am, at least... *so* drunk. I don't really know what the hell is going on here."

It was a Hail Mary.

It made April laugh. She brought her hand to her mouth and laughed.

I went along with the laughing, but nervously, because I was still marveling that I could maybe get out of this situation.

"Neither do I!" April said, laughing. "No idea."

At that precise moment, her phone buzzed, and she fished it from her purse, and started laughing again. "It's fucking Lilith," she said, and now she was laughing in that nonsensical, out-of-control drunk way that people who *might not remember the evening* laugh.

Which was great news for me.

"She wants to know if we got lost. She sent me some directions on a napkin."

She flipped the phone toward me. There was a dimly lit napkin with some red squiggles on it and an "x," evidently for the club. No words indicated what any part of the squiggles were, and none of the squiggles represented anything normally found on a map.

We laughed at it.

"Can you just ask her what the place is called?" I asked.

April smiled and typed; she was already doing that.

Good, I remember thinking. Now we were both laughing at Lilith, April seemed to have forgotten the whole conversation...

And, if I had a good read on the situation - I put my chances at 40% - it looked like we were going to the club.

*

The club was a fire trap of black walls, mirrors and blue LED lights under black-lacquered tables. On a large dance floor, a swarm of people - a peculiar mix of ages, colors, and enthusiasm levels found only in clubs in tourist traps - moved around with a desperate longing for fun, only partially in time to the music. Pockets of local kids stood, serious-faced, among the dancers, either plotting to sell them drugs or annoyed that they had taken over the dance floor with their awful dancing.

There were very good-looking people, and very ugly people, people dressed for a club and people who seemed to have wandered in off the beach around noon and decided to stay. The club was called "Melt," but the "l" was written strangely and flickered, so I spent the first few minutes looking for the rest of the name as we stood outside in the pulsing air, absorbing the shocks of the stereo system while April, adorably, tried to determine if we were in the right place.

It was good that April had tasks to occupy her mind, because I was hoping that the conversation in the middle of the street would be overwritten by everything else that would transpire and we could maybe just forget it ever happened. *I* wasn't entirely sure what had happened, but the general impression I had was that it hadn't gone well. At all.

"Okay," she said, tucking her phone away. "We're in the right place."

So we went in. I stuffed my hands in my pockets and put on my club face, in an effort to look a little more cool, but I was wearing shorts, so I very much doubt it worked.

It certainly wasn't much of a task to find Lilith. The glow of the lights in the club cast an ethereal blue on her soapy dress, and pretty much made it totally transparent. I could see the circles of her nipples from across the dance floor, when she held a hand up high to wave us over.

She was seated on the lap of the young man she had picked up at the bar, and if the scene had been played for me devoid of context, I would have assumed she was a stripper beginning a lap dance. She was grinding into his lap to the beat of the music, and he was watching her over her shoulder, eyes glued to her bouncing tits beneath the transparent glaze of her "dress."

April made for the group, passing through the dancers on the floor, shimmying a little with a guy who smiled and tried to dance with her. She looked back at me, still smiling, and then she took a few steps in the direction of Lilith and her friends.

And then, it seemed to all come back to her. I assume it was the sight of the *two guys* with Lilith. April stopped dead in her tracks and so I almost careened right into her. I did a pretty good job of turning it into a suave moment, sliding my arms around her waist like I meant to.

She turned around to me, her eyes big, her face surprised. I started dancing, which I actually have to say, I'm not that bad at.

April danced a little, too.

At this point, I was working under the assumption that April had seen these two studs, and the whole crazy evening, including our crap conversation, had come back to her in a rush. That I had a few moments to dance with her before she'd say she wanted to get out of there and start fighting again, and I was prepared to pretend I was just wasted and couldn't be reasoned with.

It wasn't going to be hard to make *that* act convincing.

Then, I was going to act like I didn't remember any of this happening, and we would all go home to America.

And I would never mention any of this again.

"I just realized," April said - and in my mind I was picturing an ax falling down toward my neck - "*You* can't show up with me."

I stopped dancing and gave her a blank look.

"They think I'm Elena," she purred, and even though it was loud, I distinctly heard her fake accent. "From Slovenia."

I was staring at her.

Her face fell suddenly. "Unless... I thought that's what..."

I thought quickly, or it might be better to say that I acted quickly and thought about it later. I grasped her hands. "Shit," I laughed. "You're right, okay. I'm going to look for Mike, I guess."

I had only just then even thought about Mike, who had departed the bar before me and April, but whom I hadn't given another thought to until now.

"You still want to do this?" she screamed, leaning toward me, because the music had just gotten louder. "Like, just for fun?"

It was important, I thought, quickly and rationally, to define all the terms in that sentence. "This" was a particularly important one, and "do" was a close second.

"Yes!" I yelled.

And then for good measure, "It's really hot!"

I am compelled to remind anyone who is still here: we were both *really* drunk.

*

I spent the next half hour with my elbows on the mirrored tabletop of a slightly elevated bar on the other side of the dance floor. From there, I had a good view of April and Lilith, and the two men they were with, and all the other men that floated into their orbits and then drifted away, deflated.

I'm going to give these two guys names. I got their actual names from April at a later time: Rick was the guy who had been brave enough to approach Lilith at first, a dark-haired, lean, twenty-something stud.

His buddy, hilariously, was also Rick, but they called him "The Chard." He was also young, less good-looking though, but with the wiry, athletic build of a guy who hasn't yet gone to seed like the rest of us.

I'll call him Mr. Hands, though, because "The Chard" is a stupid nickname any way you slice it.

April began nervously, like she couldn't quite believe what she was doing. I like to believe that was because she was playing a game she used to play when she was single, and it felt odd to her because deep down inside, she knew and remembered that she was married.

Mr. Hands was pretty happy to see her. He scooted out of the booth, and let April slide in, which she did after some hesitation. Lilith slipped off Rick's lap and into the booth, and then he rose and headed to the bar. Lilith and April put their heads together for a moment.

Whatever was said, it didn't take long. April flipped her hair suddenly, and rested her jaw on her hand, face upturned, looking at Mr. Hands with an expression of interest that sent jealousy snaking right from my heart to my groin, probably along that same artery they use to burn your heart up in an ablation, which I haven't had, but can now imagine.

I stared at the woman who I knew to be my wife, at the sparkle in her eye, at the flirtatious way she was smiling and talking, her fingers moving over the lacquered table suggestively.

Rick returned with drinks, sliding them to the ladies with great flourish. He'd purchased four shots and four chasers, and he carried and dispersed them like a bartender. Then he dropped into the booth, sliding his arm over Lilith's shoulders.

Mike was sitting in my general vicinity. I looked over at him and he gave me a chin-up nod, then went back to watching, so I followed suit.

This went on for a while. Lilith turned in the booth to face Rick, and her hands, after delivering her drinks to her lips in quick succession, disappeared under the table. But I wasn't really watching Lilith: I was watching my wife. Tucking her hair behind her ear, smiling with moist lips, holding a drink to her mouth while nodding, almost affectionately, at whatever it was Mr. Hands was saying.

Lilith must have been the impetus to move them all to the dance floor. She waved her hands and they began to move, first Rick, who turned to pull her from the booth and immediately positioned himself behind her with his hands on her waist. Mr. Hands scooted out and extended a hand to my wife, who looked troubled for just a moment, searching around - I hoped - for me.

But it was a swift, almost perfunctory glance, and then she demurred for only a second more, something of a question on her lips. A cold dagger sliced through my chest when she gave up, held her hand out, and let Hands guide her to the dance floor.

The music had turned into a vulgar reggae song, and with the change, the dancers had changed as well: now everyone was getting closer, following the advice of the lyrics, bouncing ass into waiting crotches, squirming and knotting together like mating snakes.

April was not really into this kind of dancing. She's always been more of a crazy indie-music, bouncing-around-happily kind of dancer. She tried this for a while, and Hands moved in on her, putting first one hand on her waist, pulling her in close, and then turning her around to hold her with both hands and move her hips along with his.

Which April, to my delight and anguish, faltered only for a moment before melting into.

They were out there for a long time, and April's skin began to shine with the tiniest bit of sweet sweat. Sweet, I can say, because I know her: her sweat is salty but sweet, very lickable, and I could see from Mr. Hand's expression that licking her neck was high on his list of priorities: he was staring at it when she lifted her damp hair from her neck while she danced.

April's hair is very thick. Her neck gets hot. This is a thing she does no matter how she's dancing. It's just that, set to that particular music, with her ass against Mr. Hand's crotch, swaying and grinding, it was absolutely obscene.

And hot.

Mr. Hand's hands were now traveling in wider, more exploratory ventures. From her waist, along her ribs, to just below the swollen cups of her sundress. Back down, past her waist, lower, nearly to the hem of her dress, which was riding up higher with every bend, and twist, that April was making.

Back up, back down. Did his fingers wander from her ribcage, forward, brushing over her breasts?

I admit I couldn't tell; people moved between us, blocking my view. They turned, and sweat dripped into my eye at one point, obscuring my vision with the added fun of a horrible pain.

I procured a beer for myself, but barely drank it, and the dancing went on and on. I stared at April, who was now covered in a sheen that reflected the lights. Her arms were up, holding her hair, and her body was writhing within the confines of her dance partner's wandering hands.

Hands that continued to wander, while April continued to dance, eyes closed, lips pouty. I stared as Hands plunged his right hand between her legs: over the dress, not beneath it, but still: all that stood between his palm and April's mound was her dress and her panties, both made of thin fabric. Probably damp with sweat.

On my own, cool, damp palm, I could almost feel what it was like to cup her mound like that, from behind.

But this was not my hand, I thought, with a nauseating chill: it was another man's hand.

My cock was hard, and it pulsed painfully against the seam of my shorts. I shifted, and pain gripped my balls. This was really happening, I had made it happen... April was really letting another man put his hands all over her.

The lights had begun to flash and blink, casting moments of total darkness over the dancefloor and my view. Strobe lights. Now April came to me in flashes: pale white skin, dark red lips, long lashes against her upper cheek, her eyes closed and her mouth open.

Her hair fell down, and then it was swept aside - not by her, but by Mr. Hands. In another flash, I saw his lips hovering just above her shoulder. The shock of it blurred the next white flash of April: lips open, head turned back slightly toward Hands.

Another flash, and another. All still lifes of my wife very close to this man's face, her mouth within inches of his, his hands somewhere unknowable. His head bent over as he must have, *must have*, kissed her shoulder.

The music changed abruptly, and a flurry of Spanish, poor in quality because whoever was delivering it was eating the microphone, broke the spell of the moment. The strobe lights ceased. April was standing in front of

Mr. Hands, facing him, her mouth in a strange, half-smiling expression. She leaned in, tipped her head to say something in his ear, and his hand went to her arm, his fingers dancing over her shoulder, then down the collar of her dress.

She made a move to get away from him, he pulled her back, he said something, and April smiled, then walked off the dance floor to the right of me.

The strobe lights started again. I glanced back at the dance floor, confused. Lilith was not there, and it didn't take long to come to that conclusion: a girl as hot as Lilith in a transparent dress is not something you could overlook.

I started putting it all together, and then, thankfully, acted, before I let myself think for too long. It was a little confusing, see.

But April was headed out of the club.

And I was pretty sure I was supposed to follow.

CHAPTER 5

Back to April, and her personality: she isn't like this. She isn't bubbly, or bimbo-y, or slutty, or spontaneous, or fun in the sense that she will do something wild.

She is, like a spring day, refreshing and serene and austere beautiful.

These are important things to remember because, when I popped out of the club after wading through blue-lit faces and a confusing bout of strobe-lit music that misdirected me, in my drunken state, almost back to where I started - a little like a person lost in a forest - a woman who very much looked like April was waiting for me, across the street, where she was purchasing a Jarrito from a street vendor. The vendor was chatting her up in Spanish, and this April doppelganger was laughing, which was peculiar because April doesn't speak Spanish, and April also does not drink colored sugar water beverages, which is what Jarritos are.

She lifted the glass bottle to her lips and sipped it as she turned to me, and her mouth was smiling even as she drank. Her skin was still glistening, her hair was damp with her sweat, and her red dress was sticking to her thighs, elevating the hem a good few inches more than April, the *real* April, would have been comfortable with.

She looked like what any man with a respectable suburban wife might conjure as an image of their wife, with that same masculine hopefulness I was talking about earlier. You know, the pajama-party hope.

"Did he follow?" she asked me, as I crossed the street. She didn't wait for my answer, but instead took my hand and pulled me along with her at a walking clip that was more like jogging. She was ahead of me, looking back, giggling, shiny with sweat, a long way down the street, to the strip along the beach, where we turned left and kept moving until she veered right and plopped into the sand. Laughing.

I sat down next to her, unsure of what to do. She laughed again, handed me the nearly-empty Jarritos bottle, and I warily took a sip.

Then her expression got serious. "Are you okay?" she asked. "Please don't be mad, that was all just a game."

I must have paused too long, because she hurried to say: "I thought you were, like, cool with it..."

It seemed like a very long time that her statement hovered in the air. Waves crashed in on the beach. I knew what I *wanted* to say, but I was a

little worried about it all going wrong, the way it had before we had headed to the club.

"Thomas?"

She put a hand on mine.

"It was all just for fun -"

"No, no, I know," I said quickly. "I already told you what... look," I sighed. I looked out at the ocean. Here I was, doing the same thing I only a few hours before had wished I could take back, and then had been mercifully saved from, and which I had thought had been wiped from April's memory. Here I was, about to dredge it up again.

Don't do it! a little voice in my head offered helpfully.

No one listens to that guy.

"I already told you, I think it's hot," I said.

When April didn't say anything, I assumed I had cooked my own goose again and turned toward her with a vague sense I might get slapped.

"Good," she said, smiling.

I stared for a few seconds, unable to get my bearings. I was also unsure of what I was feeling: this was good, right? April was not mad this time that I had basically admitted I liked watching her with another guy. So good.

Except this revelation, this moment I'd always secretly hoped would happen, also turned me inside out. My chest was full of that roller-coaster-induced cool sickness. I sort of like it, but also, it's no good.

"W...", I said. "Where's, uh...so where did Lilith go?"

April pulled her feet under her legs and pushed her hair back, before leaning toward me confidentially. "I think maybe I should have warned you," she said, in a deadly serious voice.

And it's important to understand this aspect of April, because it's one of the things I love most about her, but it's also the most difficult thing imaginable to manage. If I just told you what April *said*, and even if I just described the way she *looked* when she said it (eyes wide, mouth half-disbelieving), you would probably be inclined to laugh your ass off.

As am I.

But April is totally serious at moments like this.

"I think maybe I should have warned you," she tells me, totally serious. "Lilith is sometimes a little bit of a slut."

*

I managed not to laugh and we decided to go find a taxi. This ended up being remarkably easy, and in no time at all, we were headed back to the hotel, walking down the hall, fingers intertwined.

Sexual tension. Who can really say how it develops, especially between two people who have met, married, and lived together for a while. We didn't say anything to each other in the taxi.

I had an erection, but that had been going all night.

Once we were settled in the taxi, April looked over at me. And she just had that *look*. A look I hadn't seen in a long, long time. In fact, I'm going to venture that this specific look had never simmered on her face before. She gave me a smile. An inviting smile.

Inviting, inviting. Not, "come-have-a-hug-and-a-bit-of-tea" inviting. You know, *inviting*.

And then she looked out the window, the other way, still smiling, and slid her hand across the back seat to my thigh, and then inward. Her fingers moved up my bare flesh, taking the shorts with them, until she reached my boxers and tickled my balls with the pads of her fingers.

She looked back at me.

I edged in her direction. It was Mexico, so we weren't wearing seat belts, because that's the kind of thing you do there.

I looked in the rear-view mirror at the eyes of the cab driver. His eyes were on the road, and he kept them there, which was either reassuring or disconcerting, depending on how you think about it.

I put my hand on her thigh and moved my own fingers up her leg, up to where I expected to find her panties.

But did not.

This is the part of the story I keep going back to later, but for now, just suffice it to say that things were cooking in that back seat, and while the last thing on earth I expected to find when I reached up April's skirt was no panties, I just kept plowing ahead.

April rotated herself so she was leaning against the door and window, and then lifted her right foot to place it on my dick. She had let her shoe fall off. Her toes curled around the shape of my cock, while she brought her thumb to her mouth and bit on the nail, as if she were posing in a men's magazine.

But I didn't linger on that look for long, because her leg fell to the side, leaning against the back seat, and her red skirt slipped up her thighs,

exposing her bare pussy to me.

I stole another look at the rear-view mirror, to check on whether the cab driver was still driving, or if, somehow, he had been distracted by my wife's slit.

April had gotten a Brazilian wax for this trip, so nothing was there but the plush, baby-smooth outer lips of her pussy and a sweet, red slit that glistened in the lights that passed over her as we drove. Shadow, light, shadow, light, and in the pools of light, April's pussy, framed by her long pale legs and the rumpled red dress piled around her hips.

I moved my hand between her legs, eyes darting around, from her spread legs to her inviting smile, to the surroundings and the eyes of the taxi driver. We had left the town and were winding through the jungle and the resorts. We would be back at the hotel any minute now.

That didn't stop me from reaching, the best I could without shifting in the seat and calling attention from the driver, toward the slick crevice between her plump pussy lips. My fingers slid through her hot, sticky juices, gliding into the soft velvet of her slit and over the engorged knob of her clit. A shudder traveled through her, electrifying the air around us, squeezing precum from my cock, and forcing a soft, feathery gasp from between April's lips.

She looked down at my cock, where her foot was massaging me still, and her toes had encountered the wet evidence of my arousal. Her smile was gone, her eyes half-closed in pleasure, and the look on her face as she surveyed me was enough to make my cock throb against her foot.

The car had come to a stop. I had no idea for how long. When I glanced up at the rear-view mirror the driver averted his eyes quickly. "Here," he said, a frog in his throat.

I gave him 500 pesos for what appeared to be a Mex\$200 ride, and then began to climb out of the cab. April slipped her feet into her shoes, smiling with a flush across her cheeks, and we walked, holding hands, very quickly through the lobby and the courtyard, hurrying to our room.

*

I have to admit that at this point, my narration must rely on a foggy memory. The scene in the hotel room plays in my mind like a montage for a music video more than a sequence of events. April turned and walked backwards into the room while she did a strange little tease with her dress, that much I remember, because April is not a striptease kind of a girl. Her

hands moved side-to-side, playfully, with the hem of her dress in her fingers, while she walked backwards, smiling at me with that same inviting smile from the car.

She lifted the dress over her head, and tossed it away, and I was again struck by the absence of panties that had so shocked me in the taxi. She was naked from head to toe, still wearing her shoes, which I've embellished in my memory as heels but likely were not. Between her legs, her pussy shone with her excitement. I traced the origin of this shining arousal in my mind: was it from the cab ride? From her interactions with me? Or was it from the club, from the young man she had pretended to be Elena for?

My chest felt tight as I landed on this possibility, and then the sexual excitement of it began to seep into my veins. It seemed to be true, in fact: April, sweet spring-rainy April, had been red and swollen and wet before she had spread her legs for me in the taxi.

I was undressing while I was thinking about all of this, pulling at my clothes with over-excited fingers and the unsteadiness of a practiced drunk who still managed to have too much. April tossed herself onto the bed, leaving her shoes on, and stretched out seductively, propped up on her arm, eyes watching me with a hunger I hadn't seen in years.

"So how was that guy?" I remember venturing to ask, sometime before I climbed onto the bed. I remember regretting having said that, feeling the sinking sensation of having gone too far, opening the door of a fantasy that April didn't understand or share.

But to my surprise, April laughed and rolled so that she was propped up on both elbows, chest up, hair swishing behind her, mouth open and smiling in a strange delight that was unfamiliar to me. She tipped her head forward and looked at me, her legs parting as I climbed onto the bed between them, my cock erect and dripping with precum.

She was alternating, disarmingly, between looking serious and then looking as if she might suddenly become bashful, as if she couldn't decide whether to be herself, the April I knew, the April of blushes and slightly overdone modesty - or some other April. Perhaps Elena was her alter-ego, and now that she had been unearthed, I was in for a wild ride.

She giggled, and a faint pink stained her right cheek, and her right cheek only, momentarily. Half a blush. Another giggle. Her upper teeth sank into her ruby lip and she grinned. "He had a really... big... cock."

She began this sentence speaking, and finished whispering loudly. Then she looked at me, to see what I would think of that, the bashful April nowhere in her features.

"Oh yeah?" I choked out, edging toward her, still unable to fully comprehend that April, for all intents and purposes, appeared to be playing the very game I had hoped she would play. "How did you find that out?"

April moved her elbows to slide down to her back. She was propped up on the uneven pile of pillows behind her. She dragged her hand lazily to the center of her legs, and slipped her slim fingers into her open gash, finding her clit, and slowly stroking it.

"I could feel it," she said simply. "Against my ass, while we were grinding on the dance floor."

My stomach felt cold, and for a single moment - this I remember distinctly - I forgot every single word of the English language, and could only stare at her fingers through the gauzy memory of her dancing with that guy, while I tried to think of a succession of sounds that formed a word.

I guided my cock to her gash and moved it through the sopping, sticky flesh, pushing her fingers away to replace the motion of them with the stroking of the crown of my dick. Around the tip, her skin slurped like a wet kiss, and the hard knob of her clit - far larger than usual - darted away from the face of my cock as I slowly drew it through her flesh.

The following are things I am not sure whether I actually said, or only thought, because by this time my level of intoxication, between the booze and the arousal, was interfering with my memory. Evidently.

Did you want him to fuck you? Were you thinking about him putting that huge cock in your pussy and stretching it out? Tell me you were thinking about that. Are you going to think about that while I fuck you?

It wasn't an extremely long lovemaking session, of that I am sure. April came fast, shuddering beneath me, and I wasn't far behind. I don't know if I asked any of those questions, or if she answered them. The evening dissolved as I filled her engorged cunt with cum, and all I remember well is April smiling, smiling, that mischievous smile so unlike her, as her tits bounced and I drove myself deep inside of her.

CHAPTER 6

"Ohhhhh," April groaned. She rolled over onto her stomach and covered her head with a pillow. "Close it."

I pulled the drapes nearly closed, which alleviated the daggers of pain shooting through my eyes. "I can make us some Bloody Ma -" I began to say helpfully.

April waved a hand above her body at an angle that made it look like she required medical attention, and groaned. "I'm never drinking again."

I started making the Bloody Marys anyway. April doesn't drink a lot, and almost never that much. Me, on the other hand, I have some extensive experience with hangovers. A stabilizer is the best course of action.

This required a trip to the ice machine, so I peered down the hallway of Mike and Lilith's room, hoping to get some insight on what had happened to the sexy, slutty Lilith and her weirdo boyfriend. I couldn't remember anything about when they had disappeared, and I was left to wonder if Mike had accompanied her to wherever she had gone, to watch her with her young buck.

But the hallway, naturally, didn't give me any information about this.

I got some ice, and passed the hallway again, but this time, whistling, like some kind of demented character in a bad horror movie, I took a sharp left and walked down the hallway. I slowed as I approached their room.

I looked behind me: no one. No one around, nothing but balmy breezes, carrying the sound of palm trees, passing through the sections of the hallway that opened onto a courtyard like large windows. I was hidden from view, from the courtyard at least, by a wall.

Still, my heart was pounding as I paused, tried to talk myself out of it, gave another look behind me, and then leaned toward the door. I knew it was a pervy thing to do, so my palms were getting sweaty.

Closer.

Closer.

At last, my ear was against the door, and I was rewarded with exactly what I had secretly hoped to find but truly, really, not expected: Lilith emitting porn-quality moaning and panting, loudly enough that I could hear it clearly through the thick doors.

I pulled my ear away, but I could still hear her, and... I don't know. When do you decide you've heard enough of that kind of thing? I had no

idea. I had never expected to actually *hear* her.

I leaned my ear against the door and listened some more. Somewhere along the way my eyes dropped closed and I started to picture the scene: Lilith, riding that guy from the bar, her tits bouncing and rolling with the motion of her hips, to the rhythm of her moans.

But after a few seconds of conjuring the image of Lilith, the picture began to change, and I saw my own sweet April, grinding her small bottom into his balls, hips rolling forward, eyes glassy and mouth open, making the sounds that Lilith was making while I stared at her from the chair in the corner of the room. April, with her small breasts barely bouncing, a dried white film across her chest where that young stud had jerked off on her tits hours before....

Lilith began to moan and pant more loudly, more quickly, and I heard her voice form words: "Oh, oh, oh, oh, yes, fuck it into me, fuck me harder..."

I jerked my ear away from the door when I heard the low rumble of movement from within the room, the sound of furniture or a person being dragged or moved, and I almost tipped over the ice with the jolt of it.

I scurried down the hallway and back to my own room. My heart was pounding, my head was overflowing with filthy images of April and the soundtrack I had just heard from within the room, and my cock was aching.

I opened the door without knocking and practically tossed the ice on the small bar to the side of the bed. Dispensing with my usual foreplay, which at this point in our marriage was a little more perfunctory than either of us would probably like to admit, I shimmied out of my shorts, pulled the covers off April with flourish, and was crawling toward her before she even had time to turn and complain about me stealing the blankets.

She was naked, and this seemed to come as a surprise to her. She looked down at herself, then at my cock, which I was holding in my hand as I crawled toward her.

Her eyes widened in surprise, but then, as had happened the night before, sexual tension boiled immediately between us. She gave me a coquettish smile as I moved toward her, already finding her slit with my cock, already feeling the warm, wet kiss of her pussy on my crown, before I found her mouth with mine and began to swallow her lips.

She was slick and wet instantly, and I closed my eyes as I explored her mouth and felt the heat of her body encompass my dick in its velvety

wetness. In truth, I was hearing Lilith's wild, sexual screams, and thinking of the interior of April's pussy, still full of cum...

But I imagined that it was someone else's, that the Hands of last night had filled her up with his big cock, stretched her out, and that my cock now glided effortlessly through her, lubricated by his leftover cum.

So, with all that in mind, I was barely able to hang on until April came, and luckily for me, her body tensed beneath mine, and her legs squeezed my torso as she arched her back and yelled - a fair bit more of a performance than April usually treated me to. Her pussy had only just begun to pulse around my cock when I was gripped by my own thunderous orgasm.

I collapsed onto her soft body and breathed in the scent of her sweat, the pungent sweetness of fresh sex mingled with the leftovers of the night before.

At last, she pushed on me gently, and I rolled off of her.

"Wow," April said, pushing her hair back from her forehead. "What's gotten into *you*?"

I was still panting, hot, my skin burning off into the supercool air conditioning. I moved my hand along April's slick, sweat-soaked thigh and tried to catch my breath before talking.

Also, I couldn't really get a read on April: was she serious with this question?

Did she not remember last night well enough to know what had gotten into me? At all?

She couldn't have known I had stopped by Lilith's room to eavesdrop on her wild passion, or that I had imagined her in there with that bar guy, with her boyfriend watching.

But maybe the question was purely rhetorical.

I looked back up at April, to get a better idea of what she was really asking. She was looking blankly at the wall, her mind at work on something else entirely.

Another cool finger of jealousy worked its way through my chest.

April wasn't waiting for my answer. April was thinking of something else, and maybe *someone else*, entirely.

"What's gotten into *you*?" I asked. I tried to sound as playful as possible. To remind April that we'd had an adventure together last night, and

it had been fun, and I was still on board - totally on board - with a continuation of that... ambiance.

April seemed to not have heard me for a moment, so she was *very* preoccupied by something. Her eyes shifted suddenly, and she snapped her gaze down at me. "What?" she said, in that hurried, guilty way we all have when we were thinking about something we shouldn't be. "What? Oh, no, nothing."

I rolled onto my side now and gave her a disbelieving look. "What are *you* so lost in thought about?" I murmured.

I was getting hard again. I could hardly believe it. Was it April's guilty look? The fact that she was obviously thinking about something she didn't want to get caught thinking about, something she wasn't going to tell me?

"Nothing!" April said, almost as defensively as someone can say if they are an adult and not a five-year old child. She swung her legs over the bed and laughed stiffly. She pushed her hair from her face again and looked back at me. "Just thinking how I shouldn't have had that much to drink last night."

I reached for her arm and closed my fingers around it, pulling her gently so that her elbow bent and she had no choice but to fall toward me.

"That was hot last night," I said, really laying on my "sexy voice" as thick as I could without sounding silly. "*And* this morning."

April leaned toward me and gave me a quick kiss of the lips, before wrestling herself from my grip. It was the kind of thing April did when she was trying to shut down my advances. "So hot," she said, and then she was bouncing off the bed and scurrying into the bathroom.

I lay on the bed, staring at the ceiling.

Leave well enough alone, Thomas, I told myself. You had a good time, you had hot sex with your wife, twice in like ten hours, everything is good, you have some nice material to masturbate to, and you should really shut the fuck up.

I put my hands behind my head to prove to everyone how relaxed I was and how I was going to calmly mind my own advice and shut up and not be an idiot.

April started a shower and stayed in the bathroom for a very long time. When she came out, she was wrapped in a towel.

"I went by Lilith and Mike's room on the way to the ice machine," I heard myself say.

What the fuck, Thomas? What are you doing? a voice in my head shrieked.

This comment didn't seem to register much with April one way or the other. I could have been telling her I had seen a Mexican kid selling Chicle last night. In fact, her reactions was *a lot* like I had actually said something to that effect.

"Uh, huhn," April said vaguely, pawing through her suitcase for something.

"I heard some *very* interesting things coming out of that room."

I really don't know when to stop sometimes.

Most of the time, I am a dude who is control of myself. I'm the guy who tells everyone to calm down when the shit-talking gets overheated at the pool hall, and I always let April have the last word on any argument. Like Trucker Dan says: you wanna to be right, or you wanna be happy?

It's good advice.

But every now and then, this little devil inside of me starts doing shit like this.

Flicking the bear.

Barking at a dog through a fence.

This kind of thing.

So I heard myself say that, and half of me was horrified. The other part of me was kind of smirking, but luckily that part of me has learned not to *actually* smirk. Not outwardly.

April's reaction was not what I expected. My stomach was already doing flips and I was already feeling bad about whatever she was going to say to me, when *instead*, her eyes went wide and she smiled - a little.

"Oh, yeah?" she said, diffidently, as if she didn't care, but I could see that she did care. She was curious. She wanted to hear more.

You know, of course, that there really wasn't much more to tell. But I did it anyway.

"I think Lilith took that guy home with her to the room," I said.

April looked over at me and pushed on the lid of her suitcase. "Where would Mike have gone?" She asked this casually, not as part of an interrogation, the way I would have expected. This was not, "where-would-Mike-have-gone,-idiot?-So -your-idea-is-stupid" tone.

It was more like: "Hmmm-and-what-do-you-imagine-Mike-was-doing-while-she-did-that,-give me-your-naughty-thoughts" tone.

Or at least I thought so. You know guys aren't exactly geniuses at hearing what's actually being implied.

But I digress. Betting on the positive possibility, I said: "I think he's in there, too."

If what you're thinking now, because you've been reading careful and consider me a trustworthy narrator, is: Thomas, you have no way of knowing that, and you're just making shit up, you are correct.

But this is where the undying hope of the male mind becomes... shall we say... unstoppable. I started to really believe these things I was saying. It didn't matter, I figured, because I presumed that April wasn't about to go have a *chat* with Lilith about what I had heard from Lilith's hotel room while eavesdropping on her.

Was she?

Didn't matter.

April looked pleased, and impressed, and embarrassed, all at once.

"How would you know a thing like *that*?" she said.

This was a very logical question, a skeptical one, a perfectly reasonable one.

But April wasn't asking it with the tone of voice that indicated that she wanted me to admit defeat, or argue my case so she could tear it all down.

Her voice had more of the "tell me a story" quality.

I shrugged, and grinned.

And then, *even though it was not true*, I said: "I heard two male voices behind the door."

Which I immediately pretty much believed. In the way I believed in Santa Claus when I was six. It was more of a, "it'd be great if it were true" kind of thing.

April's mouth fell open, and for a second it seemed like she was just being a bad actress. She closed her mouth. She shook her head. She walked back toward the bathroom, underwear and bra in hand. "Well... I guess I wouldn't put it past her," she said. "Lilith does *a lot* of crazy shit."

I let this marinate for a moment, both within myself and also with my wife.

My heart was beating so rapidly at this point that it felt a little uncomfortable. A few thoughts wandered through my mind, and one of them was that having a cardiac event in a third-world country was probably

unwise. But this seemed like the opportunity I had never even imagined actually materializing.

"About that..." I said, gently, and I heard April begin to brush her teeth. I waited, because she never hears anything I say to her when she's brushing her teeth. I normally chose to say things I'd rather she *didn't* hear in detail at those moments.

April popped her head out of the bathroom, still brushing.

"Whuht?" she prompted, through the foaming paste. She brushed, I was caught off guard and stared at her. Just as I was about to speak, she decided she needed to spit and ducked back in.

After the rinse, I dove in. "About Lilith," I said. "She does seem pretty wild..."

"She is," April assured me, back to her business-like preparation of herself. Her hair was down and she was holding up the sundress she'd chosen.

"But you guys are best friends," I said suggestively.

April let the towel around her waist drop to the floor and I was treated to a long look at her lithe body, tan lines impishly creeping across her back and over her bottom, a transparent, pale swimsuit over her only-slightly darkened skin. Her black hair was in wild disarray from her rubbing it dry with the towel, and it gave her a very sexy combination of cleanliness and mussiness.

The sundress fell over her body.

"We're not really *best* friends," April said, turning around, underwear in hand. She bent over to step into them and pulled them up beneath the dress with a tactical proficiency I found admirable: April could fully dress and undress out of anything without ever showing her butt or boobs. "Just *old* friends."

"But you guys play this game together. You played that a lot?"

April paused, fluffing her dress a little to make sure it hadn't gotten caught on any part of her underwear. She gave me a smile. Then she rolled her eyes. "That was a long, long time ago."

She headed back to the bathroom with her makeup bag. "But I never played that game quite as, uh... all-in, I guess you would say, as Lilith."

"Never?" I asked.

Something snapped closed in the bathroom, a makeup compact or something feminine like that. A long pause ensued, while I sat, heart racing,

wondering about the length of April's silence. Had she just painted her lips, and was now rubbing them together, tapping the corners of her mouth with her pinky finger in her strange lipstick-applying ritual? Or was she frowning at my question, beginning to become annoyed with me and my perverse questioning?

Or was she hiding something, keeping a secret with a wry smile, and about to saunter out of the bathroom and sit on my lap, to tell me about all the dirty times she had acted *just like Lilith*, before slowly edging my now-reinvigorated cock past her lacy panties and into her wet, engorged pussy?

"Are you going to come to breakfast with me or what?" she asked, and I could tell by the way she pronounced that sentence that she was applying mascara, with her mouth open wide like all women seemed to do.

Ah.

She was none of those things. She was hungry.

CHAPTER 7

We ate breakfast at the restaurant in the resort that served it almost all day long for the over-indulgent, like ourselves. April's mood seemed less playful by the passing minute, because she really was hungover, and after a few clarifying freshly squeezed orange juices and a Bloody Mary made by an actual bartender, I was stabilized enough to tell myself to leave well enough alone - for now.

We went to the beach after changing into swimsuits and April stretched out on a lounge in the shade and fell asleep.

I headed to the bar, because sitting around on a beach in the heat is not really my thing. I had been hoping Lilith's boyfriend would be a more sporty guy, who wanted to try windsurfing or kite surfing, so I would have something to do while Lilith and April had their girly catch-up time. But Mike was pretty content to just sit on the beach, eyes hidden behind his sunglasses, and say nothing while knocking back what I considered a very minimal amount of beer.

This was an all-inclusive resort, after all. Might as well take advantage.

There was no sign of Lilith or Mike for hours, and April seemed zonked, so I started putting them away and chatting with the bartender. We exchanged the usual crossfire about how it wasn't the worst job in the world, serving drinks on the beach to ladies in bikinis. I noted with satisfaction that his eyes occasionally wandered appraisingly to my wife.

So I got pretty boozed-up, and didn't notice Lilith or Mike when they emerged from the palms that lined the pools closest to the beach and approached April, or when they sat down with her, or any of the events that transpired prior to the bartender grinning, jutting his chin very discretely in the direction of April's tree, and saying, in a low but audible, heavy-accented voice, "Now that, is a okay *vista*."

I looked over my shoulder to see April sitting up, with Lilith behind, her legs spread wide over both sides of the lounge, her hips very nearly hugging April's. April had her hair up in her hand, and her body rocked lightly as Lilith spread white lotion over her back.

In case my descriptions of her haven't conveyed this yet, Lilith is one of those hyper-sexual people, whose every gesture and movement seems to have gone missing from a porno and ended up in her body. So when I say she was rubbing this lotion into April's skin, there was a definite, B-grade

porno quality to the way she was doing it, hands lingering just a little too long, hips grinding into April's small bottom with just a little too much force as she worked the lotion in. Lilith's lips were moving, and it seemed she was whispering very close to April's shoulder blades, with her head tilted to the side, long blond hair flowing just a breath away from her left thigh, where it would caress April's bare waist with every movement of the ocean breezes.

It looked as if Lilith were trying to talk April into something, chanting behind her, so near to her skin. April had a partial smile on her lips and was looking out to sea with an expression similar to the lost-in-thought face she had made that morning.

Mike was sitting at the end of the lounge, body facing the bar, but arm crossed over his chest to reach for Lilith's back. He seemed absorbed in listening to her as well, while his fingers played absently over Lilith's back, in circles, in long streaks with a single finger, then back again.

It was an erotic scene, even though I'm not so much into girl-on-girl action. The eroticism for me came from wondering what it was that Lilith was saying, with her pouty, overripe lips so close to April's skin, that might make my wife smile in that very peculiar way that she was smiling.

They began to move, April turning toward the bar. I turned back to the bartender, who was grinning appreciatively, and lifted my beer slightly as a light toast. He went back to what he was doing, whistling happily.

"You let me bake out there." April's voice was throaty and sexy, sleepiness and hangover having dropped it to a low timbre and a slutty worn-sounding dryness. "I need a water."

I turned toward her, as though I hadn't seen her for hours or expected her at the bar. She leaned back against the bar, on two elbows, facing the lounge where I presumed Mike and Lilith were still slathering each other in sunscreen and filthy words.

April's skin was damp and shiny, and her face flushed with midday, tropical heat. But more importantly than that, the way she was standing, leaning against the bar like that, was not the body language of my wife. I had never seen her do anything like that. Her breasts were thrust forward, tantalizing droplets of sweat beading up on them until they burst and rolled over her taut skin, disappearing into her black swimsuit fabric, or sometimes into the smooth crevice between her breasts.

She had shifted half of her hair to hang over one shoulder and was looking at me. The odd little smile lingered somewhere on her face, but it moved like a darting fish, appearing and then making me question whether I had seen it.

It was unsettling; arousing, because it was yet again hinting at some sexual, different thing that lay dormant in April and which I had never suspected to be there, and disturbing, for much the same reason.

I ordered her a water and watched her as she stretched her legs, first one, then the other, with a feline luxuriousness. A droplet of sweat beaded up on her inner thigh and snaked down her leg, absorbing into sweet oblivion at the back of her knee. I had the visceral sensation of tasting the coconut-scented saltiness of the back of her damp knee, and the feel of her body squirming beneath me when I did.

She turned when the water arrived, and gulped it with profane elegance, all in one go, but without spilling any over her lips or making a single sound.

"You want something to drink?" I asked her.

The plastic glass was between her thumb and middle finger, and she pinged it with her pointer finger, looking at me between slightly narrowed eyes. A smattering of sand was brushed across her right cheek, and the afternoon glare from the water was lighting her violet eyes with the color and shiftiness of the sea.

"I, uh, meant... like, a real drink," I stammered, as if this was a woman I had just met at the bar five minutes ago and not my wife. I shifted on the bar stool I was perched on in an attempt to accommodate and hopefully hide my erection.

She turned her attention to the bartender. "Can I get one more water?" she asked sweetly. When she turned her eyes back to me, the bartender gave me an impressed and encouraging look.

"So Lilith," she said, turning her body slightly, one arm on the bar, and looking past me to where she had been napping, "brought that guy back here, totally, and he's in her room right now. Passed *out*."

She confided this to me with a sort of drab indifference and ended with a little smile that literally could have meant anything at all. I was completely unsure of what I was supposed to say or do: was this somehow an invitation? Would this strange creature next to me say something like, "we should borrow him?"

Or what?

I had no idea. April was not being April, and I was in free-fall, half delighted, but equally screaming in quiet fear inside my chest.

There was a long moment in which nothing was said, and April seemed to have fallen into a rabbit-hole again, her red lips aflutter with a smile and scowl that moved like the waves on the ocean, overlapping, no boundary between them.

I ordered two margaritas, for lack of any better idea.

April turned to take her water from the bartender and sipped it, then reached for the straw of the margarita without comment when it appeared in front of her. She brought the slush-caked tip to her mouth and sucked it clean, while I stared, adrift in my own wild thoughts.

"I wonder what they'll do with him," she mused, almost to herself.

I looked behind me, back to her lounge chair, and saw that Mike had claimed it for himself, propped it up at an angle, crossed his legs, and reclined, hands folded over his tacky Hawaiian shirt. Lilith was gone, and a quick scan of the beach did not locate her - and she was easy to pick out.

"Lilith's not there," I told April, when I turned back to the bar.

April looked over her shoulder and seemed mildly surprised. When she turned back to me, she put her head in her hand and pushed her black hair over her shoulder again. Her hair had a beachiness to it, but April's hair seems to have sneaked into her lineage via some random, long-ago tryst with a relative of Genghis Khan: it is oriental in character, and never forms waves. She could have walked out of a hairdresser's ten minutes ago.

Her eyes were lit up again. "That's weird," she said quietly.

Again, I found myself without a single guide in this world or any other for what to say. "What is?"

April smiled a little again. This smile was somewhat mischievous. "I just got the impression that... you know. Mike liked to watch."

In my gut, above my stomach and below my heart, I felt like a snake of Icy Hot was being released into my organs.

April repeated her straw airlift of margarita to her lips, and then looked at me as she closed them around the tip of the straw.

Now, if April had done this twenty-four hours before, I would have sworn up and down she was doing it in that naive, carelessly sexual way of hers. With no idea that it might arouse me, or anyone else who watched it.

But now? I didn't know.

I made a weird, uncomfortable laughing sound, because I was now in this odd place where I felt like I was talking to a woman I had just met, in some ways, and in others, I was beginning to think I could confide in my wife about my *own* ideas.

But hadn't I already done that?

Perhaps I was getting the feeling that I could do *more* than that.

Either way, I was also having a hard time breathing like a normal human being. I felt high: the air seemed to ring like a bell around me.

"They're so *casual* about it, too," April confided, dipping into her margarita again.

I cleared my throat. "Is this... like... new to you? Did you never know this about Lilith?"

April kind of rolled her eyes as she turned to me. "I always *suspected*, I just didn't think that like... there were guys out there like, you know... Mike." She thought about something for a second, with that far-off look in her eyes, and then leaned toward me to say softly, "Like, what do you think he like, does? While she's... you know.... doing it?"

This was more like April. She was actually at a complete loss about how this kind of thing might work. "Doing it," uttered a little bashfully, was something the woman I had married would say.

But the question was dangerous for me, because it required an answer. To say I didn't know would be a lie: I knew because I dedicated a great deal of time to researching that very topic on the internet on a regular basis. I knew because I knew what *I* would do, and I knew that I would jump at the chance to do it.

I also couldn't tell April any of that, unless I felt like taking a very big risk. And at that moment, I was not fully sure which direction April was headed with this.

My stomach churned with cold fear and heated passion, and the weight on my chest seemed to grow exponentially.

"I think, uh, like... a lot of guys are into that," I said. My voice left me like I had severe flu, in staccato breaths that barely had enough force to complete the words.

April didn't seem to hear any of that.

Her eyes went wide. "A lot?" she asked. She was truly mystified.

The anticipation of her next question had already been activated in my nervous system. The hair on the back of my neck and arms was already

raised, my heart already drowning out the ocean in my ears, and my breath trapped in the freezing pain of drowning by the time this exchange even started:

"I'm pretty sure."

And a pause, the roar of the ocean, the glittering of the sea in her eyes. I began to fall long before she said:

"Are *you*? Like, but *actually*."

It was entirely possible, I had realized that morning, that April had forgotten the things we had said and done the night before. Or had, at the very least, had those memories put into a blender of drunkenness. Perhaps her reasons for being so turned on the night before had nothing to do with my fantasies, and everything to do with her own: pretending to be someone else, for instance.

The question seemed as if she had some sense that she was really asking for clarification about something she thought she already knew, but even so, I felt incredibly exposed there in the sun under the glare of April's questioning eyes. I faltered, unable to say yes or no for a long time, trying to weigh the consequences of saying one thing or another.

I averted my eyes, because hers were, in that moment, too intense.

"I, uh..." I began. "Well..."

When I looked back at her to see how she was taking this - the possibility of me saying yes - searching for signs of revulsion, or thrill, or anything to guide me to what I should say next, her eyes were glued to my face and penetrating.

She seemed to really want to know, but she was also not giving me a clue as to what she hoped I would say.

She was waiting. I had to say something.

"I mean... it's like, sort of a turn-on, the idea of it," I said lamely.

April nodded, as if I had just said something she totally agreed with and the matter could be put to rest. "Like for fun," she affirmed to herself. "In theory. But not *really*." She turned and picked up her margarita.

My hopes were dashed, and I began to accept my fate.

"I wonder," April mused, "if I could actually do it."

I was flying again.

The bartender, whose English was clearly only good enough for him to think he had heard this conversation correctly, but not be entirely sure, was staring openly at us. He made himself busy as soon as I turned his way.

"Is that something you would want to do?" I asked April, making an effort to sound bemused and casual.

She shot me a look and laughed stiffly. Then she rolled her eyes and sort of sniffed. "Not... God, no, not with like..."

Then she smiled, as if she had just keyed in on some joke. Which was disturbing, because I had no idea what that "joke" might be.

"Oh, I get it," she said, smiling. Suddenly flirtatious she swiveled toward me again, and grinned. She gave her hair a toss. "So, who would you want me to do this with, you think? If you had to choose?" She waved her hand vaguely in the direction of the resort, the pools, the throngs of people at the swim-up bar.

April clearly was not taking this seriously and she thought now that we were playing a silly game. Which was, I was beginning to think, as close as I would ever get to my fantasy. Also, I was drunk again. So I plowed ahead. "Well, what about Mr. Big Package from last night?" I suggested.

"So young," April said coquettishly, making my cock pulse with renewed energy and mild pain. She brought another strawful of margarita to her lips and sucked at it seductively. "I wonder if he has the chops I'm looking for."

This burned right through me, but I kept it together. "Aha," I said casually. "You're looking for someone a little more *seasoned*, then?"

April smiled and plunged her straw into her margarita, sliding the whole drink closer to herself. With the plastic straw between her teeth, she said, "Not *overly* seasoned, of course." She sucked up some margarita. "And... yeah, well... maybe with that kind of equipment it wouldn't matter so much."

She grinned impishly, her long eyelashes, which she hadn't curled or applied mascara too, fluttering almost to her cheekbone. They were straight and longer than seemed possible, and like this they gave her a doe-like appearance that was sexy as hell. Especially when she was saying stuff like this.

I was just getting into this when April seemed to fall right out of it. "You know, I'm actually really surprised that you're being so... you know... cool about Lilith."

This sentence had come out of nowhere, and so I sat there digesting it for a few seconds in silence.

"Huh?" I finally said.

April shrugged. The brief flirt-ification of her personality seemed to be evaporating, and she was back to being her old self.

It was maddening.

I became aware of my level of drunkenness as I thought about her sudden mood changes - maybe it was just me, veering from one emotional extreme to the other, because I'd had too much to drink.

"It's just that I've had... like, I don't know. Past boyfriends haven't always liked Lilith very much. They got a little, like, not *jealous*, but sort of possessive, or... yeah, I don't know what the word is. They just didn't really want me hanging out with her so much."

"Really," I said, the disbelief dripping from my tone. "Tell me about this."

I perversely liked hearing about ex-boyfriends. Very much. I had always secretly hoped that April would have some kind of dark secret lurking in her closet, for all the same reasons I liked the idea of April with another man.

April giggled and sucked up some more margarita - she was now nearing the bottom of the glass and getting fairly tipsy herself. I held up a finger in the direction of the bartender and pointed at her drink, all without breaking more than a second of eye contact.

"No, I don't want to get into any details... I mean, there's nothing to tell, really. Just... oh, you know, like Rob would get really annoyed any time I was going out with her - this was when Lilith still lived in town - and he'd call like, every half hour and then do stupid things, like make up some big emergency for me to come home early. Stuff like that."

"Huh," I said. Rob was April's most recent boyfriend, the only man she'd lived with other than me. I loved to hear about Rob, though April didn't tell me the stories I really wanted to hear.

"I think she made them nervous," April continued. "Like... she was going to corrupt me or something."

These words curled like a silky fist around my cock and practically started jerking me off.

"Uhn," is the closest approximation to the sound I made.

"Which was silly," April said, suddenly very chatty. The bartender put a second margarita in front of her and she took the straw from the old one out and stabbed it into the new one without any commentary on where the new one had come from. "Just because... you know, Lilith's been my friend

for-ev-er. If she was going to corrupt me, she would have done it a *long* time ago. You know? Anyway..." she fluttered her eyes at me. "Thanks for being so... you know. Cool about everything. Making a game out of it and stuff."

There was another Earth, somewhere, out there in the vast reaches of the universe, where everything was exactly the same as this Earth, except that Thomas Roberts on that Earth grabbed April at this moments and shook her, yelling, "Don't you understand I'm not joking, April?!"

Thomas Roberts of this real world just sat there, squinting, wondering how to turn the tide on April's sexual flirtatiousness, which seemed headed out to sea.

But it was April who was pulled back to me, maybe by the forces of the moon. She looked behind her at Lilith's still-empty lounge chair, at the evidently sleeping Mike, who did not seem to care that his girlfriend was back in their hotel room with another man. Then she turned her eyes back to me.

"Well, I guess Lilith's... busy. Typical." She said this with some annoyance. She brought the margarita to her lips and lifted it from the bar. "Want to go sit by the pool bar? Maybe we'll have more fun there."

She was already set in motion, headed in that direction.

So what could I do?

I followed.

CHAPTER 8

I'm not entirely clear on how the exchange went on the way to the pool bar. April was ahead of me, margarita in hand, occasionally spilling a little every time she turned back to look at me. "You want to sit on opposite sides?" is what I think she said. I am sure it was her idea: I had pretty much bitten my tongue off, literally biting on the end of my tongue to remind myself that I was drunk, out in deep waters I didn't know very well, and I needed to shut the hell up.

But I must have agreed to that plan, and agreed in a way that was satisfactory to April, because when I settled in on a stool, I was at one end of the bar, submerged in lukewarm pool water, and April was at the other end.

She set her margarita down and dipped herself into the water, leaning her head back to wet her hair. Of course. She must have been exceedingly hot at that point, after lounging on the hot beach. There were a handful of people around the bar - two couples, and one single, but very old guy, so as far as flirting went, it didn't look too promising.

Except for the bartender, a lithe, dark-skinned guy with a great deal of black hair in a Disney-prince haircut, with one lock persistently falling from his carefully mussed 'do to the center of his forehead, which he tossed back into place with a practiced jerk of his head whenever the fancy struck him. He was wearing the resort uniform of green polo shirt and khakis, but his ripped, young physique was evident even beneath the cotton weave.

He went to April like a moth to a flame, and leaned on the bar to talk to her.

April spoke just loudly enough, for a quick moment, for me to hear her silly accent. She smiled and ran her finger along the edge of her margarita glass as she spoke to the bartender, lowering her voice so that I could only hear the distant purr of it, and try to imagine what she was saying with her wide, wet smile.

"You here alone?" the man next to me barked, in a nasal, East Coast accent. He spoke at the quick clip of a New Jersian or New Yorker. He leaned closer to me, without looking at me, and lifted a meaty hand with resignation, pointing lazily at the bartender before dropping his hand, as if it were too heavy to hold up for so long. "You're gonna get half as many

drinks from this guy," he confided. "Real ladies' man. If you have a wife, I'd ask her to get down here, just to get some service."

The bartender was smiling when he turned away from April and began to fish the ingredients for her beverage from behind the bar. I noted with mild alarm that her previous margarita was almost finished.

Which meant April would be good and toasted.

For a moment the thought lingered inside of me. I wasn't sure if it was good or bad.

"Heh," the guy said. "Never mind what I said. Now that *she's* here, we'd do better at another bar."

I suppressed the inclination to tell this guy that the hottie who would steal all the bartender's attention *was* my wife and stared at her instead. She was deliberately not looking at me, with a little smile on her lips as she sipped the final drops of margarita from her glass by dropping them onto her tongue from the straw.

The bartender, indeed, ignored most of the patrons to take the drink to April and lean on his elbows and chat with her.

It hit me at that moment, like a slap in the face: this was probably what happened *whenever* April was out by herself. I had just assumed things unfolded when she was alone the same way they did when I was out with her, but that was stupid, I could see just then.

Of course men hit on April. Men hit on April all the time.

I felt a wave of nausea, a flick of regret - I couldn't help thinking that I had somehow opened a Pandora's box, and now I couldn't close it.

As I sat there watching April, who gathered her wet hair to one side and squeezed water from it, so that rivulets of shining water snaked down her skin, over her breasts, down her side, riding over the faintly visible bumps of her ribcage to the curve of her waist, where they were taking one of two paths: to her navel, where they would pool in her belly-button, or down to her hip. I was sure Johnny Bartender was enjoying either path, following them with his eyes, imagining his own fingers, then his mouth, taking the same journey.

April was smiling as she did this, talking to the bartender with a veneer of innocence glazed over her features, and another cruel knot developed in my abdomen: April *knew* what she was doing now, because she had been told *by me* to do exactly that. She knew, and she was doing it deliberately, which led me to this thought: perhaps the innocence that I had imagined in

all of April's gestures and expressions was only that: a gloss over something more worldly, more flirtatious, more dangerous. What if April, the flirting April at the bar right now, was not an act that I had conjured with my request, but the April who had always been there? April probably looked just like this when men flirted with her and I wasn't around. Sure, maybe she didn't wring her wet hair out for most guys, letting sparkling droplets wander all over her body in this alluring way, but was that because April didn't flirt, or because she wasn't usually sitting in a pool talking to hot guys when I wasn't there?

I heard her laugh, silvery and welcoming, the exact kind of invitational laugh that men assume is like a welcome mat. The hairs at the back of my neck prickled.

"Yeah," the guy next to me said. "He's reeling that one in. I'm off to the bar by the beach. You would be too, if you want another drink."

"I'll take my chances," I mumbled, without taking my eyes off my wife.

In my peripheral vision, I could see the old guy's eyes crinkle in amusement. He gave April an appreciative look, sighed, and set off for other parts.

At this point, April was playing with her straw, her fingers delicately pinching the end of it, stroking a few inches of its length, lips hovering just above the tip, her eyes on the bartender, absorbing whatever he was saying, limpid violet and glittering with interest.

Another punch landed on my chest plate. How long had it been since April had looked at me like this? It was the sort of look pornographic magazines tried to get hovering over a mouth full of cock, the kind of look that every man desired. And here was April, who I had assumed was so innocent of any *knowledge* about the power of that expression, bringing it to life as with the mastery of a high-end prostitute.

The bartender had to excuse himself, and April gave him an inviting smile, closing her lips around the straw, seemingly aware that such an image would burn through his cornea, and mine. Only after he had turned - smirking with a level of self-satisfaction that made me want to smack him - did April slowly, painfully, draw her eyes away from him as if it hurt to do so. An ache grew in my chest as she moved her eyes, drawing them over my heart like a red-hot wire as she did, and then finally, finally, met mine.

She then smiled, straw still in her mouth, and *shrugged*.

The shrug, I supposed, was meant to convey that she didn't know what she had done, or that she was surprised it had been so easy. But in my mind, it became a much darker thing: a shrug that meant she was unable to help who she was, that it wasn't her fault that an unstoppable, sexual monster lived within her, and wasn't I sorry I had let it out?

The bartender was doing something with what seemed like four glasses at once when he gave me a chin-nod. "What can I get you?" he asked.

I grumbled something about a beer, and he almost nodded, so who knew if I'd get one or not? Whatever. I just wanted to see what April would do next, and I was trying hard not to stare at her.

Aroused? Sure, I was. That was the only thing stopping me from wading around the bar and grabbing my wife's arm and getting her out of there.

Well, that and trust, right? Because April was my wife, and I trusted her, and we were just playing a game, right?

I would love to be able to say that, but the truth is a little murkier. Because April's expertise at flirting was unnerving me. I hadn't expected her to jump into it with quite so much... gusto, sure, but also... *skill*.

So I sat there watching her for the next half hour or so, and the bartender did, eventually, park a beer in front of me. I watched as April tilted her head to the side, and touched her lips a little too often, and played with her straw, and dipped back into the pool to cool herself off and wring more snaking rivers of glistening water over her body. I listened to her laugh, the low reverberations of her voice that gave me no clue what she was saying. I watched until the bartender put his fingers on her forearm while taking her order, playing with her skin, saying something in his low, accented voice, very close to her ear.

After he did this, April met my eyes again - or at least, where she might have imagined my eyes were, because I had tapped my sunglasses onto the bridge of my nose to not look like I was staring as much as I was. She brought her thumb between her teeth, like some kind of trashy, sexy picture in which a wildly stupid-looking girl tries to imitate thoughtfulness.

And then, she shrugged again.

Inside my torso, cold jealousy and hot arousal rose and fell, colliding like the bubbles of a lava lamp, making liquid, lukewarm bubbles of nausea grow somewhere in my abdomen. The whole time my dick just thickened and pulsed, even there in the water, until my balls ached.

As a result, I sat there, motionless, and probably expressionless, too. When I remember this whole scene, I often picture myself sitting there, looking a little like the Unibomber sketches, except holding a beer in my fist so tight it would have broken, had it been made of glass.

I'm not sure how long this moment lasted. Memory is a fickle mistress, sometimes exactly what you want it to be, sometimes raw and real. Sometimes, when I think of that moment, it stretched on forever, while the bartender finished up his shift. Maybe hours. And April just sat there, smiling her little smile, drinking her drink, and looking at me whenever she wasn't looking at him.

I didn't know what she wanted me to do, and so I did nothing.

April smiled at him, and then at me, and left the bar, wading over to the stairs behind her. As she rose from the water, her bikini bottoms riding high on her ass, revealing almost all of her smooth rounded bottom, she looked over her shoulder with a smile.

It was impossible to know who she was smiling at.

And then, quite suddenly, *he* was leaving. A new bartender had come, and he was clapping him on the shoulder. April had disappeared down a walkway, obscured by foliage. And now the bartender was disappearing in that direction as well.

The new bartender, a round-faced and jovial man, shorter than me and pot-bellied, placed a beer in front of me. "I'm Luis!" he yelled cheerfully. "I keep the drinks coming." And then he made his way down the bar, getting everyone seated another one of whatever they were having, whether they asked for it or not.

Numb, I thanked Luis, who doubtlessly didn't hear me, and fished an unknown amount of cash from my shirt pocket, leaving whatever absurd denomination of notes for Luis as a tip. Then I almost fell as I dismounted my stool, and I waded toward the same staircase that April had ascended. I looked like a fool, I'm sure: wading with an erection and a shirt on in a huge hurry while wasted is probably not any man's best look, but I hadn't thought clearly about what I was doing.

I was more like a lemming, or something equally senseless, following my wife in the direction she had gone, my heart empty and cold, my dick hard as stone.

It was upon feeling the rough stone that lined the pool area upon my feet that I remember my shoes, sitting on the edge of the pool on the other

side of the bar. Mustering as much dignity as I could, I walked back behind the bar, stuffed my feet into them, and walked back to the passage April had disappeared through. Sort of speed-walking. I'm sure it was a sight.

This foliage-enhanced pathway led to an intersection, where one path led to the hotel, and to the right, to the beach. Straight ahead, the path ended after a few yards at a gate which read: "Staff Only" in English only.

An air conditioner kicked in as I sat there contemplating my next move. They were gone, and there were no wet footprints leading me in one direction or another.

I gave the sign a withering look, as a complete fantasy about April sneaking into some dark maintenance room and getting fucked senseless against a wall flashed, condensed but painful, through my head. I turned toward the beach.

She was nowhere on the beach, at least not in the immediate vicinity, and so I walked even more quickly in a large circle, back to where we had left Mike. But Mike was gone and the lounge inhabited by new people, and a new bartender was tending the beach bar, where the man from New Jersey was still drinking, as he had promised to do.

A film rendition of this moment would have some kind of tunnel effect and dramatic music to indicate a sense of falling toward my own death.

I speed-walked back to the pool bar. I'm not sure why. My eyes searched everywhere for a sign of April, but there were no slender, porcelain-skinned women with black hair anywhere on this resort. No nubile limbs, which might now be wrapped around a Mexican bartender.

Luis saw me and waved. "Hey, you back for your money? You leave me too much man, come here."

Numbly, I sat on the edge of the pool after discarding my shoes in a heap. I sank into the water and waded over to my old seat.

I had left Luis one thousand pesos, which, I agreed with equal numbness, was not what I had meant. He fetched me another beer but told me to take it easy. He gave me back some of the tip, and I stuffed it listlessly into my shirt without counting it. I sat in my own lava lamp of misery and erotic fantasy, vaguely making sounds with my mouth in response to his jokes and questions, but my mind was behind the "Staff Only" door, where in a cool, cement hallway, April was getting filled with Mexican cock.

How long?

Who knows.

My mind was turning over every single thing April had done since we had arrived in Mexico, turning each event into a razor, cutting myself carefully in the heart with it, pouring into my wounds the salt of my fantasies about what April was doing just then.

These fantasy thoughts were almost entirely visual: April with her lips closed around the bartender's fat prick, bobbing and slurping enthusiastically, on her knees, tits sprung earlier from her bikini. A last spurt of cum falling in a pearly rope across her breasts, pooling on her nipples.

The sun had begun to set, or maybe it already had, when April appeared, hair dry, a fresh sundress on, makeup applied, eyes searching the pool area. When she saw me, she looked momentarily surprised, and then she walked - a little poorly, because she was drunk, over to the part of the bar that jutted up to a sunken row of stools on land.

I watched her descend the steps, legs first, then swishing dress.

"Why are you still here?" she called to me, laughing. "It's almost dinner time. We have a reservation at that Italian place. I'm starving."

She was smiling, the way April had always smiled.

But now, it sliced a trail of cold, aroused, jealous pain through my chest.

April tipped her head to the side. "Come *on*," she said. "I've been looking for you *everywhere*."

CHAPTER 9

I was pretty wasted, so there is some lack of clarity about what happened next. April fished me out of the pool, and I distinctly remember her taking me by the hand, along the same passageway of tropical plants, to the t-intersection where I had lost sight of her.

I also remember making out with her in the breezy hallway to our room, insisting that she come back to the room with me to change. And that she declined, smiling, pushing my hands away, using the excuse that everyone was probably there, waiting for us. I was instructed to take a shower, get dressed, and get to dinner. I was reminded several times "at the *Italian* place," in the tone of voice April uses when I am drunk and likely to forget things.

"What happened?" I kept asking, fingers working their way up her dress, making it only so far, and then being pushed away playfully. "Where did you go?"

April didn't say. She just laughed and kept urging me toward the hotel room. She checked to make sure I had a key. She repeated that I was to meet them at the Italian restaurant. And so it went, a haze of drunken, fumbling requests and April waving me off with a smile, but never answering my question.

"Why won't you tell me what happened?" I said, a little angrily, as my mood swung with the whims of my alcohol level.

April leaned in and said quietly, "Because if I keep it a secret, you won't pass out and miss dinner." The devious smile had returned to her face.

I supposed she was right.

*

I was disappointed to see that Mike and Lilith were seated at the table with my wife, but we had, after all, come to this resort specifically for Lilith and April to hang out. I had taken a cold shower to sober up and cool down, metaphorically speaking, though it had not made too much of a dent in either of those conditions.

Lilith was wearing a scandalous dress, which was decidedly against the dress code, but I doubted women like Lilith were ever given any feedback about the appropriateness of their clothing by men, and it was only men who staffed the Italian restaurant that evening. It was red and looked like it had been crocheted with a giant needle, leaving more holes than fabric for

her tanned skin to peek through. She was not wearing underwear, or a bra, and while the maker of the dress had fashioned the crocheting a little tighter between her legs and at her breasts, enough skin was peeking through those areas to give any man hope that it was still an indecent dress.

Lilith has this way of sort of draping herself all over everything. Her legs and her arms seem to be everywhere, her hair silky and shiny and always being tossed. Her legs were crossed but much of one rested over Mike's thigh, and her arms were all over the table, her fingers touching April's arm, her big wet lips telling my wife something very close to her cheek.

When she saw me, she grinned, and recoiled her sexy limbs back toward her own side of the table. "Look who's finally here," she said, as if she knew something that I didn't.

I looked at April, who gave me a quick shake of the head. *She* hadn't told Lilith anything, she was saying. "About time," she said, sweetly, patting the chair next to her. "I was starting to think we'd lost you."

"We've had soooo many oysters," Lilith purred. "And so much wine."

I glanced at her, and she grinned at me with her semi-sinister grin. I had no idea what to make of the comment.

I sat down, and a waiter appeared to pour me some wine. He asked if we were ready to order, and Lilith asked for some more time, and a menu, and after a few awkward minutes, she was buried with Mike behind the enormous leather-bound copy.

I turned my attention to April, putting a hand on her thigh. "So?" I said quietly. Lilith was giggling behind the menu, but it barely registered with me.

April tugged a cherry from an amber-colored drink and placed it in her mouth, pulling the stem away with a snap, eyes on mine. Again, this woman who was not my wife seemed to have occupied her body, though it's difficult to explain why I felt that way: perhaps it was the sexualized way that she did it, the expression in her eyes... I have no idea. But I was again struck by a sense of deep unease, and even more profound arousal, as this different expression lingered on April's face.

She smiled, chewing her cherry.

"So," she said, leaning closer to me. "Are you going to -"

Mike and Lilith had been getting increasingly louder - or that is to say, Lilith had been getting louder, and Mike had become more hands-on. At

this moment they erupted into a semi-adolescent make-out session, before Lilith set a hand on the table and oozed all of her glossy, sexual body from the chair, half of her kind of slithering around with Mike. "I think I had enough with all those oysters. We've got to, uh... get going."

And away they went, as April watched them with raised eyebrows. She whipped her head toward me very suddenly.

"You don't think she's...?"

"I don't care what she's doing," I said, moving my hand between April's thighs, over the sundress, but still predatory.

April looked around quickly, and blushed. That was the April I had always known.

But then, she let me begin to pull her dress up, bunching the fabric in my fist so that I could work my hand up, along her smooth, bare skin...

And *that* was *not* the April I knew.

She leaned on her elbow and pressed her fingers to her lips as my hand moved beneath her dress, my fingers brushing against the thigh furthest from me, a damp heat enveloping my fingers. Her eyes darted around us jerkily, but she let me continue.

"I want to know what you did," I began. "After you left the - "

A waiter had somehow appeared behind me, and April's eyes jerked up to him. He cleared his throat. I left my fingers where they were.

"Are you ready to order your main course, señores? And perhaps a drink for señor? Will the other guests be returning?"

April crossed her leg over my hand and looked at me. "Yes," she said with a smile, then looked up at the waiter again. "Or, no... they won't be back. But we are actually going to... have the dinner special for two."

"I'm not - "

"And another bottle of wine," she said, smiling at me. Then, decisively. "I have a long story to tell you."

*

For several minutes, my hearing stopped working, and there was a serious blood flow imbalance between the various organs of my body, my brain probably being the big loser in that battle. Also, as I tend to be on vacation, I was still pretty drunk, and so the first part of what April said is kind of a blur.

So, you know, this isn't *verbatim*, which I'm sure by now you've figured out.

She waited until the wine had arrived, all the time looking out over the beach. A breeze lifted her hair and made her look a little like a model on a shoot. Her skin had a tropical sheen to it, adding to the effect, and her sundress of tiny red flowers on white only called to mind the thrilling layers of purity I had glazed onto the idea of my wife.

So it was intoxicatingly disarming when, after smiling at the waiter and taking a sip of her wine, she looked at me, eyes dark blue and shifting like the dark ocean reflected in them, and said:

"So, aren't you going to ask me?" in a Penthouse-letter kind of voice.

I stared at her.

"Don't you want to know what I did? With the bartender?"

So these words were making their way to me through what seemed like a lot of Jell-o that had somehow grown inside of my brain, through the loud sound of my pulse in my ears, and then bypassing thought entirely, just adding to the massive physical reaction I was having without me really being able to understand a word of it.

My cock understood it, and evidently, I needed to have a pulse of 185 to maintain all this, but my brain was checked out completely.

"The bartender," my mouth said. My throat was so dry it stuck together.

"Raul," April said, smiling, giving the pronunciation an extra-saucy Latino kick. She waited for me to say something, blinking slowly, sexily, and then put her chin on her hand. "Didn't you wonder where I went?"

My hand was still pressed between April's hot thighs, but I had forgotten it. I remembered it now as she uncrossed her legs, and my hand, as if it were detached from my body, slid up her welcoming, moist thighs to where I could just feel her panties with the tip of my finger. To allow for this, April had to spread her legs quite a bit, and scoot toward me on the chair, which was obscene for April, even with the long tablecloth.

So I just kept staring at her, my fingertip telling me that her panties were soaked, my cock telling me she had said *something* incredible. But unable to really believe this was reality.

"I thought you would follow me," April said, and my eyes had settled on her mouth. Her tongue darted along her upper lip, playfully, like some kind of men's magazine photo.

"I..." I said hoarsely, and had to swallow. "I did. I couldn't find you."

"Hmm," she said.

And then she waited, took a sip of her wine.

"Where?" I managed to say. "Where did you go?"

Half of my body was falling, falling into a black hole. I didn't want to know where she went, I didn't actually want to hear this. I didn't want my April to cease to be this flower-speckled spring fresh beauty.

The other half was flying, chasing the thrilling idea that *this was it*: April was going to tell me that her panties were wet with Raul's cum, that she had fucked some guy, right under my nose.

"You know those little cabanas?" April said, holding her wine glass at a strange angle, as if she'd forgotten it. "The ones that they put all the equipment into?"

My mouth opened. I mean, sure... cabanas. I didn't know them, but they had to be there. This was a beach. I nodded vaguely. Her tongue moved in her mouth again, a smile quivered on her lips.

"That's where," she said.

She brought the wine to her lips and looked at me over the glass. At the same time, she edged toward me, legs apart, pressing the softness of her mound into my fingers. She was hot, her panties soaked.

"Where what?" I asked her, because she seemed like she was going to stop.

"Where Raul told me to meet him," she said, coyly.

I slipped my finger underneath her panties. Her lips parted as she sucked in a breath of air. I dipped my finger into her hole, then slid it upward over her clit, delighted that a tremor passed through her body as I rubbed her tight nub.

"What did you do with him, this Raul?"

April didn't answer. She smiled, sipped her wine, ground her clit against my finger. And then she dipped her finger into her wine, and brought it to her mouth. She sucked the wine from it.

No misreading that. My cock flexed and a pain developed in my ball sac.

Consumed, as we were then, by lust, I doubt we were doing a very good job of being inconspicuous about what we were doing. April was now pressed up to the table, her skin dented slightly by the edge, her back at an unnatural angle. The table shook a little as I rubbed her. I waited for her to talk again, to tell me every detail of her cock sucking. I stared at her lips and thought of how another man's creamy seed had spilled over them,

painting them momentarily the color of a pearl, before her pink tongue had come to lap it up. Had she smiled at him, like she was smiling at me now, looking up at him from the floor where she was on her knees?

April's eyes grew heavy and her lips quivered. I felt her thighs tense against my hand and she made a gasping noise, then snapped her mouth shut. The table jiggled as she came, maybe from her leg, or her torso, but so much that the wine in my glass sloshed onto the table.

She opened her eyes and looked quickly around, then scooted back primly into her chair, using two hands to toss her hair behind her. She had a pink flush on her face, and her lips seemed plumper, her eyes wild.

April leaned on one elbow and touched my other hand, the one I had left like a corpse on the table. My palms were clammy. Her finger felt like fire as she swooped over the back of my hand.

"So...?" I said.

She smiled at me. "He rented me two of those windsurfing things," she said, laughing. "I thought we could go tomorrow."

I must have looked disappointed as hell, because she seemed to look at me with pity. "He did flirt with me," she said, encouragingly. She held up her hand, which had her wedding ring shimmering on her slender finger, and waved it. "But he knew I'm married, duh."

Oh, April. I think she actually believes that's the sort of thing that would deter a man from having sex with her.

The waiter, who if you ask me had played his cards pretty well, and waited for the right moment to come over, brought us our first course, some kind of salad. His face was the model of professionalism as he asked us if we wanted freshly ground pepper.

"I can't believe," April said, stabbing her fork into her salad, "you really thought I *did that*."

I swallowed, tried to lean forward, reached for my wine.

The question came out of nowhere.

"What happened to your panties?" I asked. "The other night."

April held a forkful of salad in front of her mouth, pausing, and thought.

She made a really, really big show of thinking. She looked at the ceiling, she put the salad in her mouth, chewed, looked to the other side of the ceiling. Swallowed.

"Huh," she said.

My face no longer felt like something I had control of.

April looked at me for a moment, and I really didn't know what she was thinking.

Then she laughed. "I just...ended up not wearing them."

"How?"

Her eyes narrowed. "Jesus, Thomas, you know this is all just a game, right?"

"Of course," I said, much too quickly.

She stabbed her salad and looked at me with a serious face now.

"Good. Jesus."

She waved her hand at me when I kept boring into her with a stare whose unpleasantness I could imagine, because I could feel it on my own face and disliked it very much.

I was acting like a psycho. At least I knew it.

"It's like..." she sighed. "A tedious story. I had put on my swimsuit bottoms by mistake, we were rushing out the door, they were uncomfortable, that dress was getting caught on them, I took them off and put them in my purse."

"At the bar," I said, statement-not-question. "The second bar?"

"Is this an inquisition?"

"No."

Yes. Sort of.

April chewed and leaned back. "Because it sort of seems like one," she said. She looked up at the ceiling. "I thought this was what you wanted," she complained. "You said it was hot."

I snapped out of my psychosis for a moment.

I put my hand on hers. "You're misreading something," I told her.

Both April and I know that this is gaslighting, but she's too polite to say anything about it, and it's sort of an agreed-upon way out of this kind of trouble. "I do, I think... I thought it was hot. I just, you know, got to thinking..."

"Oh," April said, smiling again. She swished her wine. "That I had been all ready to jump on some guy that night?"

I shrugged. Thomas-The-Shrugged.

She shook her head, squinted, then smiled in this screwed-up-lip kind of way.

And then, bless her, she dropped it. We ate some more salad and drank some more wine.

Before the remaining courses arrived, that sexual tension - the same kind that had built up in the cab, the kind that comes from nowhere, forcefully, tangibly - bubbled up between us.

We looked at each other for a few steamy minutes, and then we abandoned our dinner and ran back to our room to have sex, like it was the first date and we couldn't keep our hands off each other.

I did not bring up any of this while we were doing that, because I am Thomas Roberts, and I know when I have a good thing, and I know when to shut the fuck up.

*

And so that was Mexico.

I didn't get everything I could have fantasized about in this world, but I got a great deal more than I ever expected to.

Once we arrived home, however, April seemed to wipe the entire thing from her memory. It was as if she had been playing a game and had now lost interest in it. Or perhaps she thought of it as a passing fancy, something whimsical for vacations only. In truth, her indifference to, or misunderstanding of, the depths of my own soul in which this fantasy existed, made me uneasy. Had she only been toying with me? Or drunk? Or compelled by some other motive that I would never be able to uncover? Would I ever know? Would she ever repeat this behavior, or take it further?

It was the not knowing that tormented me the most, and in many ways, that might have heightened the eroticism for me. That layers of sexual deviousness of any kind existed beneath April's fresh-as-spring veneer was destabilizing and arousing. Whether she had only been playing a game, or meant to go further, or was only teasing, or very drunk, or very serious: it didn't really matter as much, because any of those explanations meant that there was a secret April inside of her.

So why not just ask her, you might be wondering?

Sure.

You go ahead and think of the way you would phrase that question. How you would then - with April, soft as silk and white as snow, sleeping on her side with her red lips parted just so, or April, a placid, angelic beauty sitting across the table from you at breakfast - actually voice that question?

Were you just pretending that you have a deep, inner slut, or is it really in there? And if so, would you be willing to set her free, while I watch, because I was deadly serious in Mexico, and I really do want you to get thoroughly fucked by a man with a huge cock, and let him do twisted, defiling things to you.

So needless to say, that never got said, and I had to live with the scraps of our adventure: the dreams, the masturbatory fantasies, the occasional, vague references to it whenever April had something to drink, which was almost never.

Things went on like this for months.

And then...

CHAPTER 10

"So, you'll never guess what," April said. She was in a long, thin red t-shirt that she used as a nightshirt sometimes. I believe she thought it was the sort of thing that would put me off. It had a small tear near her hip, and the fabric was washed-out, the sleeves long, the cut unflattering. But in places the fabric was so worn I could see through it, and it actually had the opposite effect.

She plopped onto the edge of the bed with a brush in her hand, and began combing her long hair. It fell from the handful she was brushing like onyx sand.

"I forget what you just said," I admitted, leaning forward to get a hold of her.

She shot me a look first, and then smiled. "Guess what?" she repeated. Her voice was down turned, not eager. It was the kind of intro that could lead anywhere, but was likely to be semi-bitter news.

I shook my head and grabbed her thigh, tugging her gently toward me. She resisted, and set the brush down.

"I hate guessing," I reminded her.

"Lilith is moving back to town," she said, in a flat voice. She picked the brush up and began brushing again.

I furrowed my brow. I mean, I wasn't exactly thrilled about it, because Lilith was one crazy bitch. It seemed odd, though, that the news would be met by such a somber April.

"You... sound... almost... disappointed," I ventured.

April let her hand fall between her spread legs and sighed. "I just... you know. It's *hard*," she interrupted herself, turning to face me, "like, managing being friends with her, and, like, well, not you because you've never been in this position, but just, like previous, you know, boyfriends and stuff, who get sort of - and I don't really even know if I'm, like I was never Lilith's speed before but now maybe I'm just too old for like, what she wants to do, and so it's like, managing all these expectations and really it's just a hassle being friends with her when she's around, you know?"

I blinked slowly, and felt myself making the face that April hates. I guess my lips are drawn back and my mouth is open and I look at the ceiling.

"You're making the face."

"I just... I tried really hard, April, but I have no idea what you're saying."

April groaned in frustration. She's a hot mess when it comes to explaining her feelings. Not linear, is all I can tell you.

I put my hand on her leg. "Don't get frustrated with me - "

"I just don't know how else to explain it."

I won't bore you with the next twenty minutes, but basically, what April was getting at, I figured out in the end, was that she had mixed feelings about Lilith coming to town, because she felt pressured to maintain their friendship, but Lilith was a pretty crazy, single, sexual libertine, and April had outgrown that. Also April's previous boyfriends had been upset about some of the antics April had been dragged into by Lilith.

"Hmm," I said, once she had confessed this final issue. "Like what?"

April looked at me. Her expressions rippled, mercurial, from annoyed to amused to that devious character from Mexico, before she opened her mouth as if to tell me.

My cock stiffened.

She closed her mouth without telling me, shaking her head. "God, nothing ever *serious*," she said.

Did I believe that? I wondered to myself.

And this is where the problem lay. I both wanted that to be true, very much: April was April and had always been April as I knew her. She had never done anything *serious* with crazy, sexy, lascivious Lilith.

And yet... I wanted it to be untrue. Just a little. Maybe, a medium amount. Perhaps I wanted for that secret April to have existed. An April who *had* done serious things, very serious, filthy, perverted things with her friend Lilith.

Mexico, also, lingered in my mind. The promise of it, never quite fulfilled: the brushing up against my fantasy. I still didn't know if it had been the illusion of closeness, or if April really might have taken things further, if only we'd had more time.

And now, here it was again, circling around me, just outside of my reach. I could feel the air shift as it danced around me, and once again, I could feel the mercurial energy of that specific arousal coming to life in my gut.

It's a tight rope to walk in your own head, let alone with your wife.

"Okay, sure, nothing serious," I agreed. Of course, April. Nothing *serious*. "But you know, I kind of get a little kick out of... you know..."

April smiled, but the smile was non-committal and unclassifiable.

"Just tell me a 'for instance,'" I said, as carelessly as I could muster. I fiddled with a remote control to display my neutral level of interest, while beneath my skin, my blood darted through my arteries.

"That's just it, it's all so silly," April said. "You know, just... you know how Lilith is. She likes to flirt, and pick up guys, and, you know... I'm more like her wingman. I mean, obviously, guys barely notice me when Lilith is around."

Oh, April.

"Lilith is pretty hot," I said, cautiously. "But I *don't* think you're right about that."

April *snorted*. "Yeah, okay."

I looked at her sharply and tapped the remote. "You didn't notice that guy she was with in Mexico, checking you out, when he thought you weren't looking?"

April rolled her eyes, squinting, and shook her head. It was the gesture of a sixteen-year-old girl and quite endearing. Arousing, which was a little disturbing, but mostly endearing.

"I did," I told her, dropping the remote. I started to crawl toward her on the bed. "I think maybe you don't understand your allure as well as you think you do," I said, all schmaltzy, because now I was thinking more about having sex with April than trying to talk her into having sex with another man.

Momentarily, anyway.

April gave me a surprised look, and then smiled and melted into my advances, falling back onto the bed and allowing me to lie on top of her, my hands making their way under the t-shirt and up to the smooth crests of her breasts.

"I bet," I told her, rubbing a thumb over her hardening left nipple, and back again to savor the feel of what I had done, "that if you had stuck around that night, that guy would have gone after you, not Lilith."

April's body rose up against mine. "Hmm," she said. "And you would have liked that, wouldn't you?"

I didn't answer. I didn't trust my luck at this point. It's my philosophy to shut up when things are going inexplicably well, and for once, I followed it.

I let my fingers, slipping into her pussy, do the talking.

She wasn't gushing wet, and her outer lips still had that rubbery, squeaky texture to them, but once I found her sweet center, a pooling slippery wetness let me glide into her. I curled my fingers outward, tips seeking the rough patch that drove her wild, finding it, making her back arch and her body grind against me.

"What would you want me to do with him?" she purred.

"Hmm?" I said. Surprise was still fluttering around in my chest, confusing me a little. "Whatever you wanted to do..." I pushed my boxers down and climbed on top of her. She parted her legs, drawing my cock toward her pussy and then wrapped her legs around me, pulling me into her with her ankles.

We didn't say anything after that, but she stared into my eyes, and used her feet to pull me deep into her on each thrust, mouth open, eyes blue and mysterious. I imagined the strength of her thighs, and the burning of her eyes, being given to another man. I pictured her exactly as she was, but not beneath me. Beneath, instead, the bartender from Mexico, or the guy she had danced with.

And then, it was a very good thing that April was thinking about whatever she was thinking about, because I didn't last that much longer, and whatever the reason, she also came within seconds.

CHAPTER 11

It was weeks before Lilith actually returned to town, but she didn't waste any time inviting April out on the town. I found myself, at the end of the month, staring at April's text with a mixture of fear and excitement.

*Lilith's back, she just texted me... wants to go out tonight
????*

My first thought, curiously enough, was about Lilith's name. Like me, she was a never-nicknamed persona, even with her unwieldy long name that would, like Thomas, shorten so easily. But whereas I seemed to be "Thomas" because I had been pulled in to some gravitas-thick category for too-serious, too-cynical people, the commitment to Lilith's full name seemed to be, for her, some kind of escape from the orbit of ordinary females.

A Lilith like Lilith didn't need a pretty or cute name. She was *Lilith*, in all her colossal, raw, sexuality.

But I digress. My next thoughts tried to keep up with the quickening in my gut. The excitement, I guess by association, of our adventures in Mexico began to fill me again. The feeling was delicious. My fingers shook as I typed my answer.

Is this just you and Lilith, or am I invited too?

And then I waited. It was a Friday at the end of the month, a bad time. I was dog-tired, probably wouldn't get out of the office until eight, and that was only if I worked ceaselessly until then. If the question had involved anyone but Lilith, it would have been an immediate "no" for me. But the presence of Lilith might bring with it a return of the ambiance from Mexico, and there was no amount of fatigue that could keep me from that.

You too silly. I told her you're probably pretty tired.

Heh. I typed back, a little giddy, some of the excitement of dating returning to my bloodstream. April and I had been married a while now, long enough for that sweet taste of uncertainty to fade from our relationship entirely. Would April be in my bed tonight? Yes. The only uncertainty in life was now whether or not she would be too tired to have sex.

You trying to get rid of me?

An idea, which, in and of itself, provided me with some kind of perverse pleasure.

Of course not. But you're not exactly a social butterfly.

This was true. I disdained most social situations, especially those that involved girlfriends "going out" while I sat around drinking hard liquor at about three times its value.

Is it a girl thing?

She specifically asked if "you guys" want to go out.

This gave me another perverse thrill. I wasn't attracted in any serious way to Lilith, but let's face it, anytime a woman like Lilith even remembers you exist, it gives a guy an ego boost.

Where?

There was a long pause between messages, during which time I supposed April was consulting Lilith, who seemed like the sort of person who might not answer her many messages all that quickly. I could have done a lot of things with that time, like work, but I found myself too distracted by the unfolding excitement.

At last, my silent phone buzzed with a message from April.

She's got a whole plan to go check things out downtown.

*She said she'll head out around 9, we can meet her
wherever she is.*

Ah, yes. Lilith was going to survey the scene downtown. I could already imagine her devouring her way through every man in every bar and club within days, and when I did picture it, she was wearing her filmy, see-through white dress from Mexico.

I shrugged.

What was the worst that could happen?

And, on the other hand, what did I have to lose?

9. Pretty late.

Don't be an old fart.

I shrugged. to myself.

OK. We might be late, I have a lot of work.

There was another long pause.

You don't think Lilith's going to show up on time, right?

She finished this off with a few martini glass emoticons and a winky face, which was extraordinarily unlike April. She hated emoticons. It was a fine dusting of flooziness on my normally non-floozy wife, and for some reason it titillated me.

I sent her a thinky emoticon back.

CHAPTER 12

Even after arriving at home at 8:30, showering and changing, then retreating to the closet to look for something hipper once I saw what April was wearing, we still arrived at a place called The Buddha before Lilith had even replied to a message April sent her, telling her we were ready to go. It was 9:45.

The Buddha was in the middle of a district of nightlife hotspots, and I suggested it as a place to wait to hear from Lilith because it was the only bar in that area I'd been in in the past six years. My friends are pretty content with the sports bar down the street from their house, where Coors Light is on tap un-ironically.

The Buddha was old news and it was pretty clear that its clientele were all people like me, who didn't go out much and so came here for the safety of being in a place that had been popular back in their day. All the twenty-somethings were somewhere else. The paint was fading, the decor was aged, and the music was slightly lame. We had a pick of several booths, so we sat down and pored over the drink menu.

Well, April did that. I pored over her.

April, as I mentioned, was a fairly conservative dresser, which was still very sexy because it kind of went with her fresh-as-a-spring-rain thing. Occasionally she retrieved something from her closet that was slightly shorter, or cut lower at the neckline, or was tight throughout. But these items were never all three of these things at once.

So imagine my surprise and delight when I found April standing in front of the mirror, smoothing the dress she was wearing, turning sideways and making, however faintly, that pouty face that girls make when they look in the mirror.

The dress was new, which she hurried to explain. Because I had advised her I'd be home late, she'd decided to kill time by going shopping. This - she also rushed to explain - was because she had felt that if she sat down too long, she might get sleepy.

"What do you think?" she'd asked me.

I had barely opened my mouth to say, probably, "hhhhuhuhot," when she squinted and crinkled her nose. "It's too much, right? I should probably just wear that - "

"It's hot!" I practically screamed.

This dress was a violet-blue, and April's eyes had shifted to the exact shade, as they did with all shades of blue. Two thick ribbons of blue fabric hung from her neck, crossed at her breast plate, covering her perky breasts, and then joined a tight skirt that began just below her ribcage and descended, plastered to her lithe form, to mid-thigh, leaving a lot of her legs dangling from it. A triangle of skin, the base at the waistline of the dress and the peak between her breasts, remained uncovered by the fabric. There was no back, just the slope of her shoulder blades and the plain of white skin, the tiniest trace of a tan line all but faded away.

April turned to look at herself in the mirror again, with her hand on her hip. "I don't know," she said. "It's sort of..."

I had approached her by now and put my mouth close to her shoulder. "It looks great," I said. "And whatever Lilith is wearing will probably make it look like a nun costume. I like it."

So, April had worn this dress to The Buddha, along with some very high heels, which she had apologized for, because they made her about half an inch taller than me. But they gave her long legs an even longer line, and her bottom rolled beneath the tight dress as she walked in a way that I could only find delightful. She had also worn her hair long, parted down the middle, sleek and shiny as always. Her lips were a bright red, but her makeup was otherwise plain and natural, as usual.

The eyes of the men at The Buddha were drawn to her quickly, and I felt a little rush watching so many beady, hungry gazes slide away from their own partners to take in April's pristine beauty. Where other women seemed a little overdone, like they were working too hard, April just looked like a tall, glorious flower.

"She bringing anyone?" I asked April, after we'd chosen our drinks and given the order to a harried waitress who seemed to be the only person working.

April pulled out her phone and checked for a message from Lilith. "I don't know," she said vaguely, scanning the texts. She looked up at me. "I mean, probably not. She's probably, you know, looking."

We had our drinks and didn't talk much: the volume was going up faster than we were drinking. April checked her phone, pretty soon it was way past my bedtime and I was almost positive that Lilith would end up ditching us.

I felt her before I saw her. I thought someone was falling over drunk into our booth. She shoved herself down next to me, and the scent of expensive hair products and makeup slid over my face. Her hair fell over my shoulder, and her firm, rounded, feverishly hot body pressed against my entire left side.

"Jesus," her lips, pink and wet-shiny, spat, next to left eye. "Tell me this is the worst place in this town or I am going to slit my wrists."

She was looking at me now.

"Thomas?"

"We don't go out very much," April told her from across the booth. "This is where we used to go."

Lilith looked me up and down, then shot a glance at April. "Hot dress," she said. She turned her haughty, devilishly arousing face back to me. "We *can't* waste that here."

Then, without any further explanation, she stood up, and walked to the bar. She leaned over it in such a way that her full ass jutted out. She was wearing a pink dress the color of her lips, and nipples, and probably pussy, that barely reached beneath her bottom. It was a silky material, the kind that clung to imperfections, but the material found none on Lilith's body, and instead moved, slippery and evocative of the shiny wet petals of her cunt. One spaghetti strap slipped from her shoulder constantly, though I never managed to catch her placing it back to its perch, so it could fall suggestively, over and over again, all night long.

A bartender seemed to materialize in front of her, as bartenders do for Lilith. She chatted with him, he poured her a pink drink she never paid for, he typed a few things on his phone while she drank it and stirred it with x-rated motions, one ankle crossed over the other now, the shadow between her thigh stretching upward...

We both stared at her. Along with, I'm assuming, everybody in the bar.

"Okay," Lilith said, returning to the table, but not sitting down. "We're going to *Arcade*."

She said it "ar-kad," the French pronunciation.

"Josh has a friend who works there and he'll get us ahead in the line," she added. Then she blew the bartender, who must have been "Josh," a kiss.

"Hop to it," she told us.

*

So *Ar-kahhhhd* was where all the cool kids were, it turned out. The line stretched down the block and around the corner. We took a cab and the cab driver seemed to know the deal. He approached the butt-end of the line on the adjacent street and stopped, without passing the place to check it out first.

"This is line," he told us, in a thick Russian accent he did not seem to care if we could understand.

Lilith, who probably never waited in a line in her entire life, did not object to being dropped there. She popped out of the taxi, breezily crossing the street without looking back, blond hair caught in the wind, the glossy pink of her dress glissading over the curves of her body. She did not look back, or care who paid for the cab. I wondered if girls like Lilith had any idea that things actually cost money.

April stood outside the cab, waiting for me, elbows clasped in her hands, her face screwed up in an expression of apology for Lilith's behavior. She shrugged, and slipped a hand into the crook of my arm.

Lilith walked right past the whole line like she owned the place, while I trailed behind with April. Guys never get to cut a line like this one, especially guys like me.

But the bouncer seemed to be expecting Lilith, and even if he hadn't been, she was a goddess in pink and she walked right up to him to lean on the railing of the stairs and chat. He waved April and me through, giving April a look of approval, up and down, before scowling at me.

Whatever.

I had just cut the line of the hottest club in town (a fact I would not be aware of until the next day when I mentioned the place to a girl at work), and I had done it in my thirties and with the two hottest women around. *Scowl all you want.*

*

The inside of *Arcade* was new, shinier, louder, hipper, and full of a lot more young people than The Buddha, but other than that, it was effectively the same bar with a slightly different color scheme, which is my opinion about pretty much all bars everywhere. Lilith seemed to have chosen her dress for the purposes of matching the color scheme of pinks, which fanned out on the floor in circles of light and glowed in a tank full of jellyfish.

But she did not blend.

Within minutes she had somehow installed us in a booth and managed to get us drinks, and had three men approach her and whisper in her ear, to which she flung her hair around, smiled brightly, and sent them away without pissing them off.

April was seated next to me, on the inside of the booth, an arrangement Lilith had expressed some displeasure at by rolling her eyes after we sat down.

"This is more like it," she declared, when our drinks came sailing smoothly to our table. She had, I noted, at least managed to order something I wanted (a whiskey), which puffed me up with a little bit of pride. She cast her discerning eye upon the throng around us, twisting a straw between her fingers.

Time dragged on for a bit because it was pretty hard to talk. Once we had a few drinks, the provenance of which was never clear to me: it was as if Lilith appeared thirsty and the male hive mind ordered drinks for her before her cup ran dry. She leaned over to talk conspiratorially with April for a few minutes, and then disappeared with a guy who had purchased a drink for her.

April turned to me after she left. "You okay?" she asked, almost hopelessly.

"This is great!" I screamed.

April patted me on the arm and smiled apologetically. We sat there, quietly, while everyone around us yelled and laughed and flirted.

"Hey," I said, after a few awkward moments. "Why don't you get out and mingle. You know? With Lilith, wherever she is?"

April rubbed her nose and rolled her eyes.

"Well, at least, you know, sit across from me, so it looks like I got lucky."

It took some doing for me to scoot out and for April to take Lilith's place. She leaned over to talk to me, stirring her cocktail, smiling. For a moment or two, it felt like I actually *had* picked up April in that bar, and I felt some of that old, long-buried excitement.

I was three drinks in. "Guys are checking you out," I told her suggestively.

She looked up at that moment, and one such guy happened to be looking down at her. He was making no bones about staring at her breasts,

or even below them, at the bare triangle of skin peeking from below the crossed straps. She met his eyes and grinned, as did he.

An electric flicker of arousal traveled the length of my dick. April looked quickly back at me.

I couldn't tell if she was feeling, as I was, the lure of that fun we'd had in Mexico. If she was considering playing the same kinds of games.

Lilith reappeared, a couple of guys in tow, at that very moment. "These are my friends," she said, "Laila, and... that's just her cousin Tomás," she told them of me. She leaned close to one guy's ear and purred in it, before turning toward me, leaning over on the booth so that her dress must have ridden all the way up to her ass, which the man behind her appreciated. "I told them you don't speak English," she giggled in my ear. "So don't say anything."

I wondered where sandy-haired, 5'8", all-American-bland-looks "Tomás" was supposed to be from. I hoped that Lilith had the sense to tell people I was from somewhere where Spanish wasn't spoken. You can't throw a piece of popcorn in this town without hitting someone who wants to practice their Spanish.

April shot me a look as Lilith tugged at her arm and pulled her to her feet. I raised my glass to the group and pretended to not speak English, my eyes devouring the sight of my wife in a bar, men trying to charm her, her mild flirtations back, as if I wasn't even there. Was she doing it on purpose, because I had dropped that suggestive tone into our conversation moments ago? Or was she oblivious to the way she reacted to other men? Or was I imagining it? Or was this how April acted all the time when I wasn't around, touching her neck, laughing brightly, giving her hair a shimmering toss and narrowing her eyes seductively... and I just didn't know it?

I marinated in this funk for a while, while they chatted, but eventually everyone started cramming into the booth, getting up, switching sides, getting drinks, talking to people at other tables. April went to the bathroom and then, through the strange behavior of people at bars, which reminds me a lot of pinball machines, I was left alone with Lilith and there was a lull in the chatter.

"It's just me and you, cowboy," Lilith said, and her foot brushed, whether accidentally or not, over my shin beneath the table.

"I'm sure all the men will come stampeding back any moment," I told her.

She bit into a straw and smiled at me.

"You aren't going to be a pain in my ass like *all* April's boyfriends, are you?"

I cocked my head. "Well, Lilith, for one, I'm April's husband, not her boyfriend."

Lilith grinned again at this, which made me feel a lot of emotions, the primary of which was terror.

"But I'm not sure exactly what you mean, by being a pain in the ass," I continued.

Lilith sat back haughtily and eyed me with an arched eyebrow. "People seem to have a problem with April going out with me," she said. "And you have this, I don't know..." she waved her hand at me. "Pissy look on your face right now."

"Huh," I answered. I was happy to see that I managed to say it in a clever-enough way that it captured her interest. I wondered what about my look was "pissy."

Lilith narrowed her eyes. "Is that why you're here? To be like, a chaperone? For poor little weak April, who would just get swept up into the arms of any man who flirted with her?"

This made me tip my head again. "You invited me."

Lilith laughed. The mercury of her mood shifted again. "That's true," she agreed.

"But no," I said, feeling dangerous. "That's not at all why I'm here."

Lilith had been holding her drink for these last few exchanges, swirling what little was left of it malevolently, and this caused her to set it down and lean back across the table with a renewed interest and a grin that was, though still terrifying, slightly more conspiratorial. "Oh. Yeah?"

"Yep" I said, making the final "p" obnoxiously plosive.

I was in the zone with the drinks, exactly the right level of drunk to think I was hot shit, but not so drunk I was slurring my speech.

"Hnn," Lilith said, tracing her fingers lazily around mine, without touching me, on the table. "So why are you here, then, Tom?"

"Thomas," I corrected, almost reflexively.

Lilith looked me right in the eye. "*Thomas*," she purred. "That's a lot to say. Especially in certain situations." She touched her throat - in what is hands-down the most pornographic gesture I have ever seen that did not involve actual genitalia - and tossed her hair again.

She became instantly snippy, less sexual. "But... sorry, April is a really good friend, so anything like *that*..." she walked her fingers over to me, "Is off the table. And threesomes, too... but that's because of April." She smiled, and then purred, "not me."

I sipped my drink. I certainly felt like a badass, about to tell a girl like Lilith that I wasn't interested in her wares, and mean it. But April was not the kind of girl to dawdle in the bathroom, so I had better lay the chips down fast.

"I'm not into that kind of thing," I said. "At least... not *that* kind of threesome."

Lilith considered this only briefly. I suppose a girl like Lilith has seen it all, so it didn't take more than a few seconds for her to size up the situation.

She laughed, and it seemed to have escaped her because she slapped a hand over her mouth immediately. It was a new mood coming from her, and it startled me a little.

She shook her head, composing herself back into a vixen-type. "April would never, ever, do that," she told me, leaning forward, with her elbows on the table. "You know that, right? She's so... *prude*."

"Too prude for a threesome," I said.

"Oh yeah."

"What about a twosome?"

Lilith's mouth was open, and she smiled, shifting her jaw. "We are talking about the same thing here, right? Her with another guy? You want her to be a hotwife? Or are you more of a cuckold guy?"

I want to stress that at this particular moment, Lilith had become more clinical than anything else. Like a psychotherapist. She was not judging any of this, she was just getting down to brass tacks.

And I really... almost loved her, but definitely liked her a great deal... for it.

"Definitely hotwife," I said.

Lilith returned to smiling at my expense. "Nah," she said. "I don't think she'd ever do it."

Lilith might have known my wife better than me, in some respects, so this was a drag to hear. I tried again anyway. "I don't know," I said. "She got.. *kind of*.. into it in Mexico."

"Oh, April will get *kind of* into anything," Lilith said. "If I asked her to go to a strip club right now and put money in the girls' panties, she would get *kind of* into it..."

I raised my eyebrows.

"... but she would never actually get *all the way* into it." Lilith downed the rest of her drink. "Believe me, I've tried."

"You could get April to go to a strip club," I said, unbelieving.

"And get a lap dance," Lilith said, with supreme confidence.

I stared at her.

"Easy," she growled, as if I'd challenged her to a duel.

I shrugged. "So what else could you get her to do, more along the lines of... men?"

"We could go to a male strip club," Lilith suggested.

"*How* do you even know where one is?" I asked incredulously.

Lilith waved her hand at me impatiently. "Pshht. They're all gay, anyway." She looked up at the ceiling, and it occurred to me at that moment that Lilith really seemed to be *actually working* on my problem.

"So look," she said, after a few moments, "I know a -"

"That *line*," April said, materializing behind Lilith. "Was like sixty people long."

Lilith grinned, and April spilled into the booth next to me. "Sorry," she huffed. Her eyes went back and forth to our drinks. "You guys need more drinks."

Lilith had an arm slung over the booth and was tapping her finger against it, amused to no end. I was sure that she could see how my desire and curiosity was burning inside of me, eating away at my inner organs. I wanted the end of that unfinished sentence more than anything in the world.

But duty called. "I'll go grab some," I offered.

"Let me," Lilith said. "Then they'll be free." She stood up, smoothed her dress down, and tapped the end of the table with one of her gloriously manicured fingernails. "Just whiskey?" she asked me, but didn't really wait for my answer.

"Is she really just going to go up there and get three drinks?" I asked April.

"Probably." April was eyeing me with something like suspicion. "So, what have you and Lilith been doing while I was gone?"

Guilt probably ended up on my face somehow, because I did feel a little guilty about talking about my wife and conspiring with Lilith about her. April saw it, and tendrils of suspicion ignited in her violet eyes.

"We were just talking," I scoffed, without meaning to sound so unbelievable.

"Oh," April said. "I see." Her tone was icy.

Jesus, I wanted to tell her, have you got the wrong end of the stick.

"What did you talk about?"

I smiled. "Uh... god, I don't know. This and that."

April searched my eyes. "This and that," she repeated.

"Hey," I said, putting a hand on her arm. "Are you okay?"

April doesn't linger on things like this too long. She looked at my hand, then at me, and then seemed to shrug things off. "Sorry, yeah, of course, just... being silly."

"Okay," I said, making a funny face.

She rolled her eyes because she hated that face.

I heard Lilith laughing at the bar. Somehow, she had already made it through the crowd and was being served a drink. "She *is* really something," I commented. I grinned at April, to stop her from scowling. "At least we'll always have free drinks," I joked.

But by then, a caravan of men were headed our way, and Lilith was being loud, and April didn't get a chance to be annoyed or laugh at my joke, because the lava lamp had just erupted a very large, lively bubble.

CHAPTER 13

When in the course of the next forty minutes or so Lilith spoke to April and the other guys with us, and convinced everyone to leave the club and go to a strip joint, or how she even knew where to go, I will never know. Well... it's mainly the convincing April to go that mystifies me, but she must have done it, said something, put all the wheels in motion, because suddenly we were getting up, moving toward the door, exchanging numbers and instructions, piling into cabs.

April tried to pile into the cab I was effectively pushed into by Lilith, but the cab driver, who did not have an accent of any kind and seemed to hail from Brooklyn and an art design college, would not allow extra people in the back of his cab. That was how April ended up in the vehicle behind us, but the doors were shut and Lilith was patting my arm affectionately before I could even think of what protest to lodge.

"She'll be fine," Lilith told me. "She has a phone. She's a big girl."

I looked behind us, saw a glimpse of April's blue dress and her slender leg in the bright light of a headlight, and then she was gone.

When I turned to Lilith, she was rolling her eyes, taking a tube of lip gloss from between her breasts. "It's what you wanted, anyway, right?" she said, grinning. She placed the brush on her lower lip and drew it along, batting her eyes at me. "Just *imagine* what she's getting up to in there with all those younger guys."

I do admit that the idea made my cock plump up, but a cool layer of jealousy floated down to the lower chambers of my heart. Hopping into a cab with strangers was not April's style. It was the kind of thing she'd never done around me.

"Does she know where we're going?" I asked, looking behind us again, as if I could see, through the blinding headlights, what was going on in the vehicle behind us. If that vehicle was even the one she was in.

Lilith was spreading lip gloss on her upper lip now. "Like, does she know the address? Or do you mean, does she know *where* we are going?"

"Both, I guess," I said.

Lilith grinned.

She waited, smiling to herself, her left hand working its way into the legs of the guy seated next to her, unashamedly finding the outline of his erect cock with her fingertips.

"Both," she said finally, and then grinned at me wickedly, before turning toward the guy she'd picked up at the bar and climbing onto his lap to make out.

I watched this in fascination for a few moments. Regulatory-Brooklyn-driver broke in after a few seconds. "Hey. Everybody has to have a seatbelt on back there."

This made Lilith laugh, but she plopped into the middle seat and made the driver nervous by making eyes at him and touching her mouth, so he could see it in the rear view mirror, while laughing a little derisively and using her other hand to stroke the bulging package between the other passenger's legs.

All I could think about was the unfinished sentence, the promise of it lingering in my mind, from Lilith's and my conversation at the bar.

So look, I know a... Lilith's voice purred, over and over and over again in my mind, as slippery and glossy as her satin dress.

*

We emerged from our cab ride beneath hundreds of light bulbs at the entrance to a strip club called the Grand Marquee. Lilith linked arms with her gentleman friend, who I'd learned was named Rob, and made straight for the bouncer. The particular throbbing music of strip clubs pulsed behind thick black doors, and when they opened, a sweetly scented fake fog bathed in red light poured into the street. I caught a glimpse of lights reflected in sequins.

"Uh," I said, as Lilith made the bouncer, an enormous black man, grin from ear to ear and rise from his stool to open the door for her. "Aren't we....? I'm gonna wait for April," I said.

Idiotically, it was only at this moment that it became very clear to me that I had let my wife climb into a cab with two young men we had only just met at a bar, whose names I did not know.

Lilith was already disappearing inside, pulling Rob's hand behind her. The absurdity of the entire situation began to crash down around me. What the fuck were we doing here? Lilith was moderately insane.

"Hey," the stout bouncer said aggressively to me, scowling. A line had begun to form behind him. "You with the pretty lady here or not? Cuz' they goin' in."

"I'm just... Lilith!" I tried to get her attention. Something had slowed them just as they entered, and I could see the smooth curve of Lilith's satin-

wrapped ass in the crack of the door. "I have to wait for my wife," I explained almost helplessly to the bouncer.

The bouncer whistled and held his hand up a few inches above his head, about at April's high-heeled height. "Hot little thing, black hair? Blue-ass eyes?"

I didn't say anything, and I can't even be sure what face I made. The bouncer shook his head and opened the door. "She *already* here. Damn, that your *wife*?"

I stepped toward the door, confused, not really sure what was going on. The bouncer patted me almost affectionately with the back of his hand. He was looking at Lilith now, his head tipped sideways as his eyes tracked the movements of her ass. "Hey man, what you do for a living? Huh?"

I smiled mysteriously, because I felt pretty sure he'd be disappointed by the answer, which seemed to only endear me to him more. He chuckled and gave me another friendly slap on the shoulder as I entered the club. "Bunch a' fine-ass bitches, man. You gotta tell me what you do," he muttered, grinning broadly, as I sank into the dim den of sin.

I was still thinking of April, and whether it was true that she was already here, how it had happened, and, most importantly, how it had come to pass that *April* had entered the club alone, with her two strange men, before I'd arrived.

I kept one eye on Lilith's pink dress while fishing my phone out. Maybe April had texted me and I just hadn't felt it, or seen it, even though I'd been checking my phone every thirty seconds in the cab.

But no, there was nothing from April.

And then, there she was.

If anyone had asked me, say twenty minutes earlier, what I would expect my wife to look like if she had entered a strip club with two strange men, I would have not hesitated to describe a scene in which April looked around wide-eyed, clearly uncomfortable, with her arms folded over her waist.

But April was seated at the bar, legs crossed, elbow leaning on the black lacquer, a drink in one hand, the chair turned outward, her body at an angle so she could talk to the guy in front of her and easily see the stage. In her blue dress, with her casual demeanor and the enormous smile she was wearing, she looked... like a girl who *worked* there.

For a moment, that idea, of April working there, distorted my reality, and my heart seized up and then fell through my feet. A tinge of disappointment spread through the well of fear, confusion, and arousal that had sprung in my abdomen.

This woman, at the bar of a strip club, was not my wife.

But when she saw Lilith, she smiled, and extended an arm to her, and the two embraced, high pitched squeals buried beneath the music accompanying a pair of naughty, feathery nurses on stage.

I approached, disbelieving, watching April as though through a looking-glass.

When she saw me, she hopped from her chair and hurried over. She squeezed my hand. "Jesus," she said, leaning close to my ear. "I thought you'd *never* get here. I had no *idea* this was a *strip* club."

I leaned away from her and looked at her face. She was smiling more like herself now: a little goofily, a little less confidently.

"You handled it pretty well," I said, a note of suspicion in my voice even though I had not intended for it to be there.

April squeezed my hand again. "What do we *do* here? Whose idea was this?"

I opened my mouth to explain, but Lilith grabbed April's hand faster than I could get the words out and tugged her away. "Come on, we've got a table over here."

April slipped from my grasp, and Lilith led her away, up front, to a table Lilith had procured with her magical powers of being Lilith. Right next to the stage.

I followed, hands in pockets, eyes on April.

I can get her to get a lap dance, Lilith's assured voice whispered in my ears.

So look, I know a...

When I arrived at the table, which was a tiny cocktail table surrounded by uncomfortable, tiny chairs, the gang we had towed from the bar was already piled around my wife and Lilith. Everyone was drunk, shouting, staring at the strippers, and it was general mayhem. But the boys Lilith had picked up at the bar were quick to put their arms over April's chair and lean in close to talk to her.

I watched April, mesmerized by her behavior.

I had expected her to be uncomfortable. But, while she certainly didn't have a fistful of dollars in her hand, and she wasn't gawking at the dancers like a man, she wasn't trying hard to avert her eyes or position herself so she wouldn't see them - which is what I would have expected her to do.

But, like I've mentioned, the thing I'm into seeing is not April with other girls.

So I was less... affected... by the fact that she was not super-uncomfortable with the dancers, than by the fact that she was not super-uncomfortable with the men sitting around her, vying for her attention whenever they got the chance.

They were making her laugh and place her head on her hand to listen. They were watching the strippers with the same testosterone-fueled greed that any man watches strippers with at a strip club, but they always made their way back to talking to April.

Lilith, you ask? She was making out with one of these guys, and we were all doing our best to give them some space.

April looked at me occasionally, giving me a bemused smile. At one point she leaned over and said, loudly, "I can't believe we're at this place!"

A hand on my shoulder interrupted my reverie after about fifteen minutes of this. Pink fingernails, expensive scent. "Come and get some drinks with me."

Lilith.

I followed her.

*

"I thought there were waitresses for this," I told Lilith, as she leaned against the bar.

She waved a hand at me and rolled her eyes. "That's the problem with these places, everyone thinks I work here, including the people who work here."

She said this matter-of-factly, as if it were the same kind of inconvenience, and just as commonplace, as the paper ketchup cups at McDonald's.

I raised my hand to get the bartender's attention. It was nice to be better-served than Lilith for once.

Lilith watched me, swaying a little. She was obviously very amused with herself, or me, or both.

"So you really think you could get April to get a lap dance?" I asked her.

Lilith grinned and looked in April's direction. Then she shrugged. "Probably." Then she looked at me over the rim of her glass. "I can get April to do a lot of things," she purred. "Is *that* the thing you really want?"

I looked at her, not sure of what to say, stomach in knots of arousal and nervousness.

I leaned in to be heard over the music. "Back at the bar, you started to say something, you didn't finish. You know a...?"

Lilith rolled an ice cube around sexily in her mouth. "I know a... what?" she teased, smiling like the devil.

"That's what you didn't say," I said, repressing, as much as I could, my hunger for the answer. Lilith seemed like the kind of girl to really fuck with you if she knew you wanted something badly enough.

She crunched her ice and swished her drink, apparently thinking of how best to fuck with me, before she seemed to think suddenly better of it. "I know a perfect stud for you," she said brightly. She held her pointer fingers up in front of her, apart about ten inches. "He likes breaking couples in. It's sort of his specialty."

Every one of her words, so casually uttered, felt like a tongue swiping the crown of my cock. A physical pain gripped me as my dick grew impossibly hard.

The idea of someone "breaking April in" was of course horrid and vulgar.

So very, very vulgar.

Deliciously vulgar.

Why did I like it so much? Just the combination of those ideas, the vague feral feel of them, the allusion to horse breeding... it was all v-u-l-g-a-r and arousing as fuck.

I could see the interest piquing in Lilith's eye. She was lighting up at my reaction. Her eyes dropped briefly to my cock and lingered but a second on it. What she found there made the corners of her mouth flicker slightly with an even-wider smile. She fished an ice cube from her drink and extended her tongue to place it on the blade, an action that would have been ill-mannered and hickish from any other woman, but when Lilith did it, was a filthily erotic gesture I would probably never forget.

"He really enjoys teaching girls like April some dirty new tricks."

She eyed my response with a grin as she moved her tongue beneath the ice cube. She closed her lips around it, sucked on it, and then plunked it into the glass. "But maybe that's not what you're after."

I moved my body from side to side in a shrug.

Lilith laughed, and turned toward the bar, waving her fingers at the bartender. To me, she said, "If you want, I can give you his number." She batted her eyes at me. "But I *am* warning you. He's *really* filthy." She sucked in some air, and wiggled a little, almost as if she was having a light orgasm.

"He's really *good*," she added.

My excitement reached a fevered pitch, and I turned with Lilith to watch the group down by the stage. April looked over at me, almost as if she needed to be rescued. The bubble of my arousal thinned, and suddenly popped. "April would never do anything like that," I said, muted.

I didn't think Lilith heard me at first: I was saying it more to myself than to anyone else. It was partly a lament, partly a fervent hope, partly a slap to my own face to get me straightened out. What was I doing, sitting here with Lilith, thinking about getting the number of a "stud" to teach my wife some dirty tricks?

There was also an element to all of this that made me nervous, and it was Lilith. Lilith's claims to be able to get my wife to do "lots of things."

But these were all things I wanted.

"Actually," Lilith said, slipping her phone out of god-knows-where and holding it to type something. She completed this task before finishing her sentence. "Maybe he's around tonight."

I stared at her. She grinned with her lips on the edge of her phone.

"Did you...?" I asked.

Lilith laughed, and then shrugged. "He probably won't be around anyway."

I stared at her.

"It's too late to un-do it," Lilith said, shrugging.

I headed, speechless, to the table, leaving Lilith to order her drinks and flirt with the men at the bar.

*

"You okay?"

I was a little numb as I sort of climbed through the guys, jostling a few of them, to seat myself next to my wife. Lilith's text to her stud "friend,"

while likely to come to nothing this evening, had hit me in the chest with a cold, hard punch. My guts were draining, warm, into my groin, where my cock was coming wildly to life, with a mind of its own.

April was in an animated conversation with a dark-haired guy, which became suspiciously muted once I sat down.

I leaned over April's lap. "Don't mind me," I said to him, a little more aggressively than I had intended to. "Just keep talking really close to my wife like that."

He laughed, but he seemed to sense that I was agitated, and withdrew a little awkwardly with a mumbled excuse to April that I couldn't hear.

I wasn't entirely sure why I had acted like that. My head was reeling from the drinks, Lilith, the "stud," my obsessions, the flashing lights.

"How are you doing?" I asked April again.

She tipped her head back to laugh and leaned toward me. "I am so... drunk," she practically shouted. "This place is crazy," she added, and then gazed for a moment, awestruck, at the stage, where a very talented blond dancer was upside down and doing the splits bare-chested.

"What was Prince Charming there chatting you up about?" I asked, all but ignoring April's answer, and the stage.

April waved a hand carelessly in the direction he had had wandered off to. "Oh... that. He was just telling me... like.... all this stuff about strippers."

"Oh, yeah," I said, in a patient "mm-hhm" sort of tone.

"He said they make like \$1-2K a night," April said. "There's no way, right? That's like... thirty grand a month."

"Seems a little steep for just stripping," I reflected.

April looked shocked. Her mouth was open. Her eyes flicked to the girl on stage, and then back at me, and she began to shake her head slowly.

"Nah...no. That's... nobody actually *does* that, do they?"

I looked at her.

"I thought that was just on, like, TV shows and stuff." She looked around, then leaned close to me. "They have rules and stuff. *Surely*."

I didn't say anything, just smiled, and rearranged my drink on the tiny, wobbly table, which was now teeming with empties. The waitresses were not doing a very good job at our table, probably because we were so crammed together.

I glanced back at Lilith, and a jolt of electricity went through me when I saw she was grinning devilishly and typing a text on her phone.

Head whirling, stomach cool, I turned back to the stage and stared at the dancer without seeing her. The music came to me through a singing fog, and I felt like I was watching everything through a fish-eyed lens.

April was saying something. She had been saying something for a long time, and slowly, slowly, her voice worked its way through my foggy head. She had asked a question. I looked at her. She was waiting for an answer.

"I, uh... sorry..."

April looked at the stage, then back at me. "Right, a little distracting," she said. Her tone seemed to be joking and light. "I'm going to go talk to Lilith," she said, using fake sign language and speaking slowly, like I was a mentally impaired foreigner. "and then we can go home. Okay?"

This was, to be honest, precisely what I'd wanted not ten minutes ago. But now, the brazen curiosity inside of me, the hopeful fantasizer, wanted to wait and see if Lilith's "friend" was going to show up.

I mean - it was pointless, sure, because April would never agree to something like that, and anyway, I wasn't sure that's what I really wanted... but... curiosity gnawed at me.

And my cock was using up, admittedly, more than its fair share of oxygenated blood.

*

I had to jump on the opportunity to talk to Lilith in a dull moment: she was pretty busy, letting a new harem of men attend to her at the bar.

"Lilith!" I whisper-yelled.

After April didn't return for fifteen minutes or so, I had headed to the bar. Lilith had absorbed April into the conversation at the bar, and now a dark-skinned man was openly flirting with my wife, leaning down over her like vulture because he was so tall.

I heard my voice and felt like I sounded a little hysterical.

What can you do?

Lilith whirled around and smiled at me.

"So?" I asked Lilith, as casually as possible,

"So..." Lilith said, and she really did seem to have no idea what I was talking about. She let me simmer with confusion and disappointment for a moment.

"Oh," she said, smiling her devilish smile. "Jonny." She grinned harder. "He said he'd try to stop by."

I nodded.

"*You* seem pretty eager," Lilith said, almost smirking.

In truth, I had just needed to know whether to stick around or not, but that was the last thought I wanted to articulate to Lilith. She was unnerving, as if some evil idea always lurked in her mind and you were just lucky if she didn't make it happen.

*

"Thomas," Lilith purred, running her hand over Jonny's chest. "This is Jonny."

Jonny was about 6'3," tanned and rugged-looking. Tattoos wrapped around his arms, giving him an authentic bad-boy air, even though it was hard to see what kind of tattoos they were. His hair was cut neatly, though, and he moved the way ultra-fit guys move, either an athlete or a military guy, economical with his movements, tightly coiled strength.

He looked me in the eye with neither contempt, nor superiority, but with an expression that made it clear he wasn't the type to push around or be pushed around, emphasis on the latter. We shook hands, which was a little weird, considering that I was kind of hoping the guy was going to thoroughly fuck my wife.

Nah, I told myself. That wasn't actually going to happen.

"Hey," we said to each other.

Lilith's fingers crawled through his hair, and she tugged him down to her mouth to whisper something in his ear. He did not react to it, but his eyes went searching around, by our table, as soon as she finished speaking.

Lilith sort of pushed him away, like a mother would a kid on a football field, saying *go get 'em tiger*. I didn't try to stop him or follow him. Lilith turned to me and laughed. "Ehhhhh," she said, rolling her eyes. "Leave it in his capable hands. Come with me and we'll watch the show."

I hesitated, glancing back at Jonny's muscled back as he moved, panther-like, toward my wife, who was laughing and talking to Prince Charming again.

"What am I doing?" I said to myself.

"It's not any different than some other guy talking to her," Lilith assured me. "He's just feeling her out, is all."

I looked back at Lilith.

She laughed again. "Or up. He's pretty good."

She rolled her eyes to my silence and pulled me toward the bar. "God, Thomas, I'm only trying to help."

We moved back to the bar. It was set up on a platform, so that patrons could easily turn and have a good view of the various stages in the club. Lilith put her hand on my arm a lot as she talked to me, and I was acutely aware of how much I looked like a guy in the club, with a stripper who was being paid to be friendly, chatting me up for free drinks or a lap dance... or maybe more. All my interest, however, was on the onyx sheen of my wife's hair, lit with a corona of the red light that bathed the ceilings. It was all I could really see of her from there. That and Jonny's dark head, hovering dangerously close to her.

Lilith caught my eye when I, at last, looked back at her. She grinned. "So, do you ever talk to her about this at all? Or do you just... pine for something silently?"

I didn't really feel like divulging any details of my sex life to Lilith, and I wasn't really sure what her game was at this point: she was being helpful, and while I didn't know her very well, Lilith struck me as the sort of person who only helped out when it benefited her somehow.

I shrugged.

"I thought maybe you guys had this sort of thing going, in Mexico."

"Oh, yeah," I said, shifting my eyes back to Jonny and April. Was it my imagination or were they sitting closer to each other? What did a guy like Jonny do or say when he approached a girl like April?

"But you didn't," Lilith said, trying to lure me into the conversation.

"What does a guy like Jonny do, anyway, when he's, like... in this sort of situation?" I asked her, interrupting. "How much did you tell him anyway?"

Lilith looked behind her in their direction and waved a hand carelessly. "Oh, that. Yeah... he's a real pro. Don't worry about it."

"But what did you *tell* him?" I insisted.

Lilith studied my face. "Yeesh," she commented. "You should probably figure out what you really want, Thomas." She pulled out her phone and swiped at it before flipping it around to face me.

I scanned the messages.

Got a friend here who wants his wife to play. She's a little prude. Want to meet them?

Always ready to help

You free tonight?

Not really

This was followed by a picture of April, taken somewhere in the club that evening. It was blurry, and didn't do her justice, but it highlighted her long, scantily-clad legs, the firm plumpness of her perfectly-sized breasts, and the curve of her red mouth, caught in an inviting moment of parted lips that almost seemed to be panting.

It prompted Jonny to reply:

Where are you?

I read and re-read the conversation. Guilt licked at my insides: this conversation came dangerously close to pimping my wife out. But the very thought that caused me guilt was also undeniably delicious: this conversation was *very close* to pimping my wife out.

I met Lilith's eye over the rim of her phone after I had read it several times. She was watching me with interest.

"Lilith," I said. "Tell me something, what do you get out of all this?"

Lilith laughed, and replaced her phone in her garter with deliberate, teasing slowness. She winked behind me, which gave me the impression that someone was watching her, and she liked it very much. In a chipper voice, she answered: "Get out of it? Nothing, really. I just like everyone to have as much fun as I'm having."

I considered telling Lilith that it honestly seemed a little more sinister than that, but she seemed to presage that comment. She put her hand on my arm again and moved it flirtatiously along my bicep. "Listen, Thomas, I just thought I could help out. I'm not trying to... I don't know... start some kind of conspiracy here or something." She glanced behind her again. "Why don't you just let Jonny talk to her a while, and then see what happens?"

*

I'd love to have a detailed description of the salacious things that "happened" once Jonny arrived at the strip club, sat down next to my wife by sort of pushing some other guy out of the way, and then started talking to her.

But mainly, the next two hours or so consisted of me wandering around, sitting first here and then there, staring like a creepy pervert at Jonny and my wife, and attempting to look like I wasn't doing that by casting unseeing glances at the stage. Parades of very athletic, beautiful, and some sinister-looking girls pranced and danced onstage.

When I looked over at Jonny and April, they looked like a scene from another place entirely. Like they were on a first date at a respectable

restaurant. April was laughing, moving her hands around to explain things, and Jonny was leaning on the table, engrossed by her, but he wasn't putting any *real* moves on her as far as I could tell.

It was still titillating, don't get me wrong: April hadn't looked around for me, and was drinking a lot, and didn't seem in the least concerned or remorseful that she was talking to some guy all night, at a strip club, while her husband was doing whatever it was she thought I was doing. That's *if* she thought of me at all.

But it didn't look like some hotwife hit man had been loosed upon my wife.

"Give it time," Lilith said at some point, when she arrived at the bar in some random guy's arms and, without looking at me, asked for some shots.

I wasn't even sure if she had been talking to me. I was getting a little bleary-eyed.

Lilith disappeared. I noticed this as the hour grew late and Jonny and April just sat there, "talking." There were fewer people at the club at this point. The bartender called out last call.

I staggered down to the table.

"April," I said loudly, and the music ended halfway through her name. She looked up.

"Time to go," I said.

Jonny turned to look at me. "Hey, Tommy," he said.

No one calls me that.

"Hey, Jon," I remarked. I couldn't have told you whether I was being sarcastic or a dick or what. I didn't know how he knew my name, and I wasn't even sure we hadn't been introduced. I was feeling sour: disappointed, on the one hand, because nothing had happened between them; and bitter, on the other, because something sort of *had*.

Jonny gave me an actually friendly grin.

April looked back and forth from me to Jonny and back again.

The lights came on.

"Time to go," Jonny said. "Better hurry or we'll be waiting for a cab forever."

And then, like we were all best friends who had come there together, he walked out with us and somehow got a cab. His fingers were lightly pressed to the small of April's back as we pushed our way to the front door.

CHAPTER 14

April poured herself into the backseat, giggling, and fell over once her butt hit the bench. This gave Jonny, no doubt, a view straight up her skirt and to her panties, which I reminded myself dutifully that she was in fact wearing.

Jonny leaned on the door casually and raised his eyebrows to me. "So?" he said. "You want me to come home with you guys?"

I glanced at April, who was leaning back up and repositioning herself on the bench. I looked back at Jonny and sucked in my breath. I couldn't actually believe that there were people who were this... straightforward, and cut-and-dry, about this kind of thing. Also, I had no idea what the hell was going on anymore.

"I think..." I said, "April is pretty drunk, man."

I didn't want to offend him or anything, but taking a step that deep didn't seem like the best idea right now.

"Sure," he said, amicably. He closed the door and leaned through the open window to April. "Bye-bye April," he told her, and for a moment I thought he might kiss her. "Hope I see you again soon."

I missed whatever April said, because Jonny was turning toward me. "All right man, Lilith's got my number if you want to play some time."

"Uh," I stumbled. "Yeah, we're, uh... kind of new to this, so I..." I trailed off, not really sure where I was going with that.

He punched me in the arm. "Sure. I get it. But I'm really good at making girls like April come around." He grinned. "Lots."

A pain in my abdomen let me know that my cock was about as hard as it could get, and all further arousal was going to feel like a kick to the groin. We walked around the car together.

"Did, uh... you know, she seem kind of into it?" I asked him. "What's your feeling?"

He leaned toward me. "I can get your wife," he said, assured, "to do things you can't even imagine." He put his hands in his pockets. "So, give me a call." He stepped backward and leaned down to see April through the window. "Bye, bye April."

He said it sweetly, but it sounded, to my ears, about as filthy as anything I'd ever heard.

*

"Soooo," I said, after I'd re-iterated to the driver which route to take home, because of the construction on our street, and we'd been silently simmering in the back seat together for a bout ten minutes. "Have a nice time with Jonny?"

April started to answer. I could see that her first instinct was to summon a typical defense, something along the lines of *what are you talking about?*

But she stopped herself and brought a hand to her face coquettishly. "Maybe."

Another pang in my gut as my cock throbbed. I reached for her right knee, furthest away from me, and after a glance at the eyes of the driver in the mirror, I slid it along her thigh. "Maybe, huh?" I asked.

April didn't say anything. She just smiled, and her eyes dropped to my hand, then toward the driver, then frantically to my face. I was leaning over to her side of the car: it was obvious that something was going on in the back.

I smiled, and continued, moving my fingers along her thigh, meeting the boundary of her smooth dry skin with the slightly damp, hot tackiness of her upper thigh.

"Thomas," she whispered.

A word about this: a lot had happened that night, and much of it had been incredibly sexy. But the way April said my name, in a throaty whisper, with that tone of "we shouldn't" mixed with "but keep going," was the most erotic moment of the whole night.

"What did you think of him?" I said. I wasn't being especially quiet.

The driver was diligently paying us no mind, but April's eyes kept jerking to the back of his head, while her mouth fluttered between being scandalized, and wanting more. My fingers had reached her panties, and they were damp. I stroked the material with my pointer finger, pleased that I could feel, nestled in the soft bed of her labia, a hard sliver of her swollen clit, emerging to be stroked.

April's mouth fell open to express a little sigh.

"Did you like him?"

"*Thomas,*"

I drew my finger over her clit with the back of my finger, the hard nail just teasing the surface over her wet panties. April's eyes closed and she inhaled. A very slight tremor passed through her body.

"Seems like you liked him a lot," I suggested. I did it again, and another puff of air left her mouth.

Her eyes opened and met mine. In the limpid pools of cornflower blue something shimmered, foreign and hot. "He liked *me* a lot," she breathed.

"Mmm. And how do you know *that*?"

She leaned toward me, crossing her leg to enclose my hand in the soft flesh of her thighs. She nestled her mouth close to my neck. I could tell that she was very drunk by the clumsy way she moved, and by the laughter that seemed to be beneath the current of her voice. Still, it was a little unexpected when she said:

"I felt it."

"It" in this sentence could have meant anything: she "felt" his attraction the way one recognizes any other emotion in another person, a combination of words and body language and expressions.

But something about the way April said this made it very clear that "it" in that sentences meant only one thing: "his cock."

I drew back to look at her. I had not seen anything like that all night, and I had been watching like a hawk.

Was she fucking with me?

"Accidentally, of course," she added, with a smile.

But there was something about her tone, very strange for April, that left this open-ended: I couldn't read whether she was flat-out joking, or trying to amuse me and tease me because this scene was so similar to Mexico, or if she was trying to get a rise out of me (in either definition of the word).

"Mmm," I said.

The car rolled to a halt, a little harder than necessary. "We're here," the driver said, louder than necessary.

I paid him while April poured herself out of the car, in much the same way she had poured herself in. She took my hand and we stumbled up to the house.

*

We started peeling our clothes off as soon as we were inside. Streetlights outside our window cast a white glow over the interior, and it reflected off tiny bits of trashy strip-glitter that had somehow landed on April's skin.

Between wet, hungry kisses, I tried to pry more of this story from April. I put my fingers on her mouth to push her face in front of me and

look at her. "So how did you end up feeling this strange guy's cock?"

And April just laughed, sucked at the tips of my fingers and gave me a mysterious look, before kissing me wetly on the mouth. We stumbled to the bedroom. April was in just her thong by then, and she tossed herself on the bed, arms over her head in a fetching, erotic pose.

I climbed over her and ran my mouth all over her as I pulled her thong to her knees. Her skin had a faint taste of strip club to it, something from the sweetish air that seemed to prevail in that place. Flecks of glitter had landed in the exposure on her chest, a tiny bit of sweet brackish sweat punctuated the whole vaguely filthy taste of her.

She worked one leg out of her panties and I dove straight for her slit. The tiniest, trim line of feathery black hair that remained from her carefully trimmed bush was soaked with her sweet juices, and in the center she was hot and gushing with her tangy, sexy scent. I worked my tongue between her pussy lips, searching for her clit. When I found it, and pressed it between my tongue and upper lip, her body went rigid and she sucked in her breath.

I watched as I worked on her, rhythmically, maybe a little clumsily in my inebriated state. Her hips rolled against me, pressing her wet taint against my chin. She put her hands on my head, fingers raking my scalp, and mewled more loudly with every pulse of my tongue.

I was imagining her hands beneath the table at the sordid strip club, fingers wandering to the hardening lump in Jonny's jeans, caressing him. Did it excite her, to feel the outline of another man's cock? Was that what she was imagining behind her closed eyes?

I willed her, in my mind, both to lift her head and look at me, to meet my eyes and think of me when she came. At the same time, I willed her to escape to the thoughts of that other man, to imagine that it was him, instead of me.

But she did neither: she pulled on my hair, dragging me away from her pussy. "I want you inside of me," she breathed, looking me in the eyes, pulling me up to lie on top of her.

She wrapped her legs around me and bit gently on my lower lip as I entered her. She ground against me, and I could tell that she would come within seconds.

Her eyes closed, and she pulled herself up and around me, her teeth sharp in the meat of my shoulder. I felt her body stiffening with that final

second before release, thought of her hands again, working their way over another man, and then let the pain of her thinking about another man in that moment - of Jonny, of his fuller cock, of his unfamiliar taste and strength, instead of me - carry me over the edge.

I lay on top of her, feeling the tremors that coursed through her, the constriction of her silky cunt around my cock, the molten cum inside of her. Her teeth released me, her limbs relaxed, but she was still looking over my shoulder.

I imagined her staring at the ceiling, thoughts of Jonny in her head. My cock pulsed with a final spasm of cum.

When I finally rose up on my arms to look at her, her eyelids were heavy and she had a faint smile on her lips. She kissed me absently on the cheek, and her arm fell above her head.

"That was hot, April," I told her, hoping, in some drunken way, that I could wring something from her - more dirty talk, a secret, a window into her mind where I hoped she was thinking of another man.

"It was so..." April began. The words came slowly and slurred from her mouth, so I already knew, by the time she finished her sentence, that she was half-asleep. "Late," she said at last.

I rolled onto my side, and watched her as she fell almost immediately asleep, arm over her head, an unknowable thought leaving a faint smile on her lips.

CHAPTER 15

When I woke up, April was already taking a shower, so I sat up with the intention of joining her. My head revolted, and I had to hold it as I waited for the mistakes of the previous evening to slosh back and forth until they were still.

We have this old-style bathroom with a claw-foot tub, which is huge and charming and the sort of thing girls - especially girls like April - are delighted by and squeal about and love about the house when they see it staged for sale.

But the reality of having a claw-foot bathtub is not so great. No one actually wants to take baths, and April was so enthralled by the old-timey tub that she didn't even think about how she actually bathed. She also "just figured" I would build a shower eventually, which I am doing, at a glacial pace.

In the meantime, I erected a shower curtain rod around the bathtub, and there is an expensive white curtain lurking inches from you at all times, threatening to lunge and stick to you. I called it "The Rapist" until April made me stop.

It is, however, very fun to sneak up on your wife and peek into the shower, so it isn't all bad. The curtain comes together at the back of the tub, and so I can easily peek in and get a nice view of April, either standing with her nice bum facing me, or with her arms over her head, pushing soap and water from her hair so that the bubbles glide over her slightly bobbing breasts, toward her navel, and then kiss her slit on their way to forming rivulets on her inner thighs.

"I know you're there," she said, smiling. Her eyes were closed because she was washing her hair. My gaze, unobserved, tended to go to places April might not approve of me staring at, like today, when I drank in the sight of her slightly reddened pussy lips.

"Can I come in?"

This was a joke, because two people cannot shower in this monstrosity without everyone getting wrapped up in the curtain, which we both agree is gross.

April shook her head and smiled.

"That was some pretty hot sex last night," I told her, watching her turn to face the shower head and drinking in the view of her toned bottom. Her

black hair was even darker and shiner, and it clung to the center of her back in a tidy v-shape that I found erotic for some reason.

"Hey," she said after a while, "can you get me a towel?"

I did, and she was still blind as she reached for it. She wiped her face off first and then began to dry off.

"That," she declared, drying her hair, "was a wild night."

She pulled the curtain aside and stepped onto the rug, dripping water still because she hadn't dried her hair completely. I watched her find another towel, hang upside down to wrap it up in that turban-thingy that women do, and then enjoyed the show of her body for a few seconds more until she wrapped herself up in the towel. She went into the section of the bathroom with the vanity and wiped the steam from the mirror.

I took out my toothbrush so it looked like I had a reason to be there other than just creeping her.

"I'm surprised Lilith is still so... wild," April said, pressing her fingers to her skin and watching what she was doing.

"Really?" I asked.

April gave me the side eye, and then went back to what she was doing.

"She was pretty crazy in Mexico," I said.

"True."

This wasn't really what I had wanted to talk about. I put the toothbrush in my mouth and started moving it around. April continued to do things to her face, with lotions and cotton balls, and I watched, fathoming none of it.

"What are you doing?" she said suddenly, laughing. "You aren't even brushing your teeth."

I wasn't. I spat and rinsed my brush.

April laughed again, and started to curl her long, doe-like lashes with something that looked like a medieval torture device.

"So," I began, and April stopped, holding her curler, and looking at me through the mirror. I supposed my tone sounded pretty serious. I walked my fingers over to her on the counter and touched her arm. "Last night was, like... a really good time," I said, hopefully.

April smiled. "Yeah...?" she said. She leaned in toward the mirror and brought the curler to her other eye.

I sighed. Then I re-grouped. I didn't know what I was sighing about, exactly. Maybe that April seemed so cavalier about these nights when she

indulged in my fantasies, but then the next morning she seemed to want to act like it never happened, or maybe she just didn't care that it had.

Or maybe *I* was the crazy one, wanting to re-live it.

"Well, I thought it was pretty hot, you flirting with that Jonny guy..." I said.

April blinked and admired her lashes, and for a moment, I felt like she might act like she hadn't heard me. Instead, she turned to me and leaned on the counter. She leaned so that her shoulder rose up to her left cheek, and she pressed her face to it. The towel piled on her head tipped and threatened to fall over. She reached up with one hand and tried to steady it, gave up, and pulled it from her hair, which tumbled around her shoulders, disheveled. "It wasn't... too much?" she asked.

I was taken aback by this. "April... I told you... it was hot. I thought you knew that."

April looked at the counter and shook her head slowly, then sank her whole row of front teeth into her lower lip while she sucked in her breath. "It just seems like... I don't know."

I waited.

"A little bit... wrong, you know?"

She lifted her eyes to meet mine at the end of this sentence. I felt like she had shivved me in such a way that the knife cut right through my chest and then curved, right through my cock, only instead of pure pain it was a mix of arousal and pain.

"Thomas?"

I reached for her elbow. "I mean, that's sort of the thing, you know?" I said. I pulled her toward me. "It is a little bit wrong."

April looked at my eyes, studying them. She seemed to believe me. "You're sure you're not mad about any of it...?"

I kissed her without answering that question, because I felt like I might say something stupid. April was like a very fragile flower opening now, and I didn't want to shred any petals by being overeager.

"So... that guy Jonny...? Is he the kind of guy you're attracted to?"

April leaned away from me.

Wrong move?

I put a hand to her hair and tucked it behind her ear. "Hypothetically, of course."

April looked confused.

"I'm just asking. You know. If you were to ever, say, hook up with a guy other than me... is that the kind of guy you'd hook up with?"

April squirmed a little and brought her arms close to her body, raising her shoulders. "I wouldn't *do* that, Thomas, you know that."

I put a hand on her shoulder and moved her hair so that I could lightly rub my fingers over the first vertebrae between her shoulders. Her skin dimpled. I moved down between her shoulder blades. "Just hypothetically," I whispered. "Humor me."

April smiled. "Hypothetically?"

"Totally."

Her lips were parted, her breath a little quicker, and she seemed like she was going to say something I very much wanted to hear.

But then she stepped away and laughed, looking at the ceiling. "Oh my God, Thomas," she said, as if it were all just a big joke.

"April," I said, putting my hand out again. "Look, I'm kind of... I'm a little bit serious here."

She narrowed her eyes, and her mouth fell open in disbelief.

"How serious?" she asked.

I looked at my fingers on her hand. *Okay, Thomas, baby*, I remember thinking. *This is the big Kahuna*.

"Well, uh... pretty, fairly, you know... serious. In the sense that, I feel like I keep telling you I'm *serious*, serious, and you seem to, you know, play along with it. And then you don't really seem to believe me the next day, and I want to... clarify, I guess, that *if* you were having any thoughts that were a little more, you know, actually serious, then..." I looked up at her. "That might be... that *would be*, okay. With me."

April blinked. Her eyes went wide. "I thought... this was all just... fooling around," she said. And she said it in this tone of voice that made it sound like she was looking at the end of the universe or something. *Awed*.

I have to admit, this exasperated me. I didn't see the exasperation coming: I'd been turning moments like this over and over in my mind since... well, forever, but especially since Mexico. I guess I had always fantasized about them going in a slightly different direction.

"I mean, April, *really*?" I heard myself saying, and I really wanted to clamp a hand over my own mouth.

April looked stunned, and I guess if I were April I would look stunned, too. Because April knows, deep down inside, she's got me wrapped around

her little finger, and I never said anything like this.

So then I felt my mouth moving, and I heard sound coming out of it, but it was like someone had stuck a hand up my ass and I was a puppet. Seriously, what the fuck was I saying? This was the kind of shit they told you to *never do* on all those forums, this was the beginning of someone's sad post about how their wife had left them when they brought up the topic. This was, in layman's terms, a class-A fuckup. But I just kept going.

"I mean, April... why play all those games? You let that guy in Mexico feel you up, practically, on the dance floor, you walked around pretending to have some Slovenian accent and flirting with guys, and afterward we had hot sex, and you can't tell me that just had nothing to do with any of it. Did I seem *un-serious* about it then? It's like you're two different people, and I just -"

I ended with a sigh because April's eyes were looking damp. If she started crying, I wasn't sure what I would do. I put a hand on her arm.

But she wasn't crying. Not yet.

"I just can't *actually believe* that you want me to *actually* have sex with another guy," she said. "For real?"

I waved my hands around in frustration. "*What* about anything I've said about this makes you think I didn't *actually* want that?"

April closed her mouth, and stared at me, and then turned furiously to face the mirror. "I guess," she said, after a long, cool silence, "that when we got married and said we were going to be faithful to each other, that *that's* what you said that made me think you didn't want me running around and screwing other guys."

This felt like an ice pick aimed at my heart.

She took out a powdery makeup and started scrubbing at it furiously with a brush. I'm no expert in makeup but it didn't look like very proper technique.

The realization that I had screwed up was slowly pouring over me. "April," I began, with the fervent hope that I would think of something brilliant to say after that. "It's not..."

A million words of Reddit posts dumped into my consciousness and swirled around like a hurricane of sentences. Desperately, I reached for one.

"It's not being unfaithful, honey, if it's something we do together. And plan together. Then it's different."

The furious scrubbing stopped. April looked in the mirror. The predominant expression on her face was disbelief, and beneath that, anger. "I don't want to have some open relationship," she spat. Her eyes met mine in the reflection. Then she tapped her brush on the counter and a mountain of pink powder fell into the sink.

I was just finally processing some of the things I'd said. I'd really fucked the pooch, I was realizing. It was time to retreat, regroup, and possibly never bring this up again. April isn't the type to get mad, and now she seemed fully steamed.

I held my hands up. "Listen, God, of course, okay," I said. "If it's not something you want, April, then of course we don't have to do anything like that."

"I thought we were just... role-playing or something," April said.

"I'm sorry," I said quickly, because that is usually the right thing to say. "I'm sorry, it's not... I just didn't understand... where the line was."

April swept some of the blush onto her cheek. It was too thick, very bright. "Pssssh," she hissed, frowning. She reached for a Kleenex and took four out in quick, angry succession. Then, without wiping it off, she turned to me. "I think the line is, I just... that's not for me. I can't believe you would even think I would... do that. For real."

She turned to face herself in the mirror. She wiped at her cheek. Then she sighed. "I always have this problem," she said.

I cocked my head. "What?"

"Just..." April leaned in and looked at her face more closely. "This same problem, being friends with Lilith. Everybody always assumes that because Lilith is so... free-spirited... and we're friends, that I'm going to be like that, too."

I was formulating an answer when she shifted her gaze to meet my eyes in the reflection again. "I'm *not*."

So look, if you've read this far you're probably thinking what I was thinking at that moment: it *was* pretty difficult to believe that April had been friends with the wild and lascivious, sexually charged Lilith for so long, and that not one iota of that libertine spirit had rubbed off on her. That she had never, ever, done anything naughty in all the time she'd spent parading around with the naughtiest girl I'd personally met in my lifetime.

And there was a deep, deep pull inside of me to say something to that effect.

But April's voice had a hard, hard, *titanium-level hard*, tone to it.

It was a swing and a miss.

It was a hard no.

It was time to shut the fuck up for Thomas Roberts.

"April," I said smoothly. "Look. We don't have to say another thing about this. Okay? If it's not cool with you, it's not cool with me, and that's that. Okay? I don't want you to do anything you don't want to do. I love you. I just want you to be happy."

Or, basically, that's what I said. It was all the stuff that I pile on when I've stepped over the line about anything, and it's all completely 100% true, so don't go thinking I wasn't being sincere: it's just that you have to have a stockpile of this kind of stuff ready, so you can carpet-bomb it, hoping one of those things hits the target.

April turned to face me. "Promise?"

"Promise. I won't bring it up again. Okay?"

This was a devastating thing to hear myself saying. I wasn't even sure that was a promise I could keep forever, but I knew it was a promise I could keep for a very long time, because April, as I've explained, is way out of my league and I am not about to fuck up my marriage because of a fantasy that, let's face it, I never really believed I'd see play out in real life anyway.

April turned back to the mirror. "Okay," she said quietly.

Behind her eyes, I thought she looked troubled. But she just leaned toward the mirror and kept applying makeup, and so I thought it was probably in my best interests to leave well enough alone.

"I'm... going to go make some coffee," I said.

"Great," April said. She tried to sound cheerful. Her eyes darted to mine, and she gave me a weak smile.

I resolved to successfully make a heart in her latte, which is something I always found a little lame, but today seemed like a day to make an exception.

CHAPTER 16

The next few weeks were quiet time, during which I silently prayed that a document server would not show up and slap me with divorce papers. There were a few chilly nights, and I thought of bringing the topic up with her, asking her if she wanted to talk about it, but to be honest, I didn't really want to go there.

April thawed after a few days, and things went back to normal. Thomas Roberts resolved to thank his good fortune and never say or do anything stupid again as long as he lived, and that way he would live happily ever after with his beautiful wife. I wasn't going to fly too close to the sun. Not me.

Weeks went by, and April didn't talk about Lilith at all. My play, in all of this, was to go with the flow. If April ever went out with Lilith again, with or without me, I'd assess and adapt. But for the time being, I was going to keep my trap shut and soldier on, because I know when I have a good thing, and I know when to shut the hell up. As I've mentioned.

We had gone out to dinner at an imminently forgettable restaurant, when April received what I think of as "The Invitation." It came to her as a text, which she read because we were just kind of sitting there, waiting for a meal we no longer felt like eating, because we had both forgotten to eat all day, ordered poutine, and were now feeling the way anyone feels after eating poutine.

April fished her phone from her purse, read the text, and smiled. Her face brightened, and I of course had a flare of jealousy without knowing what the text was or where it had come from. A vibration in her hand indicated that another text popped up while she was reading the first, and her eyes moved over the new message as I watched.

I hate to admit to getting annoyed and jealous about something like that, but anything that makes April light up and is unknown to me irks me a little.

After reading this second message, though, her face fell a little, and she pushed her lips together.

Then she slipped the phone back into her purse without saying anything, which only caused my mild jealousy to flare up.

I dug into some poutine to give myself something to do while I waited for her to tell me what was going on. She didn't.

She had a spaced-out look in her eyes when I looked up at her.

"Everything okay?" I asked her. I gestured with a fork at her purse.

"Who was that?"

April picked up a fork and stabbed it into the poutine. She shrugged, looked at the wall behind me. "Lilith. She bought a house."

I made a strange face, trying to be funny and concerned at the same time. I was glad she wasn't looking "Why so glum, chum?"

April quickly pulled herself together and smiled. "No, no, not... I'm not. That's great for her."

She put some poutine in her mouth and chewed, nodding, I guess to further agree with herself.

I cocked my head. "So... what's wrong?"

April's mouth was full and she put a napkin up to it. She shook her head vigorously. "Mmm-mmm," she mumbled, rapidly. Finished chewing. Opened her mouth before she was completely finished, which is *not* something April does. "No, nothing."

I gave her my "suspicious" face, which consists of me squinting with one eye.

Her phone vibrated again.

Then again.

"You gonna check that?" I asked her. I admit to beginning to get well-on jealous-annoyed (my buddy Dan calls it "jealoyed") at this point, and to trying to hide it.

I'm not a huge fan of this aspect of my personality.

She looked at her purse, as if she seemed surprised it was there. "Yeah, what? That's... no. She's just, uh, sending me some information. Is all."

"Information," I repeated.

April nodded. Then she looked at me like I was the crazy person.

"What?" she asked.

"You're acting really strange," I told her.

April sighed, and spread her napkin on her lap while she looked at the ceiling. "Okay, it's... yeah, well, Lilith is having a housewarming party. And so she invited us. And, I probably should go."

"Okay...?"

"But I just... I don't know. I don't want to have any weird... thing. You know. Like, about Lilith, or our, you know... thing, we talked about, from before."

I sat back, and put my hand on my beer, sensing I would probably need it. "Baby, I told you, there's no need to worry about any of that. It's... a closed topic. Okay? You closed it, so it is *closed*."

"I know," April said, like she didn't.

"Just...?" I prompted.

She shrugged. "I don't know. I... do you *want* to go?" Then, without waiting for me to answer, she sighed. "I don't think there's really any way *out* of going."

"When is it?"

"In like two weeks, Saturday."

I took a sip of my beer. "Look, if you want to go, go. If you want me to go, I'll go with you. If you don't want to go, just tell her you have something else. I mean, it's just a housewarming party. Don't... I didn't even realize people did those anymore."

"Lilith has whatever kind of party she can think of," April said, as if she had known I was going to say that and we had rehearsed this conversation a thousand times. She sighed again.

I wasn't sure what she wanted.

"What's the problem?" I asked, when she continued to look like this decision was causing her a lot of pain. Which, to be fair to April, wasn't all that uncommon. Sometimes she looked like this while deciding what to have for dinner. "Decisive" is not a word I'd use to describe my wife.

April sighed again and shrugged and looked upward. "Ehhhhh," she said. "I don't... know."

I ventured a smile. It was a big gamble, because I really had no idea what April's problem was at the moment.

She - kind of - smiled back.

"Lilith's parties are sometimes a little crazy," she said.

"Got it," I told her. "And you are *not*."

"Exactly."

"Well, if you want to go, why don't we go early, leave early, and that way you've done your friend duty and we can avoid... the crazy part?" I suggested.

I am, after all, in logistics.

April seemed pleased with this, so I guess it was the right move.

And that was that.

Until.

Jonny is going to be there.

I stared at the text for a long time. It was obviously Lilith: Lilith was the only person, other than April, who knew "Jonny" and also me.

I had no idea how she'd gotten my number.

How'd you get my number?

Lilith did not reply to this. I set my phone down and waited. Hours passed, with me picking the phone up every fifteen minutes and looking to see if I had missed her message somehow.

Well, genius, I thought. What now?

I had no idea what Lilith's game was, and that was the truth. Maybe she was just a mischievous imp, which rang true for me in all ways except one, and that one way was a real kink in the analysis: her friendship with April.

If April was really the April I knew, virtuous, a little prudish, snow-white and pure, then it was really hard to understand how their friendship worked, and why it had lasted so long.

Really hard. For one thing, what did April see in Lilith? And what did Lilith see in April? They were like night and day.

Their friendship, on the other hand, made a lot more sense (and incidentally, made my cock a lot harder), if there was *something else* stirred in there: that April *used* to be much different. Perhaps April was wild back in the day. Maybe she bent her own rules every now and then, and let her hair down, or had a few one-night stands she didn't want to tell me about.

That went down as a sweet, burning elixir, for sure. April, with a sordid past. A fertile, sordid past that was ripe to be re-planted with more sordid seeds for more future sordid deeds...

Maybe, I thought, in my more hopeful moments, Lilith's *game* was to re-corrupt her friend.

That was a delightful thought, because it meant that Lilith's game ultimately benefited me.

However, it also made me feel a little bad, because if I were to play along with Lilith's game, and that's what it was, we were sort of teaming up on my wife.

And I was pretty sure that sort of thing, if discovered, was not going to fly with April.

So I pondered all of that for a long, long time, while waiting to hear from Lilith again. But the maddening, mysterious Lilith never got back to me.

And I wasn't about to go chasing her down about it.

The only question remaining was this: did I say something to April, or not?

If I did, what would I say? Lilith sent me a random text telling me Jonny will be at her party? That's all she wrote, and I don't even know how she got my number? How would April take that?

On the other hand, I thought, it could be some kind of loyalty test. What if April had put Lilith up to it, to see if I would mention it to April?

That seemed too demented for my wife, but the thought niggled in dark corners of my mind.

And then of course, to this marinade, you add the fact that the idea of Jonny showing up at this party and interacting with my wife was kind of... pleasant, and fun, and what I really kind of wanted to happen, and you can see why, after going rounds and rounds about everyone's motivations, I allowed myself to come to the following conclusion:

Lilith was just being impish.

She had asked April for my number under some party-planning pretext.

April did not know about this, and if I didn't communicate any more with Lilith, I wasn't conspiring with her impish ways. I could, for example, delete these messages and claim to "not remember" what exactly had been exchanged between us.

So... I deleted Lilith's message and pretended I didn't know that Jonny was coming to the party.

Except I knew that he was, so I can't honestly claim that I didn't act upon any of the events that followed.

*

You're not going to believe this

????

They don't have the order for 6

WHAAAT?

They heard 7.

*They can make us some but it'll be like 45 minutes
because of the chicken*

*You want it anyway? I don't mind waiting, I can run
some errands.*

*I was soooo looking forward to this
I'll just wait. I can get you a dessert from Pedro's*

April's favorite food is a barbecue chicken meal from a churresqueria like twenty minutes from our house. I *may* have suggested it to her, and I *may* have offered to call in the order. This place runs a serious business, and they run out of chicken all the time if you don't order ahead. You have to pay over the phone and everything, otherwise it's your gamble.

I *may* have not given the correct time.

The logic was this: I had told April we should go to Lilith's party early and leave early, and I wasn't about to be the person to suggest something else. But, judging from Jonny's appearance, he wasn't the kind of guy to show up at a house party at 6pm.

Was this devious? A little bit. But I justified it to myself like this: I was not breaking any promises to April. I wasn't bringing up the topic, I wasn't trying hard to put these two together, I hadn't asked Jonny to actively seduce my wife or anything.

I was just making us a little later to a party, and then I would stay the hell out of the way.

I don't even consider that tipping the scales, necessarily.

The chicken, to my delight, ended up not being ready until 7:30, for which I profusely apologized. But you have to understand how April is a maniac with this chicken. Once she thinks she's going to have it, she fasts the whole day so she can eat a ton of it.

I *may* have eaten kind of slowly.

I *may* have deliberately forgotten to grab an extra bottle of vodka for Lilith's gift.

I may have added just a little friction to every transaction and event taking us to the party, so we didn't get there until 9:30.

But after that, things rolled along of their own accord. And that is the truth.

*

"Seriously. What the *fuck* does Lilith do for a living?" I said, coming to a stop on the sidewalk and staring up at what was apparently Lilith's house.

It was a long, modernized, ranch-style house, atop a hill, overlooking a golf course, and it was in a neighborhood that I frankly wasn't even sure plebes like us were allowed to walk around in.

April was holding my hand. She did not answer this question.

Instead, she tugged me up the very expensively landscaped steps to a front porch with floor-to-ceiling windows looking in on a very busy party,

with a thick wooden door between them that looked more expensive than my car.

"*Seriously*," I hissed. "What in the actual fuck does she do?"

April looked over at me, her hand paused in mid-air near the doorbell. She hilariously put her hand up, with the back of her palm to her face - hilariously, because there was only me and the big wooden door out there to read her lips - to whisper, "I think it's something on the internet."

And then she gave me this look like I was supposed to know what that was.

"The internet is a big place, April," I said, as she knocked on the door, which had an immense knocker in the shape of a skull on it - utterly out of place with the original decor and clearly Lilith's doing. "Find out which *part* of it she's on."

I cannot be sure if this happened or not, because my imagination is pretty active, and the door was opened at that exact moment, so the noise of the party drowned it out, but I *think* I heard April say, sardonically:

"Heeeeh, I think you know which part."

But I didn't have time to address that.

*

The inside of Lilith's house was just as extravagantly expensive looking as the outside, and for someone who had just moved back to town, she had a ton of friends. In appearance, they ranged from mildly-pornographic to imminently Instagramable, with a few boring guys like me scattered reassuringly around and looking as if they were aware that they were Token Normal People.

"Whoa," I said, which was a comment on the house as well as the guests.

April did not seem surprised to have walked in on a party that looked as if someone had gone through central casting to make it look hip and beautiful. She scanned the room, and ended her survey at a table piled high with unwrapped gifts, most of which were booze.

Lilith was nowhere in sight, which I guess I didn't find very surprising.

April looked back at me, and smiled. "Guess I'll go find Lilith," she said. And then she melted into the throng of good-looking people as if she lived at that place.

April was wearing a pair of tight, stylish jeans, the kind that come with fashionable little tears in them and faded patches in all the right places.

They looked particularly great on her, making her legs look longer than usual. They were helped out by a sexy pair of strappy red heels, and a red-orange, silky camisole with spaghetti straps that alternated slipping from one smooth shoulder, and then the other, and teased about sliding from her skin at the same time. It was full-time entertainment just watching her straps slip, the silk fabric pucker sexily, the trim at the top of the garment puckering sensually, slipping to just where I might have gotten a glimpse of her breast. But she always caught it with an elegant finger, and dropped it back into place in a smooth motion. Her long black hair swung behind her shoulders, shiny as her silky top, parted down the middle. Even among all the pretty and sexy people at Lilith's party, she stood out. She was striking, that's what April always was.

As I watched her move gracefully around the large, open rooms, I was pleased to see that more than one male head turned to watch her walk away. In the kitchen, which was just a conglomerate of counters and high-end stainless steel appliances in the middle of all this open space, she was absorbed in a conversation by several guys.

I was still standing by the door. My cock swelled as April put her arms around one of the guys and smiled affectionately.

I stood, hands in my pockets, not quite sure what to do with myself. The door knocked behind me.

I let people in, and because I am this kind of person, I started directing them to put their gifts on the table and make themselves a drink in the kitchen.

"Hey, I'm Mark," one of them said, like I was supposed to know him.

"Oh yeah," I said jovially. "I'm the famous Thomas." I shook his hand vigorously. "Good to finally meet you."

"Yeah, man," he agreed wholeheartedly.

I absolutely fucking hate parties, and this is the reason why. But not all parties are created equal, and this one hopefully had an Easter Egg within it, for the clever and patient.

I followed my new friend Mark to the kitchen and offered to make him a drink.

Might as well blend.

*

A good deal of time went by, and Lilith eventually appeared from a hallway, all luminescent skin and filmy fabric and long, eternally tossing

white-blond hair. I made a little nest for myself on a couch (there were four) for a while and tried to look like part of a grouping of people there.

"Thomas," Lilith said, smiling, when we ended up in the kitchen making a drink.

"Lilith," I said, with a neutral smile. I still didn't know what our relationship was, or what game was being played, or really what the hell was going with Lilith, so I felt it was best to stay neutral.

Lilith just poured herself a drink and tilted her chin up, grinning.

"Nice house," I told her.

She finished pouring her drink, turned, and surveyed the living room and kitchen - and this was a big, open space with like forty people in it and no one was crammed. "Thanks. I really liked it, you know, in the photos, but then you move in, and it's just really... too open concept."

I had no idea what to say. Lilith struck me as an open-concept kind of gal.

What I *wanted* to know is when Jonny would be arriving, but I didn't want to voice that question, because I still needed everything to look like I had nothing to do with any of it, whatever "it" turned out to be.

Lilith waited, looking at me, with the amused and predatory gaze of an impish cat. Then she tapped my glass with hers. "Cheers," she said, and disappeared.

I paused at April's conversation cluster long enough to be introduced to a few people, and then I was swept away, back toward the sliding glass doors that led to Lilith's killer back yard, and tried to blend in while keeping an eye on April and trying to decide when to call it quits on this party.

"Anyone know what Lilith does for a living?" I asked loudly.

This had the effect of stopping the conversation, and then making everyone laugh, before they started talking again.

It was 11:05.

*

April saw Jonny enter at the same time I did. She was talking in a cluster of three women, her plastic cup in her hand, held to her chest, this very April-esque way of holding drinks. Nodding, smiling, being her usual attentive conversation partner.

People like talking to April because she actually listens to whatever bullshit they're telling her and asks interested, meaningful questions about it all. Her large, big eyes seem alive and hooked on whatever you're saying.

The door was to April's left, but within her peripheral vision. The outer edges of it, mind you.

Which is why, when Jonny's unmistakably fit torso filled the doorway, pausing for a moment to scan the party and look for whoever he was looking for, April saw only the outlines of his form. The peripheral, blurry view of his shape, or his gait, or his aura of confidence was all she got - and it was all she needed to identify him.

Her eyes immediately telescoped, her gaze drifting from the closed circle of women to something beyond them, a wall or a painting she wasn't really seeing. The drink traveled to her neck, and then hastily back again. Her lips parted, and she looked like she had just smoked a cocaine-laced blunt.

I couldn't have actually seen this detail of course, but it *seemed* like a wave of goosebumps rose on her smooth arms. Her skin turned red, and she began to fidget.

Of course, I can't say that nothing happened to me. My stomach plunged to my shoes, my heart felt like it was being kneaded for bread.

Jonny was not a snazzy dresser, or loud, or outrageously good-looking. He was wearing a gray t-shirt that was loose at his flat stomach and tight across his shoulders and chest. Jeans hid his evidently well-sized package and fit him well. He was a real specimen, but it wasn't like the ladies all turned to watch him or something.

No. The girls April was talking to kept chattering away, not having noticed him. Jonny walked behind April, clearly recognizing her, but he didn't make a move yet. He headed to the kitchen, where Lilith's room-filling presence could be heard laughing. April stared, vacantly, over her friend's head until he had passed. And then, slowly, unaware that I was watching her, she turned her head to the side, enough to see him clearly, to confirm what she obviously already knew.

She snapped it back. Her lips were smiling.

Then her face looked worried, and her eyes darted about, looking, I would guess, for me.

I sort of faded backwards to one of the walls in the middle of the floor and bumped into someone.

"Hiding?" It was another guy.

I looked him up and down. "Yeah," I said, using my favorite fake-hipster voice. It wasn't worth doing anything but agreeing.

He nodded, smiling idiotically. He was stoned. "I got you," he said, and looked into his beer.

I walked around the wall - it was only a couple of feet wide - and tried to look casual as I walked toward the kitchen. Jonny had found Lilith, and a drink, but was now leaning against a counter and sipping it, looking plainly in the direction of my wife.

Lilith was still talking to someone else - Jonny might have been waiting for her. She saw me coming, though, and gave me her devilish grin again.

"Hold on," I heard her say, coming toward me.

April was still diligently facing the opposite direction. I wondered what she was thinking: it was obvious she was thinking about Jonny, about his arrival, but who knew in what *way*?

She raised her eyebrows when she got to me. "Thanks, Lilith," she prompted me.

I shook my head. "I don't know if this is such a good -"

"Oh, God, Thomas, don't be such a bore."

"I just don't want... you know, April to think I invited him here or something. We sort of had a thing about it-"

Lilith waved her hands at me, dismissing whatever I was about to say. "I always invite Jonny," she said, a perverse smile on her lips. "He's... a good friend. We have an arrangement, anyway. If we both strike out, we can fuck each other."

I wasn't sure what to say about that, so I just stared at her.

"It's never happened," Lilith added, with an even more devious smile. She became suddenly bored by me. "God. Just... go sit on the porch or something. There're some guys out there who are a little too coked-up. Go tell them about your job and bore them out of a fucking heart attack, you'll be doing everyone a favor. As for Jonny, trust me. *Let nature take its course.*"

Lilith didn't give me any time to respond to this. She whirled away.

Jonny was looking at me when I shifted my gaze to where he was standing. He met my eyes for a second, and brought a beer to his lips. But I saw a faint smile on them before he did.

I stood there for a minute. April was still resolutely not turning around, looking through the friend she was talking to. Another woman started talking to Jonny, standing close in front of him. My heart was racing.

I really didn't want April to think I was pushing something. For the record, I would not have been ballsy enough to invite Jonny here. On the other hand, I could see that his arrival had clearly had an effect on her.

What could I do?

Lilith caught my eye and raised her eyebrows.

Let nature take its course.

I walked to the counter, swept up the first beer I saw, and headed to the porch.

*

The porch.

The porch was full of smokers, talking about smoking, which as far as I can tell is what people who smoke talk about whenever they are smoking: how they don't smoke here or there, or at this time or that time, when they started, how they plan to quit or when they did and then when they started up again.

The beer I had grabbed was a super light, fruity, girly beer and I regretted not making a better choice. It also, irritatingly, required an opener.

I asked for a lighter and got an offer for a cigarette, which I lit and held to my lips but didn't inhale. I had quit smoking three years before. April hated it, and so she said, "You have to quit," and I did. I know the score.

I used the lighter to open the beer, which impressed an extremely drunk woman and drew me into the conversation.

My back was to the house, and the smokers provided good cover: I was just a guy out here talking to these guys, not interested at all in the guy with the huge dick who liked to "break in" girls like April, or how my wife would interact with him. Everyone was too drunk to notice I wasn't inhaling.

I finished the cigarette without taking much of a drag, but by then I actually wanted to smoke. I held out for a while, talked about hockey with some random guy who came out and inhaled three cigarettes in two minutes, and then departed.

It went on like this for as long as I could stand it. I stood up, walked out into the yard, pretended to examine some horticultural shit out there—which, if April was watching, would have made her come take my temperature. I don't know a hibiscus from a carrot, and I take big pains to tell anyone who will listen that I also don't care.

Then, after staring at the fence with a racing heartbeat, empty girl-beer shaking slightly in my hand, I inhaled, and turned around.

There was a good view of the entire house from out there. The windows were large and formed almost the entire back side of the house. The open-concept floor plan made it easy to see who was inside, to look for April's sheen of black hair among all the drab browns and bottled blonds was no task, ever. She was tall, she was beautiful, she was no Waldo. I can find April in any crowd within moments.

But April was not there. Not on the brightly-lit side of the house where the party was happening. There were rooms stretching out to my right, with lights behind them and curtains closed, shadows moving behind them, and my gut seized as I thought of the implications.

I scanned for Jonny, which was also an easy task if you are, like me, obsessed with your wife's attraction to another man. He's easy to spot, it's like you get a radar for that sort of thing.

He, too, was missing from the scene, and my heart actually came to a thudding, loud stop for a beat. Lightning-quick, I thought about how I might be about to die, and then my pulse returned.

I strolled into the house.

Lilith was draped on the couch, her legs pouring all over the place the way she poured her shiny, perfect self all over everything like a glistening dessert topping. She had an arm around the neck of a guy she was leaning against, and a leg on the thigh of another. She was telling a story, it seemed like, and they were both, clearly, not *listening*.

I walked over to her. "Hey," I said, interrupting.

She made a puff with her lips and fluttered her eyes at me. "Hey yourself." She didn't move. The guys seemed annoyed I was interrupting.

Now, it's important to understand that the rest of this party seemed perfectly normal. People were just clustered together, getting a little drunk and talking loudly.

"You seen April?" I asked Lilith.

Lilith let me simmer for a little while. She dropped her hand from the thick male neck she had been toying with, made me wait some more, and then pointed, limply, toward the hallway leading to the bathroom and the bedrooms.

I looked in that direction. Lilith was grinning when I looked back at her.

"I think they're playing golf in the rec room," she said, abruptly laughing.

Rec room. So of course Lilith, who had some unknown and unfathomable job, and a bachelor's degree in business and French, would have a *rec room* in her house where people could play golf.

Because that all makes sense.

I turned and headed toward the hallway Lilith had vaguely indicated, looking around for what might be a rec room. Only as I passed it did I see a very wide stairway leading to a fully finished basement, brightly lit and covered with an expensive, thick carpet. Tittering and laughter indicated that a number of people were downstairs.

I reached the middle of the stairs, where my head was low enough to survey the room. I did so quickly, and caught sight of Jonny and my wife, standing on a section of - get this - putting green embedded in the expensive carpet. Before them was a large screen, some kind of expensive golf game simulator. I didn't look long: I saw that April was standing with a golf club in her hands, and Jonny was pressed up against her, "instructing" her on how to play golf.

I turned quickly, before they could see me, and pretty much ran back up the stairs, processing the image of Jonny's tattooed, bad-boy arms against April's pristine white skin. His groin against her lower back, whatever lurked beneath his jeans pressed up against her.

Lilith looked at me and smiled provocatively. She had her fingers in one guy's hair now and was petting him distractedly. "Find what you were looking for?"

She had to speak loudly to be heard, but Lilith had a very sexy way of raising her voice without ever sounding like anything but a purring cat.

Had I? Had I found what I was looking for? Jonny was working his magic on my wife, and my wife was obviously letting him. April didn't play golf, or give a shit about it, so there was something more there than idle curiosity.

The question was, why was I feeling the way I was about it?

I *wanted* her to do it.

I swung around the banister and went on a quest for more beer. I should just let nature take its course, like Lilith suggested, I was thinking.

I searched more carefully for a better beer, but finding none, started to raid the bottles of alcohol for something decent to make a drink with.

"What were they doing?" Lilith said, startling me. She had slipped into the kitchen and was leaning against the counter. She pushed some bottles aside and lifted herself, very gracefully and easily, onto the counter. "What are you making?"

"Playing golf. Something with rum," I said.

"Ugh, that golf thing is so *tacky*. I'm getting rid of it as soon as I think of what to put there instead." she picked at the bottles next to her. "Make me a martini?" she asked, handing a bottle of strange, discolored vodka to me.

"What is this?"

Lilith waved a hand at me. "Some Canadian thing, it's fine, it just tastes like vodka. I'm glad someone is using the putt-putt or whatever. " She grinned at me, studying my face. "So...? Is Jonny putting the moves on her or what?"

I dropped my eyes to read the vodka label. Then I looked back at Lilith.

She slid off the counter. "I'm just going to go see for myself," she told me. "Make me that, will you? Please?"

She gave my arm a playful squeeze.

So look, I had other things on my mind, and I'm *not*, technically attracted to Lilith, or her type.

But when she squeezed my arm and grinned at me and sashayed away in that crazy dress she was wearing, I could understand how Lilith might get pretty much anything she wanted.

I stared at the tile on the kitchen splashboard. It was some kind of glazed, hand-crafted shit that looked like it cost more than my whole house.

"Jesus," I muttered.

I looked over to see Lilith slinking down the stairs, giving me her same devilish smile, just before her head disappeared from view.

What did I want, here? Part of me wanted to go downstairs and watch April's "golf lesson." A part of me wanted April to look up, and turn red, and hurry over to tell me she was too drunk to stay and ask if I would take her home. A part of me wanted her to look over, while Jonny moved her arms for her and swung, grinding his solid chest and hard package against her back. I wanted her to look at me and do that thing she did with her tongue.

And then what?

Part of me wanted her to turn, and put her arms on Jonny's shoulders, give me one, last, flinty-eyed look, and then let Jonny taste her red lips.

Around me, the party swirled, while I wondered what to do. I was facing the counter, my dick was hard enough that a keen eye would notice, and I had no idea where to go at this party. I knew the factory-grade-smoker better than anyone else here.

I kept an eye out for Lilith and prepared her drink as slowly as I could.

*

Time passed incredibly slowly. I sat in the living room and engaged in a conversation I remember nothing about with a wildly red-haired girl who did not, on the face of it, seem old enough to be at this party. She offered me some drugs, which I declined, mostly on the basis of not even knowing what they were. And then I got fed up with waiting and started to walk downstairs.

Lilith was at the bottom, already climbing back up. A feral glint in her eyes flashed at me, and she held up one finger, subtly, in her left hand, sweeping it in a gesture that meant, *don't come down here*.

I backed up and waited for her.

Lilith dropped her eyes to my crotch, which made her already smirking grin even larger. She made a point of letting me see her looking, and then looked back up at my face. "I would maybe... give it a few more minutes. Or like, half an hour."

"What?" I said, stupidly.

Lilith rolled her eyes. "Did you make me a martini?"

I looked over at the living room coffee table. Lilith's martini was gone. "I think someone drank it. What is going on down there?"

"Jonny is trying to get your wife alone, what do you think?"

I stared at her. "What?"

"You know how April is. It's not the easiest." She leaned toward me and grinned even more broadly. "I slipped something in her beer," she whispered.

My eyes went wide in alarm. "What?!"

My first thought, of course, had been a date rape drug. I made a move toward the stairs. This was over the line.

Lilith put a hand on my chest. "Oh my god, Thomas, not a fucking roofie or something like that. Just... something fun. To loosen her up."

"What?" I asked, less panicked but still peeved.

"It's not like she's never taken anything like that before," Lilith snorted. "Jesus. It's just a teeny-tiny bit of ecstasy."

"Does she *know* you gave it to her?" My head was spinning. April had never mentioned anything like that in her past. My mind was thinking back on her comment, the unfinished conversation we'd had when Lilith had first moved here... "*nothing* that *crazy*..."

I had never found out *what* kind of crazy, though.

Lilith laughed abruptly again and rolled her eyes. "Oh my God, Thomas, you really are a piece of work. I didn't give her anything. This is *April* we're talking about. I would never hear the *end* of it."

I blinked at Lilith. I was breathing a little faster than normal, and I could feel some sweat gathering at my hairline. Lilith's hot hand was on my chest, disturbingly arousing, as she tried to stop me from going down the stairs.

"What, exactly...?" I said, finally, "Why, exactly, are you two friends, again?"

Lilith looked at me for a long time, amused. Then she dropped her hand and leaned suggestively on the handrail. Lilith, who I now knew to be cunning and a bit of a crazy manipulative bitch, which requires intelligence, did a great impression of a blond bimbo, and shrugged.

I moved, and she put her hand up again. She *winked* at me. "Trust me, Thomas. Just *give it* a minute."

"I thought you said April would never do this kind of thing?"

"Heh," Lilith laughed. "I'm wrong sometimes." She looked at me, smiling. "Look, you want this or not?"

I did. I didn't. I guess I hadn't expected this to ever really happen. But especially not after April and I had talked, and especially not tonight.

Lilith pulled me toward the kitchen, and I followed like a zombie.

"Make me a new martini," she ordered. "Then... go see what's up."

I wasn't sure what Lilith and I were sharing in that moment: complicity, or was I just another toy of Lilith's to bat around? I didn't understand why she and April were friends, or why Lilith was so suddenly invested in this particular event.

I put myself to work making the drink.

I drank it, leaning on the counter, mind spinning, completely unsurprised that in the time it took me to shake a martini mixer, Lilith's

attention had been sought by, and caught by, another gentleman who had newly arrived at the party.

I went outside to bum another cigarette.

CHAPTER 17

Smokey-guy was there, and he gave me a cigarette without my asking for it. "You gotta inhale this time, though bro. Those things are like \$1 apiece here."

The smokers readily fell into a long conversation about cigarette prices around the world, which as far as I can tell is the second-most popular topic for groups of smokers, next to rattling on about how infrequently they smoke and are trying to quit.

I lingered as long as I could, and then made my way casually to the basement, resolved to just accept whatever I saw when I got there. If Jonny and April were making out - my stomach plunged - then I would just sit down somewhere and see where they went with it. I was a leaf, floating on the river, going along with whatever April decided to do.

That was easier than trying to figure out what the fuck I actually wanted. So I was feeling pretty smart, pretty centered, as I skipped down the stairs. I even had a spring in my step, my hands in my pockets. I could have been whistling, for all I know.

I don't remember, because at the bottom of the stairs I found the entire basement deserted, except for a black couple talking in low voices on a sofa, clearly involved in the preamble to going home to one of their places. The guy glared at me, sending a definitive message to get lost. The golf game was still on, the music was still playing, the lights were still on, but no one else was there.

I made a kind of stupid show of walking over to a bar that was behind the stairs and pretending to look for something.

"Sorry," I told the guy, who wasn't exactly shooting me death rays, but pretty close. I had grabbed a bottle of something from the bar to make my search look real. I wasn't sure why I had even gone back there, except to scan the lower level for hidden doors or passageways, some place where Jonny and my wife could be curled up together that I just hadn't seen from the stairs.

Well, that, and I wasn't thinking very clearly. I had the rush of adrenaline coursing through my veins. Pressure, like there was some ticking clock out there waiting to explode. Arousal, and uncertainty. It was great, and it was terrible, and I started to feel sick as I waded through the upstairs crowd, searching in vain for my wife and Jonny.

The party seemed rowdier, like there were more people and they were drunker, which I suppose only makes sense. But the party ended quietly at the hallway to the rest of the house, where the bedrooms were.

All the doors were open, so I began my quest a little disheartened. I felt like I either wasn't going to find my wife at all, or, if I did, I wasn't going to find her in the position I (sort of) hoped for.

Most of the rooms had lights on but were empty. A few people, who really did seem to be doing drugs, were listening to a radio in one room, lying on the bed. Some girls were picking through a bookshelf and laughing. Basic house party scenes.

I turned a corner. It didn't seem possible, even in Lilith's sprawling house, that there would be too many doors in this direction. Perhaps I would just reach the end of a hallway, a bathroom that never got used, or a closet.

But it was, in fact, a bedroom, at the end of a corridor. The din of the party faded away in the thick hallway carpet and the heavy walls. The light was on, and the room was large, and people were in it, because I could see their shadows moving on the closed wooden blinds and hear their low voices.

I walked up to the doorway, and stood in it, surveying the scene.

April was sitting on the bed, her feet on the floor, fully clothed, not doing anything particularly improper. She had her hand held out to her side, and Jonny, who was stretched on the bed on his stomach, held her arm with both hands, the fingers of his right hand tracing over her palm.

April's eyes were closed, a faint smile on her lips, and Jonny was saying something in a low voice as he caressed her open palm.

My cock swelled. I froze in the doorway, not wanting to disturb the scene, hoping it would continue to play out, that April wouldn't see me and interrupt it. I could see the sexual energy boiling up inside of my wife and it felt like someone was stroking *my* cock instead of her hand.

Her eyes opened suddenly, and she saw me, and she sucked in her breath. She tried to pull her hand away from Jonny, but he held it in place, calmly, and looked at me with a smile.

I stepped into the room and closed the door behind me, leaning against it.

April's lips were parted. She looked at me in confusion, then to Jonny, then back at me.

I walked over to an armchair, and sat down, while April remained as she was, frozen, watching me. Jonny folded himself up so that he was behind her, looking at me, smiling. He slipped his hands beneath April's hair and let it fall onto her shoulders, running through his fingers. April's arm was still suspended to her left, in midair, as though Jonny still held it, and she was staring at me.

Jonny bent to whisper in her ear. I couldn't hear what he said, and I would never ask. The only effect that his whispers had were to make April's eye close slowly, sensually, and then open just as slowly, her eyes still glued to me.

I gave my drink, which I had set on a small, strange table piled with books, a quarter turn, and then I sipped it.

The back of Jonny's hand went to April's cheek, and then down to her neck. He sat back on his heels, behind her, and with both hands, slid the spaghetti straps of April's camisole off her shoulders. The silky fabric puckered into shiny waves, slipping down her breasts to just below the lacy cup of her bra. The fabric caught there, the straps loosely slumped on her bare arms.

She was still staring at me, lips parted in a heart-shaped ring of surprise tinged by pleasure. But she made no move to stop Jonny, whose hand slid from her shoulders to her back, meeting at the center. He lifted her hair and put his mouth on the back of her neck. April's chest swelled with a sharp breath, and the camisole slipped further down on her left side.

Jonny sat up on his knees, and reached behind his back to pull his shirt over his head. I was frozen, the drink in my hands, my cock painfully pressing against my pants. I was unable to think as I watched things unfold in front of me.

Jonny dropped his hand into April's hair, and then slowly tugged on it until her head tipped back and she faced up at him. He looked at her for a while, and April made no move to free herself, or stop him. He leaned over, and his lips closed around her open mouth, covering it completely. His hands, meanwhile, moved down her arms and inward, cupping her breasts, squeezing them and kneading them. All the while he sucked on her sweet lips, deeply, dirtily. A faint mewl came from April's throat, but he continued to kiss her.

When he stopped, April's head floated back to upright. She stared at me. Her lipstick had been devoured, and now only the natural red of her lips

remained. Already she looked a little used, and my gut twisted with pleasure and pain. Jonny pulled her camisole down to her waist, which pinned her arms loosely to her sides with the straps.

Her strapless bra was a white, crisp, lacy number that molded to her ripe, peach-sized breasts as perfectly as if it were a petal on a flower yet to blossom. April looked down at herself, a little stunned, and Jonny moved his lips to her ear again. Whatever he said made her eyes widen slightly - or perhaps this was only a strange illusion that I felt. Maybe my own eyes widened as April's lips moved, and formed the word, "okay."

Jonny rose up on his knees again and began to unbutton his jeans with one hand, while keeping the fingers of one hand gently stroking April's head through her hair. Behind her, he shimmied his jeans down with a quick rocking of his hips, and I saw his dark pubic hair, the bobbing of his erect cock as it sprang loose and grazed the back of April's neck. She disentangled her arms from her camisole as he did this, and her bra sprang loose when he unclipped it, expertly with a single fluid motion, after pushing his jeans down further.

April was still looking at me. "Thomas..." she said softly.

Her bra fell forward onto her lap, and her breasts were bare, her nipples hardened into rosy knobs in the center of her pink-tinted aureole.

I nodded at her, too transfixed to say anything. Jonny tipped her head back to kiss her again, hands moving to roll her nipples with his rough fingers, making a warbled mewl flutter in her throat. He tipped sideways, and stretched out on the bed, one hand around April's arm, turning her slightly with him. His jeans were bunched at his knees, and his cock, full and thick, pointed toward the ceiling. It bobbed slightly when April looked down at it.

He took it in his hand and stroked it languidly, putting his free hand behind his head. His chest was covered in tattoos, beneath them his muscles were bulky and sculpted. April looked over at me, her torso turned slightly toward Jonny, a momentary confusion on her face.

Jonny drew her hand to his chest and placed her palm on his toned pecs. He moved her hand for her, over his body, down his abs, while April stared at him. Finally he brought her hand to his cock. April didn't react, but stared at her own hand and the firm flesh next to it. Jonny wrapped her fingers his shaft.

In her fist, the girth looked even more impressive. She could barely encircle it at the base. Her eyes widened, and then she stole a glance at me.

"Come on," Jonny said, in low voice. "He wants you to have a good time." Jonny looked over at me after saying this, the first time I had been called upon to respond, to say something, to affirm what I wanted. April's eyes followed Jonny's to my face.

For a harrowing moment, I felt paralyzed. It *was* what I wanted, it was the final domino in a long series that I had let fall, one after the other. All I needed to do was nod, or say yes, and it seemed that it would be mine.

That moment seemed to last a long time. Jonny stopped looking at me, but April did not, and for a few terrible seconds I was tumbling in a void, maybe falling, maybe floating.

At last, some reptilian force inside of me managed to tip my head forward, and back, and then again. A nod to the affirmative. *Yes. Yes, April*, I thought. *I want you to have a good time.*

I'm sure I didn't say those words, but April reacted as if I had. She bit her lower lip nervously, the way she might have if I had offered her a really expensive diamond necklace and she thought it was too extravagant. She inhaled, and her bare breasts bounced a little. And then, after an excruciating moment, she turned to look at Jonny's cock in her hand again.

Jonny gripped her wrist to move her hand, up and down the length of his cock. He was uncircumcised, his foreskin rolled along his dick in her hand. April watched her own hand, the unfurling foreskin and the swollen meat it encased, staring.

"It's so big," she whispered, after a moment.

It was difficult to suppress a groan of pleasure that wanted to escape from deep inside.

"Keep doing that," Jonny told her, releasing her wrist. "That feels really good. Just like that, nice and slow."

He put both hands behind his head and leaned back to watch my wife as she slowly stroked his cock. This went on for some time. I shifted in my chair. I could see that Jonny, did, in fact, know exactly what to do with a girl like April, and I was in for a long, torturous buildup. But how far would Jonny take April? How far could he get her to go?

After a while he rose up from his reclining position, his abs flexing as he lifted himself with pure core strength, dropping one hand to his jeans to push them down further. He kicked himself out of them with a practiced

agility. His other hand went to April's head, playing with her hair again. His fingers moved across her cheek to her lips, his thumb stroking her lower lip lovingly.

He slipped a finger into April's mouth, and she closed her lips around it. Jonny smiled his approval, and pumped his finger between her lips.

Then, his message delivered, he lay back again. "Go ahead," he told her. "Taste it."

April hesitated only briefly, glancing at me so quickly she could not have seen the expression on my face. It was the sort of precursory seeking of approval that left no time for me to object.

She shifted to the side, and lowered her head. Her hair fell in front of her face, but Jonny was already anticipating this, and he reached forward to tuck it behind her ear, so that I was able to see her lips part, and her tongue emerge. "Just lick it, nice and slow for now, April. That's good," he coaxed her.

April pulled his foreskin away so the pink monster, with its one eye, emerged, smooth and shiny with precum. A pearly white bead of cum oozed from the center. Her tongue, wet and pink, darted around his crown, tracing the ridge of it, before she finally licked up the single drop of white with the very tip of her tongue, pulling it into her mouth.

"That's nice, April, that's very sweet. But now I want you to see if you can get it all in your mouth."

April was still licking the crown of his dick, and she seemed uncertain. She looked up at Jonny. "It's so... big," she said uncertainly. She looked over at me. "I don't think..."

Jonny moved his hand to the back of April's head, slowly, subtly, applying no pressure. "He wants you to try." Jonny looked over at me. "Don't you, Tommy? You want her to try."

"You can do it," I said hoarsely.

Jonny began to push on April's head, moving her mouth closer to his dick. She was still turned slightly, looking at me, but when the fat bulb of his crown reached her lips, she opened her mouth to take him inside. A final, simmering look at me, and then she turned her head to swallow Jonny's dick.

He pushed her slowly, gently, only a little at a time, toward his pelvis. Between her lips, the many inches of his dick slowly disappeared, puffing her cheeks, causing her breath to come in ragged huffs from her nose. Her

lips stretched, their fullness drawing into a taut line of pink, edged with white where they strained to take in his girth.

"That's it April, just a little bit more," Jonny coaxed her. She lifted her eyes to look at him, making a noise. I saw her stomach wobble, she gagged, and bucked against his hand. She lifted her head and gulped in a deep breath of air, his cock wet with her spit, a long strand of it stretching from his dick to her lips until it narrowed and collapsed. "It's too big," she said.

"You can do it, baby," I heard myself say.

"Show him you can do it," Jonny said, almost before I finished my sentence. "Just open wide, let it slide right in."

April lowered her head and tried again. This time she went even further, and didn't gag, and Jonny waited while she tried, before lightly placing his hand on the back of her head. "Just gonna give you a little help, here, sweetheart. That's it..." He pushed her until she went all the way to the base of his cock, and he held her there a moment. "That's it, see you did it. Good girl. You're a natural, take a look at your husband, see how much he likes it."

April released Jonny's cock and panted, turning to me. My hand had moved to my crotch, a stain of precum spreading where the tip of my dick was crammed against the seam. I touched it, so she would see it.

"Yeah, he likes that, April. That's making him very happy. You like it to, don't you, honey? You like it all the way in your throat. Hmm?" Jonny pulled April's face to his dick and moved it over her lips. "Suck on it for me, honey. Take it all the way in again."

Jonny moved April's head for her, but this time it was smooth going: his cock filled her mouth and her throat, and then slid between her lips until just the crown was in her mouth. Again, and again, he plunged her face to his crotch, and April sucked away, her mouth open and obedient.

Jonny pulled her completely from his dick, his hands still in her hair. "That's so good, April. So hot. Hubby likes it, doesn't he?" He turned April's face in my direction, and I nodded. April's lips were rubbed raw pink, and swollen, her makeup smudged beneath her eyes.

Jonny pushed her back onto his dick. "This time you're going to hold it there," he said, in almost a whisper. "All the way down, oh yeah, I can feel it in your throat." Her chin was smashed against his balls. His fingers grasped her hair tightly.

And then he sort of shook her head, rapidly, side to side, only a few centimeters in either direction. He was lifting his head, straining his abs and neck to lift it and stare at her. "Yeah, that's it, take all that cock. Fuck, that's hot."

It was hot, but a faint sense of alarm began to build in me as he held her to his pelvis, shaking her head a bit like a dog might shake a chew toy, crushing her face into his balls and pubic bone so that she couldn't even breathe. My mouth opened to protest, but Jonny looked over at me at that instant.

"She's got it. Don't worry."

He released almost immediately after that, but it seemed like an eternity as I waited for it. April gasped, spit spewing from between her lips, sticky with mucous. Her face was reddened where it had been crushed to his pelvis.

"So, this is where we find out what kind of girl April is," Jonny said, looking at April but seemingly speaking to me. He put his hand on his cock and gave it a lazy stroke. "Everyone says April is a bit of a prude, don't they?"

He propped himself up on one elbow. He swiped a drop of precum from his cock and lifted it to April's lips. "But I think... April just never gets a chance to run wild." He held his finger out to her, and April looked at it, still breathing heavily.

Then she licked it.

Jonny smiled.

"I think there's a little bit of a slut inside of April. A little bit of April who wants to do some very, *very* dirty things." His finger moved into her mouth again, pulling her jaw down, opening her mouth. "I can tell by the way you suck my cock." He put his hand on her jaw, and rubbed his thumb over her lower lip again. "What do you think, April? Do I have that right? Do you want to show your husband what a dirty little slut you can be?" He turned her head to face me again. "He wants you to do it," he told her.

April was breathing heavily, her tits bouncing lightly. It was plain to see that Jonny had her pegged: I could see the desire inside of her to say yes. Her eyes were searching mine, looking for permission.

"I want you to be a slut," I told her. "It's hot, baby. If you want to do it, I want you to do it."

"She wants to," Jonny said. He let go of April's face and got up on his knees, facing her. From this angle, his cock was even more terrifying: the length seemed to have increased, and its width was amplified by the light behind it.

"Get on your hands and knees, baby," Jonny told her. "And get that mouth open. I'm gonna give you what you want, and you're gonna take it like a proper little slut."

April gave me one last look, a flicker of uncertainty in her face. But with a searing hot cruelty that cut through my chest, I recognized that the uncertainty was not about whether or not she in fact wanted to do it, only about whether or not she believed that I was on board with it. Jonny had her figured out, and it was - while my fantasy, my dream come true - shocking and terrifying to see that April, pure spring snow April, was ready and willing to do whatever Jonny told her to.

That moment lasted only seconds. April was already climbing onto the bed. Her bra was tangled beneath her, her camisole pushed to her waist. Jonny seemed unconcerned that her jeans were still on, which made me realize, heavily, that he was in it for the long haul. This was only an appetizer.

She got onto her hands and knees, as he had asked. She was facing him, and at this height his cock was a little higher than her mouth. He tilted her head and slapped her lips with his meat. "Open up, baby," he said, and April did.

He grasped her hair and shoved his cock in. Using two hands, he gripped her head and held it in place, and pushed himself inside. April's jaw and lips stretched open, but he disappeared smoothly into her open mouth, and I watched, stunned, as a lump rolled along the profile of her neck: Jonny's cock as he stretched her to the limit.

He paused for a moment, my wife's throat stuffed full of his dick, and made a few adjustments of his hips, better situating himself inside of her. His fingers gripped her hair tightly, and then, without much warning, Jonny began to face-fuck my wife.

The scene became suddenly surreal: that could not be *my April*, obediently posed on her hands and knees with her mouth open, getting rammed in the face by another man. A filthily glutenous crackling came from her throat with each thrust: *gluck, gluck, gluck*. At last he pulled out of

her mouth and, still holding her by the hair, let her breathe. She sucked in a few wet gasps of air, as he tilted her head to look down at her.

April licked at the spit and mucous running from her mouth.

"You're doing so good, April, honey, you little slut. You're very good at it," Jonny told her. He gripped his cock and traced it lazily all over her face. "Isn't she?" he looked over at me. "Tell April what a good little slut she's being."

He twisted April's head - gently, but with a domineering force - so that she could see me. I was cold with horror, sweating from arousal and the deepening pain in my groin. "It's so hot, baby," I managed to croak.

"Can you do more, April? Do you swallow cum like a good girl?"

He didn't wait for April to answer. He was already feeding his cock to her, releasing her hair, letting April work on his dick. She eagerly bobbed on him, moving almost as steadily and quickly as when he had fucked her face. "She swallow for you?" Jonny asked, offhandedly, without looking at me.

She didn't, but I didn't push it, either. I noncommittally began to shake my head, but it seemed Jonny didn't much care about the answer - either that, or he already knew. "What do you think, April, can you show us what a good slut you can be and swallow this big load of cum? Show us you can do it."

April continued to suck on Jonny's cock diligently. His body stiffened and he sucked in his breath. "Oh, fuck, that's good, honey, you're doing such a good job, keep right on going, look up here, look right at me, that's good, oh yeah... oh fuck your eyes are so pretty with your mouth full of cock."

My own cock hurt so badly at this point I had no choice but to unzip my pants and let it loose. Precum welled at the tip of my dick, and I bounced with every filthy slurp from April's mouth.

"Oh yeah, here I come, that's good, honey, keep going, I'm gonna put it in deep and all you have to do is let it go right down."

He grasped her head again, and stared down at April's beautiful blue eyes as he groaned and clenched his ass, dumping his seed into the back of her throat.

April squeezed her eyes closed, and Jonny's body jerked as the second and third spurts erupted from him, his seed bursting directly into my wife's throat.

When he pulled his still-hard dick from her mouth, I saw her throat move as she swallowed. Jonny played with her hair, which was damp with sweat and stuck to her face, as he lifted his dick. "Lick it all off for me, baby," he said. "Give Tommy here a show. Mmmm."

My eyes felt like they were burning with tears, though none came, as April's tongue swept over Jonny's cock, licking what she hadn't already swallowed of his slimy cum from the underside of his cock, lapping at the crown and the drops that still oozed from it. "Get my balls, too," Jonny instructed her. "Suck them right up, oh, yeah, just like that."

A sound escaped my mouth as April's lips sucked up the heavy sacs beneath Jonny's cock and rolled them in her mouth.

Jonny looked over at me and grinned. "You want to get in on this now, or see some more?"

I didn't know. I didn't know what the fuck to say. I opened my mouth and said, "Wait," but more because it was a short word than anything else. Jonny nodded and looked down at my wife, who was still licking cum from his dick. "Lots guys like to wait, 'til they just can't take it any more," he said, agreeably. He pushed April gently away from his cock. "What do you think, April? You ready to get fucked? I'm gonna make you scream and fuck you 'til you can't walk. And you're going to show us how much you love it."

April was still on her hands and knees, looking at Jonny now. I'm sure she wasn't sure what to say, but Jonny was as skilled as he had promised. He sat back on his ankles and stroked his cock. "Get those jeans off," he told April. "Stand up and take them off."

April crawled backward to the foot of the bed and unbuttoned her jeans, then pushed them over her hips, one side, then the other, twisting slinkishly as she did. Her panties matched her bra: a delicate white lace satin and lace thong..

"Nice," Jonny said. "Take off those panties, too."

Jonny stroked his cock slowly as he watched her, and if it had gone flaccid at all, it was back in form by the time April began to shimmy her panties down.

"Fuck, you're a pretty little thing," Jonny said. "Nice little pussy, looks nice and tight," He looked over at me. "I'm gonna stretch that out." He turned back to April. "But you're gonna like that, aren't you, honey? A big, thick cock? He wants you to have a good time, and I'm gonna make sure

you come so hard you get dizzy. But I want to see what I'm fucking, like to have a little taste of some fresh pussy before I fuck you full of cum."

I could not believe that this guy was talking to my wife like this, or that, for that matter, April did in fact seem to like it. He beckoned her back onto the bed, and she crawled toward him.

"Turn around, baby, get that ass in the air for me."

April obeyed him, and he rose up, put his hand on her back and pushed her chest to the bed. "There you go, just like that. Her face was toward me, and he pushed her hair away. "Look right at your hubby there, he likes that, he wants to see your face when I make you come." To me, without turning away from April's bare ass in front of him, which he was stroking lazily with his free hand, he said, "don't you?" But not like it was a question.

April met my eyes. Her gaze flitted over my cock, which was standing erect above my lap, bobbing with pleasure each time Jonny touched her, and obscenely swollen. She stared at me again, but her eyes closed and she gasped almost immediately, as Jonny slipped his finger into her swollen labia and found her clit.

April moaned, and Jonny smiled as he pulled apart the outer lips of April's pussy. He scooted back a little bit, and bent over, gasping April's thighs. His hands almost enclosed her whole leg at mid-thigh, and April suddenly looked tiny and breakable in his grip. He sank his face between her legs, and April's eyes flew open at the same time that she gasped.

I couldn't see exactly what Jonny was doing, but I could hear the steady slurping as he lapped at April's pussy. I could hear the sticky wetness of April's arousal: her cunt sounded as wet as if she had already come, betraying how much the slut-sucking of Jonny's cock had appealed to her. Each slurp cut through me, perversely painful, the wet sound of April's true, inner, betraying self: she was a slut, who liked to suck fat cock, and there was no denying it. Even if I had always wanted it, it still burned me.

April's legs began to shake against Jonny's grip, and he pressed his fingers into her flesh even deeper, turning her pale skin even whiter beneath his fingertips. April's hips began to rock, and then she started to squeal, her eyes wide and open, her mouth agape, before she squeezed her eyes shut and let out a howl that seemed almost as much pain as it was pleasure.

Her whole body jerked as she came, and her scream stopped as though someone had choked her - she opened her eyes, utter shock the prevalent emotion in them. She was so stunned she could only scream silently, as she

was racked by an orgasm that was like nothing I had ever given her. Her pussy got even wetter, but Jonny did not terminate his assault on her. He continued to lap at her pussy, and then dove in hard, probably sucking her clit into his mouth. April bucked him, and then she began to moan, and then she twisted her head and tried to push away. "Stop, oh god, oh please!" she squealed. "It's too much, oh! Oh!"

Jonny played with her as she shrieked and begged him to stop, for what seemed like an eternity, until she fell to her chest again and squeezed her eyes closed in surrender. Slowly, her mouth opened to pant, and her muscles relaxed, and then began to flex again - not in resistance, but in cooperation.

Only then did Jonny rise up, wiping his mouth. April's juices shone on his chin, even on his neck. "Mmm," he said. "That's a nice sweet pussy." He put his fingers to her cunt and slid two inside of her. "Oh, fuck, she's all ready to go. You ready, April? You want to get fucked nice and hard by Jonny?"

"Mm-hmm," April moaned, her hips pushing back against Jonny's fingers.

"Do me a favor, baby, look over there at your hubby and tell him what you want. Let him hear you ask for it like a whore. Say, 'I want Jonny to fuck me with his big cock, I want a big load of cum in my pussy from Jonny.'"

Jonny grinned at the end of this sentence and continued to finger-fuck April.

April seemed uncertain. Her mouth didn't move, and her eyes sought approval in mine. But her body melded against Jonny's hand, craving his fingers deeper inside of her. She didn't need to say it for it to be abundantly obvious.

"Come on baby, say it for him," Jonny growled. "Say it. Be a good slut." He plunged deep inside of her and curled his fingers.

April mewled, and Jonny slowed his finger-fucking, making her mewl again. She focused on my eyes. "I want Jonny to fuck me with his big cock," she breathed.

"What else do you want, you little slut?"

"I want a big, I want a load of cum..." April's eyes fluttered closed and she moaned as Jonny did something to her, though I couldn't see what. "In my.. in my pussy."

Jonny slipped his hand out and flipped April over in a smooth, fluid move that had her on her back and legs flung spread-eagle in almost the blink of an eye. He seized her hips and dragged her closer to him, lining his cock up with her engorged slit.

He drew the fat head of his dick through April's cunt, burrowing his flesh through her gash like an animal in water, the pink skin folding and rippling in its wake. He used his hands to push April's hips apart. "Get that nice and wide, so he can see. Maybe you want to come over here, get a better view."

For a moment, I didn't realize he was talking to me. My body, however, was already reacting; I was standing up, shaking my pants down, staring at his fat prick at the entrance of her pussy, dwarfing it, looking far too big for her tiny cunt.

April looked at me as I approached the bed and got onto it, near her head, on my knees. She reached out for my dick and held it in her hand, and I pulsed in her grip, violently. I was staring, though, at Jonny's cock.

"Oh, my -" April said, as Jonny slid a few inches inside of her. All of her flesh stretched away from his dick, the pink of her labia drawn into a thin pink line, the feathery black silk of her neatly-trimmed bush like a pencil drawing around it: Jonny's dick, veined and somehow looking even thicker than before, dominated the space between her legs.

"Oh, fuck, that's tight," Jonny said, grinning. "Oh, yeah, that's a sweet little pussy. We need to get that stretched out, you need a good hard fuck, little girl."

April stared, lifting her head slightly, as Jonny disappeared, slowly, into her pussy. I watched as he gradually slid inside of her, until she was full of his dick. April was breathing heavily, her eyes watering a little. "It's so big," she breathed. She looked up at me. "Oh," she moaned, as Jonny moved inside of her.

Jonny lifted her a little, so that she was tilted up, her ass resting on his lap. His hand dropped to her abdomen, and he stroked it. For a second, I didn't know why he was doing that, even as April's eyes went wide and she gasped. But when he began to rock his hips, I understood what I was looking at: the tip of his fat prick was pressing outward on April's small frame, another lump moving beneath her skin.

It was vulgar, horrifying even. My cock pulsed in April's hand anyway and she tore her eyes away from her abdomen to look at me. "It's so big,"

she repeated.

"Tell him how you feel, tell him how much you like it," Jonny said.

"I...uhn...oh, oh," April moaned, her eyes rolling closed. "It's so, I'm so full, oh... oh..." Her words dribbled away into an incomprehensible slurry of sexual sounds.

Jonny looked down at his dick as he sawed into April's pussy slowly. "The thing most of them say is that my cock hits places their husband can't," he said, and while he must have been speaking to me, he just kept looking at April's stretched pussy. My own gaze jerked from her pussy to her face, her open mouth and her screwed-up expression as another orgasm bubbled, and then at last ruptured within her.

She lifted her head to stare at Jonny's cock, almost like she was surprised about what was happening to her and gave a few high-pitched shrieks before her head fell back onto the bed.

She shuddered, wracked by pleasure, until her orgasm receded. She opened her eyes and squirmed, lifting her head again.

"Don't tell me you can't take any more," Jonny told her, as a command. "Just keep those legs spread and take some more cock, keep taking it until you come again." Jonny looked over at me. "Maybe she wants to suck on something." To April: "You need something to suck on? You ever take two dicks at once, April?"

April stared at him, her hand squeezing my dick. As far as I knew, she had never done anything like that, but she didn't answer.

"She wants to, though, don't you April," Jonny continued. "You think about it all the time, don't you? I can tell, I can see you think about it. Now you can do it. Suck on Tommy's cock for him, show him you can be a good girl for him, too."

April looked at me.

"That's so hot, April, yeah," I said, to encourage her. She opened her mouth and I slid into it. Her body was sliding a little as Jonny fucked her, and her head was at an angle, so she could only fit the end of my dick inside.

But after all I had witnessed, and with the knowledge that the rocking motion of her body was another man's cock thrusting inside of her, it didn't take much for me to explode. I started to reach for her head, the way I did on the few occasions she sucked me off, to let her know I was going to come. But the hot spurt of liquid was already bursting from me, and she released

my dick and let my seed spray into her open mouth as she rubbed my cock with her hand.

"Let him see all that cum in your mouth, April, then swallow it for him like a good girl."

I stared, numbness taking over as my orgasm receded, as April opened her mouth. She opened wide, so I could see the pool of white cum at the back of her throat. The obscenity of the scene, so porno-like, so absurdly *not* something my wife ever did, burned into my retina. When she closed her mouth and swallowed, I was still viewing her mouth full of cum, sloshing a little as though in a cup being jostled, as Jonny continued to fuck her.

After she swallowed, I sank onto my heels, and Jonny slowed, reaching forward to April's head. He mingled his fingers in her hair. "That's a good little slut. Good little sluts get special treats." He pulled her by the back of the neck, exhibiting his immense core strength as he lifted her, sinking back on his own heels, so that April was seated on his lap, all without his cock ever leaving her cunt.

I was on the edge of the bed, stunned, my cock only half-depleted, and so there was nothing else to do but watch as Jonny situated April on his lap, pulled her legs behind him to his lower back, and gripped her hips. He pushed and pulled on them, but April was no passive actor for long: she dropped her feet and began to grind against Jonny, faster and faster, while she moaned, and then wailed, and then screamed, coming again. I had a view the entire time of the bottom two inches of Jonny's cock, where the meat entered her pussy, disappearing and then reappearing as my wife fucked him until she came again.

April collapsed against him, spent, but Jonny gripped her hips so she couldn't escape and continued to thrust himself into her pussy. He slowed his pace, but April still whimpered. "It's too much," she murmured, without fighting him. "I can't... I can't..."

Jonny pushed her hair to the side and put his lips next to her ear, grinning at me over her slumped shoulders as he did. "Shhh," he cooed. One hand moved to the small of her back and supported her as he pushed his dick into her. "You can take more, you can do it. You're going to be all fucked-out when Jonny's done with you, but I'm not done with you yet."

He grinned at me and brought the hand that had been holding April's hips to his groin to her mouth. April's head tipped back as he brought two

fingers to her lips. "Suck on those and get them nice and wet," he instructed her.

April obeyed, staring at Jonny. He took his fingers out of her mouth and moved them down to her ass crack, sliding them deftly between her buttocks. He went further, swiping at the glistening juices that were pouring down his balls and between their legs. Then he brought them back up, to play with April's ass.

April tilted her head toward him again. Jonny smiled at her and whispered something to her. His fingers didn't stop playing with her ass. He didn't stop fucking her either, and April was beginning to bounce on him again, getting hungry for more.

After he whispered to her, she turned to her right and looked back at me, her hands on Jonny's shoulders. She started to fuck Jonny, while he played with her ass, looking right at me.

"That's so hot," I managed to say, so she wouldn't stop.

Jonny, meanwhile, was circling her tiny asshole. I couldn't look away from April as she looked back at me, but my attention was split between her face and the wanderings of Jonny's fingers, visible peripherally.

He moved his hand up from her back to her neck and turned her head with it. "April, tell me, does Tommy here ever play with your ass?"

April's mouth fell open, and she glanced back at me.

"No?" Jonny pressed one finger against her anus and April gasped. "You never come with something in your ass?" He tsked. "That's a shame, April. There's nothing like it. But you're gonna try it today, aren't you? You're gonna let Jonny take care of it for you." He sank his teeth into her lower lip and smiled. "I think April's going to be the kind of girl with a hidden talent, hmmm?"

As he said this, he pushed his pointer finger into her ass. April's body stiffened for a second. Jonny whispered, "relax," and pushed in to his second knuckle.

I stared at April's pink eyelet, which I had never even tried to defile, as Jonny's thick finger slid even deeper inside. He finger-fucked her ass a few times while she clung to him, no longer fucking. And then she stared up again, mewling.

"Yeah," Jonny said, to no one in particular. "She's a natural slut. I can tell when they like it in the ass. She opened right up," he looked over her shoulder. "You've been missing out if you haven't been hitting this."

He pushed his middle finger to her asshole and it joined the other, eliciting a sharp gasp from April. She paused for a moment, open-mouthed, arms draped on Jonny's shoulders. "Keep going," he told her. "Just open that ass up like you did before, there you go. Mmm,"

April started to bounce and pant, grinding against Jonny, his cock sliding from her stretched pussy, juices gushing and sticky with each thrust. All the while, his two fingers plunged into her ass, digging into her, pulling her toward him like a fish on a hook. When he twisted them she moaned in pleasure.

But Jonny gripped her with his hands after what seemed like an eternity of this abuse, just as April seemed to be almost coming again, and she howled in disappointment. Jonny brought his lips to her ear and whispered instructions I couldn't hear while he looked at me deviously through the messy curtain on her hair. My ears were ringing: my cock had hardened and precum was once again gushing from the tip of my crown.

"I don't.. know... I can't," April mewled.

Jonny slipped his fingers from inside her ass and said, "Do it."

April dropped her right hand from his shoulder into his waiting palm, and he pushed her fingers into her mouth. Then, as I stared, knowing what was coming but not believing it, he slowly guided April's hand to her ass, pressed her palm to her buttock, and then, slowly, using the two fingers he had fucked her with, stuffed two of her fingers into her ass.

April turned, and looked at me, her face a mixture of confusion, pleasure, and disbelief.

If I had eaten raw glass shards, that would have explained how I felt.

"Keep going," Jonny told her, feeding her fingers to the puckered lips of her ass until she was two knuckles deep.

"Now, you want to come?" Jonny asked her, pushing her hair from her face. "I'll let you come, if you show me how dirty you can be. Fuck your ass, look at Tommy there and fuck your ass, and then I'll let you ride my cock again."

April tried to squirm on top of him and rock against his pelvis, but he tsked and gripped her hip harshly. "Uhn-uh," he told her. "Fuck that ass, show us what a good little slut you can be."

April had dropped her eyes, she was panting, her body trembling. I could see by the way that she squirmed she was close to coming, but Jonny

held her in place so she could not. Her mouth fell open as she bent her fingers and then slowly began to finger-fuck her own ass.

"Look at him," Jonny said. "Look right at him, he likes that, give him a good show."

April lifted her eyes and looked at me. Her mouth was open, her gaze vacant, she was somewhere else. She mewled and tried to move again.

"Keep going April, you gotta work for it baby. Fuck that ass nice and hard with your fingers." He grasped her wrist and jammed her fingers in deep, fucking her fast, A sticky sound cackled as he rammed her wrist back and forth.

"Feel how tight that is? How hot and silky it is? That's how my cock is gonna feel, April, when I get inside of you."

When he released her hand, April continued at the same pace, gasping, a sexual, whoreish squeal staccatoing from her throat.

"That's it," Jonny said, approvingly. He looked at me and grinned. "You sure this girl hasn't had a lot of practice? She's a grade-A fucking slut." To April, staring at her open mouth, "Oh yeah, baby, keep going, I'm gonna let you come soon."

April continued to fuck her ass with her fingers, and the moment in all its vulgar, raw filth seemed to go on forever. I felt like I was awakening in a nightmare over and over again, the scene as new and raw each time, seeing it for the first time and then again for the first time: my sweet April, lips swollen, mouth caked with cum, sitting on a huge cock, fucking her ass frantically with her fingers.

Jonny reached over her hand and dipped into the juices that were oozing between them, and then placed a hand on April's to stop her. He started to move and let go of her hip so that she could bounce on his cock, her fingers trapped in her ass by the pressure of his hand.

She turned to him, bouncing feverishly, grinding away toward her orgasm. Jonny grinned at me over her shoulder, and I couldn't tell if it was malice or camaraderie. April's grunts became more high-pitched, she started to howl, and she was very close to coming.

And just then, Jonny slipped his hand over hers, poking one of his fingers, and then the other, in between her fingers and the rim of her ass.

April was too busy fucking him wildly, trying to chase her own ecstasy, for the stretching of her ass to seemingly even register with her. Their mingled, four fingers plunged into her ass, and she just kept grinding

against Jonny until, in a shrieking, frenetic fit, she screamed, and came. "Oh my, oh my, oh my, oh my God, I'm coming, oh God, oh Gooooo.....!"

Her head tipped back violently, and Jonny braced her lower torso so she didn't fall backward. I stared at her ass, at the pulsing of her rim around their fingers to the rhythm of her orgasm, and a throb traveled through my body and my cock that felt like I was going to come without even touching myself. Instead it crashed into my dick and felt like a monster had gripped my genitals and was squeezing them tightly.

Juices poured between April's thighs, glistening, creamy cum from her pussy. Jonny's testicles clung to her labia, peeling away with a sticky sound as she bounced and bounced. The sounds she was making were unlike any I'd heard before, and then, after crescendoing to a feral screech, they were cut off again, and April just twitched, her ass sucking at their fingers, her mouth open in a silent scream.

Jonny nudged her fingers from her ass, but sank his own right back in, and April mewled. He lay her on her back, twisting his arm beneath her leg, which he tossed up by her head. April's limbs moved like a rag doll's. Jonny finger-fucked her ass, pushing the slosh from her pussy into her, pumping hard, while April's legs jiggled and bounced, as if detached from her body.

Her hair had fallen over her face: I could see her open mouth, twisted into rapturous, orgasmic shapelessness, and her closed eyes, sweat pasting her mussed hair to her cheek. Jonny fucked her for a bit with his fingers, getting her ass lubed up, and though I knew his plan I still couldn't believe it was going to happen.

Not April.

Not *my* April.

Jonny reached down and pushed her hair from her face, clearing from her features and spreading it out on the bed. "Are you gonna be a really, really beautiful slut, April? I can tell you want it. You want to take it in the ass, don't you?"

I looked down at April. "April, baby, you don't have to..." I murmured.

"She wants to," Jonny breathed. "Hubby here is gonna be *so* proud of you, April, if you take this big cock in your ass. Aren't you?" He looked at me. "Tell her. She wants it, I can tell she's an ass girl, she had her first taste of it and she can't believe how it felt." He looked down at April. "Isn't that right?" He shook his head. "It's always the neat, little pretty ones," he said to no one in particular again. Then he looked at me.

This whole time he was finger-fucking April, pummeling her ass with his two thick fingers, and April had reanimated from her trance-like state, and was now looking over her navel and Jonny's hand between her legs, almost as if she couldn't believe that he was plunging into her ass.

"Tell her," Jonny told me. "Tell her you'll be proud of her if she takes a big cock in the ass. She wants it, she just needs to know you want her to do it." He turned his eyes to April's face. April stared at Jonny, then turned, almost bewildered, to look at me.

"April," I said. My throat was dry. "If you want to -"

"She wants to, man," Jonny said. He pushed deep into April's ass and then flexed his forearm, pushing on something inside her that made her gasp. "She wants to get stuffed full of cock, feel all nice and full, get that nice, dull pain going and then have an ass full of hot cum. Look at her, look at her pussy throbbing, she's the type," Jonny smiled. "Now you just have to tell her to do it."

April had looked to Jonny, then closed her eyes while he massaged her insides. She opened them and looked at me.

"I want you to do it," I told her, but I was hearing myself from a long way away. "I'll be so proud of you if you do it, April."

Something changed in her eyes, but it was Jonny who flipped her over. Once on her side, April rolled onto her hands and knees.

I reached for her hair, pushing it over to one side so I could see her face. She looked behind her, where Jonny was smiling, watching his own fingers as they fucked her, slowly now. He had his other hand on his cock, stroking it languidly.

He lifted himself to line up with her hole, then slowly pulled his fingers from her ass. He pressed down on her lower back to tilt her ass up toward him. "You're all stretched out April, baby, all you gotta do is relax, and I'm going to slide right in and fill you up. This time, it's gonna be real quick, sweetheart, because I'm about to blow."

He held her by the hips, and spread her apart, so I had a good view of his dick sinking into her. His cock was thicker than their combined fingers, and April sucked in her breath with a sharp gasp as the fat bulb of his cock stretched her open. And then, unstoppably, irreversibly, his meaty snake disappeared, inch by inch, until his pelvis bumped against her soft white ass.

I stared down at April, who had watched this with her head turned, and now turned to me, looking up, disbelief on her face. I must have had the same look: my April, sweet, fresh April, had a full ten inches of another man's fat cock inside her ass.

Jonny moved slowly at first, staring down at his own dick. "Fuck, yeah, that's tight, that's nice, I can't believe you never hit this," he said. He looked up. "She's the type, man, she's squeezing it, she can't even stop herself, she loves it." He started to saw in and out of her. "That's it April, get one of your hands up there and rub that clit, make yourself come again, oh fuck, I'm not gonna last too long, you better move fast... shit..."

Jonny started to fuck April hard and fast, and April dropped her chest to the bed, slipping a hand to her pussy beneath her torso. Sticky, frantic plunging sounds filled my ears, and underneath that crackling, the low moan of April, building to a squeal, and Jonny grunting, before he yelled, his entire body flexed. His hips thrust forward and his fingers sank into April's hips, as he rammed himself deep inside of her. April turned her face to the bed, and her fingers kept working, I could hear the sticky sound of it. Her ass moved in small circles, or tried to, until her thighs quivered and she screamed, muffled, into the bed.

Jonny looked down at her ass, grunting, his face red and obsessed as April's orgasm collided with his. "Fuck, fuck yeah," he said hoarsely. "Shit."

I was the only one consumed by the trapped animal of pleasure and pain that hadn't been released from my body. My dick was so hard, again, that I almost needed to double over in pain. My hand reached listless for April's damp, spread-out hair. Her hand dropped from her pussy to the bed and she turned her face. Her skin was hot, red, tiny droplets of sweat beaded across her temple and her above her lip. She stared vacantly in front of her, utterly spent.

Jonny put a hand on her lower back and caressed her, moving down to her ass, which he squeezed. Another burst of cum seemed to squirt from his cock, and he shuddered. He still had the wild, obsessed look of a man who was about to come, or just had. "Not bad," he said, panting, "for your first time."

When he slid from inside her, his cock was only semi-flaccid, and it bobbed before slapping against her still-spread thighs, cum dripping onto her legs. I was kneeling, awkwardly, next to April's head, and I could see

the shadow of her gaping hole, cum oozing from inside of her, spurting filthily.

She folded over to one side, then rolled onto her back, her legs together and resting to her right. Jonny fell back against the headboard, smiling at April.

I couldn't tell what she was looking at: she seemed dazed. She brought her fingers to her lips, as if she wanted to feel if they were really hers.

Jonny sat, panting, until he caught his breath, which didn't take long. He looked at me, and grinned. Then he swung his leg over April, sat on the edge of the bed, and scooped up his t-shirt. He reached over April to find his jeans, kissed her stomach as he sat back up, patted her almost paternalistically, and shook his jeans out in front of him.

"Well," he said. "I imagine you two have some stuff to talk about." He hopped up, pulling his jeans on, buttoned them, touched a damp spot at his crotch, and then shook his shirt away from his body. "Anytime y'all want to play, you know how to get a hold of me."

He leaned over, touched April's lips tenderly. "Bye-bye for now, sweet April."

He punched me lightly on the shoulder as he went to the door. I was still staring at April, dumbstruck. The door opened, Jonny said something about the room being occupied to whoever was out in the hall, and then it closed behind him.

There was a silence in the room for a moment. April sat up, slowly, and perched against one arm, facing me. She looked like she wanted to say something but didn't know what to say. "Thomas," she whispered.

At that moment, the April who had performed all of these stunningly filthy acts seemed to evaporate, leaving only the April I had thought I knew so well in her place. In her eyes there almost seemed to be surprise, a sudden overtaking of insecurity and confusion, much like when we had talked about Jonny in the bathroom what seemed like years ago.

I reached for her, and meshed my fingers in her hair, pulling her toward me to kiss her. Her lips seemed the same, felt like hers beneath my mouth, but lingering somewhere on them, I knew, were traces of Jonny's cock. In my mind I could only see that image burned into my mind, of April's open mouth, full of cum.

She looked at me almost apologetically when I released her. A peal of laughter and several thumps erupted outside the door. I held my finger up to

April and darted to the door, locking it just in time. A dull thud resonated against the door, followed by laughter.

"Occupied," I said, louder than necessary. The voices and dull thuds retreated from the door as I turned toward April, who had turned, eyes frantic, and was looking for her clothing in the mess on the bed. She paused, now that the door was locked, and her eyes dropped to my erection.

I didn't give her time to say anything, just crawled onto the bed and pulled her face toward me to kiss her.

"Thomas," she said, between my thirsty kisses.

"April," I said, then kissed her again. "It's okay. That was hot. That's what I wanted." I pushed her backward onto the bed, lying on top of her. She was looking at me, between kisses, traces of disbelief still clouding her eyes. "It's what I wanted," I repeated. "It was hot."

I moved my hand down her body, to the engorged velvet between her legs. Slick juices coated her thighs, spilling from her ruptured pussy. I slid my fingers gently into her slit, and my cock throbbed at the wetness, the loose feel of her flesh.

"Are you sore?" I whispered, moving my fingers to feel around her used pussy.

April moved her head in an absent nod.

"Too sore?" I asked. "Because I'm not done with you yet."

I had moved my cock to the entrance of her pussy by then, the head sinking into her wet flesh. April's body yielded to mine in every way, her lips parted to emit a pleased gasp.

"I'll be gentle," I told her, as I filled her slowly. Her pussy was so filled with her own slick juices, the product of her many, raging orgasms, that I entered her without friction. Her body squirmed beneath mine, moving, I was sure, in response to the pressing of my cock against the tender, stretched, and used places inside of her.

"I can't believe I did that," April told me, almost like a confession. I was moving inside of her, and her body was responding to me, her hips pressing up to meet me, the regret in her eyes turning to hunger again.

I was going to come literally any second: every filthy still image that had burned into my vision was flitting through my mind, every sound that had come from April's lips, every taste and smell that did not belong to her or to me filled my nostrils. I could feel all the pain of watching her, all the intense arousal, boiling up and over.

"Come for me one more time, baby," I told her, looking into her eyes. "Come for *me*."

April's eyes closed halfway, and her mouth twisted, as she gripped me fiercely and dug her heels into my back. My whole body was seized up by then, the only thing I was aware of was the massive jet of cum that was exploding from my cock, finally draining the pain and craving that had built up inside of me.

That, and the fact that April was bucking wildly against me as I came, working herself up into one last orgasm. I was spent, and she kept pulling me in with her heels, I could barely stand the painful pleasure of her pussy around my cock. I held on, until she arched her back and began to scream loudly, her body clenching me and shuddering, her eyes flying open to stare into mine, again with disbelief.

I put my hand over her mouth and she bit into the flesh of my palm. I tipped my own head onto the mattress over her shoulder, unable to withstand the overwhelming of my senses.

At last, April ceased to move and fuck and scream, and we lay like this for a few moments - who knows how long? - our bodies slick with sweat and cum, the air fetid with the scent of sex.

A knock at the door made me raise my head.

April looked at me, shaken from what seemed like a reverie.

Behind the door, whispers, and then someone saying, clearly, "they've been in there a *long* time." Someone laughed and offered to join the fun. April and I stared at each other until their voices disappeared.

I rolled off of April, and she sat up, pulling a tangled sheet with her. She turned to look at me. I was still on my back, exhausted, spent, and not particularly motivated to move. I touched her back and her arm gently to reassure her that everything was okay.

A smudge of black mascara underlined each eye, almost as if she had intentionally drawn her makeup like that, the effect utterly slutty. Her lips were red and seemed smudged, probably because the skin at the edges of them had inflamed a little where Jonny's cock had stretched her mouth so wide. The skin of her face seemed unevenly translucent, where saliva, and probably cum, had dried, it was dull, and patches of pink splotched her normally flawless complexion. Her hair was tangled, damp in patches and dry in others, tangled a little where her head had rubbed against the bed while Jonny had fucked her.

"April. You okay?"

"I can't believe..."

I sat up, and kissed her again to reassure. "Baby, I'm so proud of you," I told her. "I am, I want you to know that, this is what I always dreamed of... really."

"You're not... I just can't see how... I can't believe I did all that."

She looked so shocked, she really did.

"Here," I said. I fished her shirt from the tangled bedsheets and felt around for her bra after handing it to her. "We'll get -"

"How are we going to get out of here?" she wondered aloud. She looked at the door and pushed her hair from her face with her hand.

I smiled. I thought it was cute that April believed that any of the guests at Lilith's party would notice, let alone give a shit, that something sexual had occurred in this bedroom. I found her bra and handed it to her. Then I kissed her shoulder. "Let's find our clothes," I said calmly, "and straighten up, and then we can just walk out, and go home."

"But -"

"It'll be fine," I said, amused.

We put on our clothes. I straightened up the bed, but then thought better of it: it seemed fair to leave it messy so someone knew not to just crash in it. Many damp spots remained among the crumpled sheets.

April ran her fingers through her hair and straightened it, and tried to wipe her smeared makeup away in a full length mirror. She didn't have much success, except with her hair, which had gone back into place in the same magical way that it always did.

I put my hands on her shoulders and looked at her reflection in the mirror, then kissed a bare shoulder. The strap slipped when I lifted my head. "You look fine," I assured her.

She looked beautiful; beautiful and used and whoreish. But I am Thomas Roberts, and I know when to shut the fuck up.

I took her by the hand and opened the door, leading her out. She followed me. As expected, no one paid us any mind as we walked through the living room, and no one paid her any mind when she stopped, told me she lost her purse, and hurried back to get it. I watched her as she walked, noticing the subtle change in her gait, thinking of the many ways she must have been sore after being pummeled in every hole by Jonny's huge cock.

While she fetched her purse, I looked around, but I didn't see Jonny or Lilith. People were outside now, and the heavy scent of pot hung in the air. I *did* see Mike, the boyfriend from Mexico, seated on a couch and fiddling with some kind of drugs that were not marijuana.

A thought nagged at me, in the back of my head, putting a nick in my good mood for a moment, but April was walking toward me, eyes looking in every direction, and I knew she wanted to leave.

No one paid us any mind, and no one cared that we didn't say goodbye.

"See?" I said, as April leaned close to me, at the end of the block. I had my phone out and was getting an Uber. I looked behind us briefly. "No one even noticed us," I told her. "I think everyone was pretty.. intoxicated..."

The bad feeling, the niggling thought, flitted around again in my mind. I just couldn't quite remember what it was.

We waited at the corner for the Uber. April was cold so I put my arms around her to keep her warm. In her sexy heels she was about an inch taller than me, which often bothers me a little and prevents me from standing too close. I didn't care, though.

We rode home in silence, hands together. April leaned against the window and began to doze off. I had to wake her when we got home.

We didn't talk about it much, I just led her to the bedroom and told her I'd get a bath going for her. I helped her out of her clothes, peeling them from her body, kissing her as I did. But April was sleepy, exhausted, and probably drunk.

"April," I said quietly, the bad thought surfacing again. "Did Lilith give you anything tonight?"

April looked at me: I was pulling the legs of her jeans off. "Hmm?" she said sleepily.

"Like... I don't know, X or anything? Lilith?"

April laughed, bemused. "What?"

I decided, based on how sleepy and confused she looked, to ask some other time. "Nothing," I told her.

I helped her into the bath and held her hair up for her while I soaped her down with a loofah. She rested her head back against the back of the tub, which is not the most comfortable-looking position in the world, and closed her eyes. "This is so nice," she said, sleepy. And then she pretty much fell asleep.

I'd like to say I lifted her out of the tub and carried her to the bed like they do in the movies, but let's face it, lifting even a very small human from soapy water is not an easy task, and April is thin and gorgeous and I'm totally, totally buff... but it just isn't possible.

I had to wake her up and pull her to standing, steady her while I wrapped a towel around her, and then guide her to our bed. I did lift her feet onto the bed.

By then she was nearly asleep, and she lifted a hand toward me, her eyes closed, aiming for god-knows-what. "Thomas," she said. "I love you, I hope..."

The words came out so slowly this whole pronouncement took like an entire minute, and so I sat there waiting for the rest of the sentence for a good long time.

But April had fallen asleep.

CHAPTER 18

I should have been exhausted, but I was so wired that I lay next to April, looking intermittently at the curves of her body, the smoothness of her skin, the fading puffiness around her lips, her drying hair, until she returned to the same April she had been before that night: unspoiled, flawless. Almost as if a spell had been cast on her, and it was fading with each passing moment of the dark night.

I knew that I had all but fallen on my knees to the gods of fate and chance, begging for what I had just gotten, and I knew that in some corners of my soul I *loved* it. That parts of my mind were already whirling away, spinning up new adventures, imagining how depraved Jonny could get this new April to be. If all it had taken was a single night to get April to do the very, very filthy things she had done tonight, what *else* could he get her to do?

Part of me, of course, thought that perhaps the whole thing had been a dream.

And then another part of me, which I scolded consistently for being hypocritical, was devastated. Sure, I had wanted and wanted it, but now it was *done*. April had been a raving slut, another man had probed her body in ways and parts I would never dare to, and she had come for him, enjoyed his cock, hyperventilated and seized up in the grip of her passion.

Thinking about all of this just made my dick hard again, so it was a long night.

All through it, April slept peacefully. And that triggered even more thoughts.

At night I have my darkest thoughts. They become larger than life. Was April really a monster inside a sweet exterior? Had I unleashed something inside of her that would only get out of control? Had she always been this way, had she done slutty things with slutty Lilith and then just pretended to be who she was for me? Had she locked all of that away and then I had pushed her into it again?

Had Lilith given her drugs that night? She told me she was joking, but I couldn't erase the image of April, her arm extended, Jonny playing with her skin. Had she been high? Had this all just been something she'd done under the influence of ecstasy, and she would wake up and regret it all?

And from that whirlpool of dark and beautiful, arousing and painful, gloomy and suspicious and fulfilled thoughts, and hopes for the future and fears of the past, and vice versa, emerged a question I could not answer, at least not late at night like that.

What was it that I *wanted*?

*

A funny thing happens in the dark to your mind, and somehow the sharp edges of these thoughts evaporate completely in the light of day. I eventually fell asleep. When I woke up, April was facing me, her eyes closed, her hand next to mine on the bed.

She opened her eyes after only a moment of me looking at her.

"Hi," she said.

"Hi."

She smiled. For a moment I was worried that she had forgotten the evening entirely - what would I do then? - and then her face changed, her eyes closing a little, her brow furrowing just ever-so-slightly.

"I've been awake for a long time," she told me, like it was a confession. She propped herself up on her elbow. "Are you... are we okay? With everything...?"

"I told you we are," I assured her, immediately, without thinking about it. I put a hand on her face. "April, please, I don't know what else to say to make you believe me."

She slid her arm out and lowered her head to where mine was. "I know," she said. "I... uh... I don't know. I just feel... sort of..."

"Don't."

April rolled her eyes. Then she smiled bravely. "Oh, okay. I just won't." She turned onto her back and covered her face. "Ohhhhh," she moaned. "I can't believe I *did* that. At Lilith's *house*!"

"At Lilith's house?" I asked, quizzically. "Lilith's house seems like the most natural place in the world for that to happen, if you ask me."

"True," April said, from behind her fingers. She dropped her hands to rest them primly on her chest. "Tell me the truth," she said. "Did you call that guy Jonny and ask him to come?"

She turned to me earnestly.

"I knew Jonny would be there," I said, equally earnestly. "I did not tell him to do anything. I didn't get in touch with him."

April turned again, up on her elbow. "You swear?"

I made the sign of the cross. She slapped my hand. She's not religious, and her parents are totally lapsing, Easter-Catholics who didn't even baptize her, but it ticks her off a little when I do that. "Seriously," she warned.

"Why?"

She glared at me.

"I *swear* April. I knew he was going to be there, but that's it."

She narrowed her eyes.

"Why?" I repeated.

"How?" she challenged back, almost immediately.

I was suddenly lost. "Huh?"

"How? How did you know he was going to be there?"

"Oh," I said. I had a sneaking suspicion I was wading into shit, as one does when one wades into shit, but the momentum was not in my favor, so I did so with gusto. "Lilith," I said.

"Lilith," April repeated. She looked at the sheets, and her fingers moved over them. She was calculating something. "Lilith, when?"

"Uh... well, she just, sent me a message," I said. I was all about honesty right now. Seemed like the best course of action. I leaned back, reached for my night table, and fumbled around for my phone. I found Lilith's message, and flipped the screen to show April. "This is what she sent me, and this is what I sent her back."

April read. It didn't take her very long. "Jonny's going to be there" and "How'd you get my number?" are not exactly Russian novels.

I watched her face. Something was up, something that I had missed or had neglected to worry about. Something beneath the surface.

She pushed my hand down and looked at me. The "something" was swimming there, beneath the surface of her skin, and I couldn't figure it out. My stomach flip-flopped. Was I in trouble? Was Lilith in trouble (and did I care if she was?)

It began to surface, and it took me a while to recognize it.

A smile.

It broke across her face, and it became a laugh. A snorty, truly lighthearted laugh. She tipped her head forward and laughed into the sheet, and then she lifted it.

"So?" she asked me. "This is actually *all* you sent her? 'How'd you get my number?'"

She used her "Thomas" voice to say that last part. I have the remnants of a very working-class Chicago accent that I've largely polished away, but it comes out sometimes. April thinks it's hysterical, and she also imitates it pretty poorly.

I stared at her.

She held her palm face up, waiting for an explanation.

"I... look... I didn't really know... what to... this was... after that conversation... I just..."

She was grinning more and more. Something was up, and if there was one person who didn't get it, it was me.

I stopped talking, and blinked, shrugging as much as I could. "*What?*" I said, at last, admitting confusion.

"How *did* she get your number? Did you ever find out?"

"I..." I said, stupidly.

"You didn't think about it after that? At all?"

I tipped my head quizzically. April was still smiling. Smiling, a lot like Lilith sometimes did. As if tufts of canary were going to pop out of her mouth any moment.

Gears were turning in my head, but they just couldn't spit out the right numbers. I waited. April smiled.

Then she fell onto her back. "I can't believe you didn't even *wonder* about that," she remarked.

She turned her head to look at me when I didn't answer.

"Lilith said you wouldn't, but I honestly didn't believe her."

"Lilith...?" I said slowly. Words had become syrup in my mouth. My thoughts went racing ahead. "Wait... what?"

April pulled the sheets up to her chin. She pressed her fists to her lips. "Okay... Lilith... talked me into this. Well... not *all* of it. Just... trying things out."

I stared.

"Please say you're not mad. She told me about... well," April turned to me. "I went to her, after that Jonny conversation, and I told her, like... all the stuff we talked about. What you wanted, what I told you. And Lilith told me about *your* conversations, you know, the things you had talked to her about."

"Oh, my God," I said, rolling onto my back and staring at the ceiling.

April rolled over and put a hand on my chest. "Don't be mad at her. She didn't... want to say anything, she just... felt like she had to take responsibility for the Jonny thing, and then I started grilling her about why she would do that - look, none of that matters anyway because... after I talked to her about all that, I sort of, I don't know. She helped me understand it. Your thing."

I turned to face her. "So, what... you planned last night? Together?"

April rolled onto her back and put her arms straight out by her sides. "Sort of..." she said, squeezing her eyes shut.

"What does that mean?" I asked.

Her eyes were squeezed very tight by then. "She invited Jonny. And then she told you he was coming. And I was going to... I don't know, see how you reacted to that. See what you did. I guess I was planning on just... just to take it one step further. The... rest of it... wasn't exactly my plan." She put her hand to her head. "I just got... carried away." She opened her eyes and rolled her head to look at me. "That's what I was worried about."

My mouth was open.

"I didn't mean for things to go that far," she said. She put her hand in mine and entwined our fingers. "I just... you were there, so, I guess I figured you would say something if it was too much."

When she lifted her eyes from our hands to my face, I had the same expression on my face.

I didn't know what to say. So I kissed her on the forehead.

And then we had sex again.

And that, my friends, is how it all *started*.

END

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